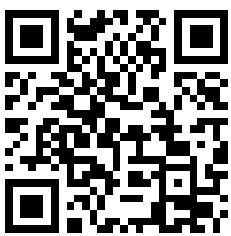
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P. A. Stapfer — achete de Barrois fils 36 frcs

23) wo) fil u f. vocalesciil alii consoni adjuncti ut) Hebr. p. 14. ad ap. Bengal. tertium, aut videtur; unde conjecturi licuit, antiqui Hebr.) semper consonam fuisse, nec nisi serius in) collapsisse.

24) inaudita consonantium cerebralium classis ap. Grammaticos Stapfer. p. 14.

25) Signorum peculiarium Pholaa ad indicandam vocalis inhaerentis quidem inexistentiam. 16/99

26) nonnulla vocales, repetita suis consonis (baanaan aut maabraah), praefigentur scribendo, sed in pronuntiando consonantibus postponuntur. p. 29. 30.

27) Vocativum Sy. l. recte casibus ejusdem p. 54, cum nullam propriae relationem significet.

28) enclitica particula metris inservientes p. 59. 198 gerundiumaddita p. 116. 311.

29) maanasso, homo p. 63. Mangal. naama maasa (masc) mensis Persica genuina 174 Naumm. p. 64. nugor civitas. Jan (locus) Sy. ori p. 138/99

30) formatio pluralis numeri atenebaedis nominibus copiam designantibus, ut tolle, dol, gomo, 71/99 goolaa p. 74. deog ib.

31) Stapfer. grammatici jam a 2dam personam pronominibus non annumerant p. 76. Pronomen tertium Bengal. rarissime adjicunt, repetitione nominum ipsorum ad fastidium taedii p. 77.

vocales et longis simul breves inesse ante per declinationem syllabarum numero, fere ut Hebr. p. 84. 48. (100) audiendum. cfr 151 Sy. Grammaticis p. 83 113.

Sic verbum substf. du-

Sapa distributioni (93) et tempori indigitandis inservientia.

Igitur verbis et prominibus p. 104. 105. Suffixum gr. emphasin inferens 114. negationem 117. 118.

Sima p. 104. 105. 122. 124. praeter Stapfer in p. 103. Latina penultimum. ult. p. 126. ultimus ampl.

imminutae accentuationes 188. et elegantia documenta in sermone Bengal. pertinent cursus p.

cere tempiliaris p. 102; hos abludens ab Anglorum abusu verbi to do. 61. 127. 99

Syriaca longa per subsonum ampl. abusum degenerasit abund. cum. p. 128. (124. 126. 137.

Bengalia Bengalensium verba cum Hebraeis Hebr. emperi professus. p. 106. 113. 137. Sed non habens

Hospital aut professum. p. 122.

36) Infinitivi in Bengal. lingua usus loco finitivi et declinatio p. 128. 107. non Arabum.

37) Discrepantia Bengala Sy. matre p. 130. forma actionis reciprocae deficit. inserendis ad ap

part. pass. et part. praes. act. compositae usus in Sy. non occurrens. p. 139. 140. 141/99

38) Literarum redupliciatio in Sy. ut verb. Gr. in pe 126. in Bengal. idiom. ad mutuam actionem, saepi-

tungas aut sonii imitationem denotand. aut alliterationis causa quam amant p. 140–143. 152.

39) subst. in genit. casu adjunctis saepe p. 181. ut Gr. distinguo ab hoc casu adjj. derivata solaces.

40) quamvis consonans suum habet vocalem subjectam, aut app. Hebr. 6. 7. 190–193. Sed eam per contractionem

haec quidem adjicit, praesertim in Bengal. dial. cum in Sy. ut in Arabicis libris haec omissio minus sit

frequens. 190.

notes écrites en 1803. Depuis, les rapports du Sanscrit avec les langues d'Occident anciennes et modernes ont été l'objet de recherches ou de conjectures de MM. Hagueman (mentor principal du enfant du Roi Joachim de Naples, et l'homme qui a jeté le plus de jour sur l'analogie de l'ancienne mythologie [illegible] celle des Grecs dans ses Disst. sur l'Odyssée de Canope [illegible] Adelung, Vater, Klenker Hartmann, Eichhorn et Schlegel. M. [illegible] croira avec le [illegible] Jones que le Sanscrit et le vieux Persan sont [illegible] ancienne de l'Iran, à laquelle se rattachent les langues Sémitiques, [illegible] recherches des Allemands les ancêtres des Hebreux sont sortis de l'Arabie. [illegible] Hartmann.

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Notitia manuscriptorum Regii Parisiensis inde occurrentium

1) quae ex ore Professi. Regii Chaguemais de antiquo Indorum cum ea
comercio in libris Shanscriticis prodita percipientur Prolegg.

2) de analogia Shaner. cum Latina et Gr. lib. III. IV. IX.
p. 8 n. 6. p. 159 n. 3. p. 32 quorum ejus in casuum numero praecellentia
1 Sg. 3) de Sg. verbi forma quali medii verbi Graecorum dicta
Slevician refert p. 101 Sg.

4) de numerorum ratione et figuris apud Indos 159 Sg. de quatuor
numeri frequentis usu p. 167.

5) de majori (157) Sg. linguae cum Latina, subjecta antiquiori linguae
de Europae è qua Graeca nata est, dialecto quam cum Ge. similitudine
5.* obs. Germ. Gall. (a Bengal. lingua ope verbi auxil. ire formari atque
radices alic. 138. (a genuina 115. 116.) Europaeis Shanscr. terminationes
Jordan p. 246 n. 3) de prosa oratione apud Indos regulae p. 96. sub finem bina 104. 105. 125. 17
7) episodes ex carmine epico Mohaabharat p. 37 Sg. (p. 58 Sg. 167 Sg. 9. 37. 111. 89. 85. 70. 90. 14.
quorundam capitum, porro
8) discrimina dial. Bengal. a Shanscrit. linguae. Evolvit numeri plur.
et duali usus in substantivis, verbis p. 102 Sg. ut in Latino, Graeco, Germ. 51. 139. ut et quaedam, verborum, conjug.
terminationes p. 102 Sg. ut in Latino in dat. lingua
9) radicum Bengalensium quae sunt Shanscr. origines (n. 137) p. 130 Sg.
p. 106. 107. 108. 129. multa dicta deperdita et gallica lingua, commercio
10) d. Bengal. metris et versibus 200. ad eandem corrupt. pertinentes usus p. 128 Sg.
de contractione vocum in poesi p. 84. 125. 126. 194. 196 Sg. articl. ako, unus (ein, a, an &c. gone)
11) de eorundem musica p. 205 add. Sing. num. a Bengal. 3 quamquam dum. sing. num.
plural. nulla praepositio et ejus articulus, aliter arbitrabor. 69. 70.
quos Helv. ex numerandi ratione confinxerunt 91.
12) de dial. Bengal. recentiori correcta per Arabicum luxuriem
XX. 178. et p. 207 Sg. atque per ejusdem syllaba aut terminationis ad
vocem adoptionem diversissimos resonandos applicationis e.g. va p. 75. 61. 62. 80. va p. 60. 66.
13) verba prospectivi in Shanscr. lingua et dial. Hindostanici. et Bengal.
defectus p. 102.

14) plur. numeri in negligentia ob reverentiam usus p. 85. 183. (ins Arabica persona pl. 184.)
aut in linguis Europ. usu inculcavit.
15) de radice Shanscrit. (agendi) verborum generalis designante et derivatis
Eadem diversa ejusdem terminationes formandis infinitiv. gerund. sup. pass. partic. d non sibilantibus insertionis 127. 130. 138. 139.
16) vestigia vocum Sg. contractionem perspicuarum in Bengal. Ind. e.g. p. 113

17) de idiomate mocco barbarica linguarum collectio Prof. II. XIII. XIV. 206 sub.

18) de litterarum figuris per Assam, Nepaul, Cashmeere aliasque regna non
minus ac in Tibetanis et Bootanicis terris cum Bengal. et Shanscrit. praesertim
similitudine Prof. IV. XIII.

19) quod p. 15 de triplici Tē Shō sono referetur, qui olim trifariam prolatus hodie
a Bengalensibus barbare aut incurio ore unisone enunciatus ut Cananitarum
atque Galilaei literas ס, ע, פ ו ת a priscis Hebraeis diversimode sonatas
rudi lingua confunderet atque promiscuo usu tanquam aequivalentia signa
usurpare dicuntur. Add. sonos ngnoo-o, gnee-o, aaao et no in Sg. l.
diversos, a Bengalensibus aut non adhibitos aut eodem pretio habitos.
p. 10. 11. Wo a Beng. ut bo pronunciatum p. 13 Sg. Ohe et Hhyo minus late patentis
Supp. Beng. nec nisi Sg. usitas. E et n figuras ei soloi confund. a Bengal. p. 13.
20) Duplex Tē t et Tē d sonus p. 11. 12. 21) Pronunciandi separata Tē p. h in alphab. d juncta ut f
in sermone p. 12. 22) similis Tē Dō et ro conformatio ut Tē d. p. 11 et 12.

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বোধপ্রকাশং শব্দশাস্ত্রং
ফিরিঙ্গিনামুপকারার্থং
ক্রিয়তে হালেদঙ্গ্রেজী

A GRAMMAR OF THE BENGAL LANGUAGE

BY

NATHANIEL BRASSEY HALHED.

ইন্দ্রাদয়োপি যস্যান্তং নয়যুঃ শব্দবারিধেঃ।
প্রক্রিয়ান্তস্য কৃৎস্নস্য ক্ষমোবক্তুং নরঃ কথং॥

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PREFACE.

THE wisdom of the British Parliament has within these few years taken a decisive part in the internal policy and civil administration of its Asiatic territories; and more particularly in the Kingdom of Bengal, which, by the most formal act of authority in the establishment of a Supreme Court of Justice, it has professedly incorporated with the British Empire. Much however still remains for the completion of this grand work; and

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and we may reaſonably preſume, that one of its moſt important deſiderata is the cultivation of a right underſtanding and of a general medium of intercourſe between the Government and its Subjects; between the Natives of Europe who are to rule, and the Inhabitants of India who are to obey. The Romans, a people of little learning and leſs taſte, had no ſooner conquered Greece than they applied themſelves to the ſtudy of Greek: They adopted its Laws even before they could read them, and civilized themſelves in ſubduing their enemies. The Engliſh, who have made ſo capital a progreſs in the Polite Arts, and who are maſters of Bengal, may, with more eaſe and greater propriety, add its Language to their acquiſitions: that they may explain the benevolent principles of that legiſlation whoſe decrees they inforce; that they may convince while they command; and be at once the diſpenſers of Laws and of Science to an extenſive nation. This ſubject has hitherto been utterly diſregarded in Europe; and it is ſcarcely believed that Bengal ever poſſeſſed a native and peculiar dialect of its own, diſtinct from that idiom which, under the name of *Moor's*, has been ſuppoſed to prevail over all India. To remove theſe prejudices, and to contribute my ſlender mite to the public ſervice, I have attempted the following grammatical explanation of the vernacular language of Bengal

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Bengal: in which my principal aim has been to comprehend every thing neceſſary to be known; not contenting myſelf with a ſuperficial or partial view, nor confining my obſervations to the more obvious particularities. A ſhort treatiſe, when preceded by other more copious and diffuſive compilations on the ſame ſubject, may perhaps paſs for a judicious abſtract, or an elegant compendium; but every omiſſion of the writer who hath choſen an unhandled topic will be imputed to ignorance or neglect, by thoſe whoſe ſubſequent diſcoveries may have furniſhed more complete information.

The grand Source of Indian Literature, the Parent of almoſt every dialect from the Perſian Gulph to the China Seas, is the Shanſcrit; a language of the moſt venerable and unfathomable antiquity; which although at preſent ſhut up in the libraries of Bramins, and appropriated ſolely to the records of their Religion, appears to have been current over moſt of the Oriental World; and traces of its original extent may ſtill be diſcovered in almoſt every diſtrict of Aſia. I have been aſtoniſhed to find the ſimilitude of Shanſcrit words with thoſe of Perſian and Arabic, and even of Latin and Greek: and theſe not in technical and metaphorical terms, which the mutuation of refined arts and improved manners might have occaſionally introduced; but

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in the main ground-work of language, in monoſyllables, in the the names of numbers, and the appellations of ſuch things as would be firſt diſcriminated on the immediate dawn of civilization. The reſemblance which may be obſerved in the characters upon the medals and ſignets of various diſtricts of Aſia, the light which they reciprocally reflect upon each other, and the general analogy which they all bear to the ſame grand Prototype, afford another ample field for curioſity. The coins of Aſſam, Napaul, Caſhmeere and many other kingdoms are all ſtamped with Shanſcrit letters, and moſtly contain alluſions to the old Shanſcrit Mythology: the ſame conformity I have obſerved on the impreſſions of ſeals from Bootan and Tibet. A collateral inference may likewiſe be deduced from the peculiar arrangement of the Shanſcrit alphabet, ſo very different from that of any other quarter of the world. This extraordinary mode of combination ſtill exiſts in the greateſt part of the Eaſt, from the Indus to Pegu, in dialects now apparently unconnected, and in characters compleatly diſſimilar; but is a forcible argument that they are all derived from the ſame ſource. Another channel of ſpeculation preſents itſelf in the names of perſons and places, of titles and dignities, which are open to general notice, and in which, to the fartheſt limits of Aſia, may be found ma-

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manifeſt traces of the Shanſcrit. The meagre remnants of Coptic antiquities afford no ſcope for compariſon between that idiom and this primitive tongue: but there ſtill exiſts ſufficient grounds for conjecture that Egypt has but a diſputable claim to its long-boaſted originality in language, in policy and in religion. In ſupport of this opinion I ſhall mention only one circumſtance. The Raja of Kiſhenagur, who is by much the moſt learned and able antiquary which Bengal has produced within this century, has very lately affirmed, that he has in his own poſſeſſion Shanſcrit books which give an account of a communication formerly ſubſiſting between India and Egypt; wherein the Egyptians are conſtantly deſcribed as diſciples, not as inſtructors, and as ſeeking that liberal education and thoſe ſciences in Hindoſtan, which none of their own countrymen had ſufficient knowledge to impart. The few paſſages which are extant in the antient Greek authors reſpecting the Bracmans at the ſame time that they receive a freſh light from this relation, very ſtrongly corroborate its authenticity.

But though theſe ſeveral proofs of the former prevalence of the Shanſcrit are now thinly ſcattered over an immenſe continent, and interſperſed with an infinite variety of extraneous matter, ariſing from every poſſible revolution in the manners

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and principles of the nations, who have by turns cultivated or deſtroyed it; that part of Aſia between the Indus and the Ganges ſtill preſerves the whole language pure and inviolate; ſtill offers a thouſand books to the peruſal of the curious, many of which have been religiouſly handed down from the earlieſt periods of human exiſtance.

The Jeſuit Dupont has miſled many ſubſequent writers, by his fabulous account of the wonderful ſtructure of this dialect. According to him, it owes the moſt extenſive and copious harveſt of words to a very inadequate number of primitive roots, and theſe he chuſes to call the *caput mortuum* of the language; as not being words of themſelves, but certain ſounds bearing a relation to certain ideas. The elements to which he alludes, and of which he has miſquoted an inſtance, fall far ſhort of thoſe comprehenſive faculties which he has beſtowed on them. They are ſimply the Roots of Verbs, and are even ſo denominated in the very title of the book from whence he muſt have borrowed his inaccurate examples. Their number is about ſeven hundred; and it muſt be granted that to them, as to the verbs of moſt other languages, a very plentiful ſtock of verbal nouns owes its origin; but I by no means believe that they exceed thoſe of the Greek either in quantity or variety.

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The fundamental part of the Shanſcrit language is divided into three claſſes: *Dhaat* or roots of verbs, (Dupont's primitive elements) *Shubd* or original nouns, and *Evya* or particles. Theſe latter are ever indeclinable as in other idioms: but the words comprehended in the two former claſſes muſt be prepared by certain additions and inflexions to fit them for a place in compoſition. And here it is that the art of the Grammarian has found room to expand itſelf, and to employ all the powers of refinement. Not a ſyllable, not a letter can be added or altered but by regimen; not the moſt trifling variation of the ſenſe in the minuteſt ſubdiviſion of declenſion or conjugation can be effected without the application of ſeveral rules: and all the different forms for every change of gender, number, caſe, perſon, tenſe, mood or degree are methodically arranged for the aſſiſtance of the memory; reſembling (though on a ſcale infinitely more extenſive) the compilations of *propria quae maribus* and *as in preſenti*.

Had Dupont been leſs bigotted to his ſyſtem of a *caput mortuum*, he muſt have reflected that a verb and a noun are equally neceſſary to the conſtruction of a ſentence, and to the very intelligibility of ſpeech; and had he gained a proper inſight into the Shanſcrit, he would have been fully convinced, that its elementary parts are made up of theſe two genera with the addition of particles.

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To this triple ſource I conceive that every word of truly Indian original in every provincial and ſubordinate dialect of all Hindoſtan may ſtill be traced by a laborious and critical analyſis; and all ſuch terms as are thoroughly proved to bear no relation to any one of the Shanſcrit roots, I would conſider as the production of ſome remote and foreign idiom, ſubſequently ingrafted upon the main ſtock. A judicious inveſtigation of this principle would probably throw a new light upon the firſt invention of many arts and ſciences, and open a freſh mine of philological diſcoveries.

Excluſive of the Shanſcrit, there are three different dialects applied (tho' not with equal currency) in the kingdom of Bengal: Viz. the Perſian, the Hindoſtanic and the proper Bengaleſe; each of which has its own peculiar department in the buſineſs of the country, and conſequently neither of them can be univerſally adopted to the excluſion of the others.

The Perſian entered Bengal with the Mogul conquerors, and being the language of the court naturally gained a footing in the law and in the revenues; it has alſo for ſome centuries been the common medium of negotiation between the ſeveral ſtates of Hindoſtan, and from thence became an almoſt indiſpenſable qualification for thoſe who were to manage the extenſive affairs of the

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the East India Company: ſo that the accurate and elegant grammar compoſed by Mr. Jones does equal honour to the cauſe of learning, and ſervice to his countrymen in Aſia. This language is ſtill uſed by all the Mogul officers of government, in their ſeveral departments of accounts and correſpondence; as being the dialect of the former ruling power, of which the Engliſh have in ſome degree taken the place, and whoſe ſyſtem they have not yet laid aſide. From hence ariſes one capital impediment to the uniformity of political arrangements in Bengal; for while the ſummary of all public buſineſs is kept in one idiom, the detail is invariably confined to another, as I ſhall preſently demonſtrate.

The Hindoſtanic, or Indian language, appears to have been generally ſpoken for many ages through all proper Hindoſtan. It is indubitably derived from the Shanſcrit, with which it has exactly the ſame connexion, as the modern dialects of France and Italy with pure Latin. For while the ſame ſounds are almoſt conſtantly applied in both languages to repreſent the ſame ideas, the inflexions by which they are affected and the modes of grammatical regimen are widely different. The Shanſcrit has a dual number both to verbs and nouns, the Hindoſtanic to neither. Verbs in Shanſcrit have the ſame form for both

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both the maſculine and feminine genders; Hindoſtanic verbs are diſtinguiſhed by different terminations for the different ſexes, like thoſe of the Arabic. Theſe are their capital outlines of diſſimilarity; but in the original appropriation of particular words to particular ſenſes, in the idiomatic turns of expreſſion and complexion of ſpeech we may obſerve the ſtrongeſt family likeneſs.

The Characters alſo peculiar to the Hindoſtanic are exactly the ſame with thoſe of the Shanſcrit, but of a ruder ſhape: yet ſtill exhibiting a more accurate reſemblance than is found in many of the Greek letters upon inſcriptions of different Æras.

This primitive Hindoſtanic tongue has by no means preſerved its purity, or its univerſality to the preſent age: for the modern Inhabitants of India vary almoſt as much in language as in Religion. It is well known in what an obſtinate and inviolable obſcurity the Jentoos conceal as well the Myſteries of their Faith, as the Books in which they are contained: and under what ſevere prohibitions their moſt approved Legiſlators have confined the ſtudy of the Shanſcrit to their own principal tribes only. An explanation of it to perſons not qualified for this ſcience by their rank, ſubjected both the teacher and the pupil to very tremendous penalties; but to fully its purity by imparting the ſlighteſt knowledge of it to ſtrangers was ever cautiouſly avoided as the moſt inexpiable crime. The Pundit who imparted a ſmall

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portion of his language to me, has by no means escaped the censure of his countrymen: and while he readily displayed the principles of his grammar, he has invariably refused to develope a single article of his religion. Thus we may suppose that when the Mahometan Invaders first settled in India, and from the necessity of having some medium of communication with their new subjects, applied themselves to the study of the Hindostanic dialect, the impenetrable reserve of the Jentoos would quickly render its abstruser Shanscrit terms unintelligible; and the Foreigners, unpracticed in the idiom, would frequently recur to their own native expressions. New adventurers continually arriving kept up a constant influx of exotic words, and the heterogeneous mass gradually increased its stock, as conquest or policy extended the boundaries of its circulation. But these alterations affected words only. The grammatical principles of the original Hindostanic, and the ancient forms of conjugation and inflexion remained the same; and whilst the primitive substantives were excluded or exchanged, the verbs maintained both their inflexions and their regimen. They still subsist in their pristine state; and at present those persons are thought to speak this compound idiom with the most elegance, who mix with pure Indian verbs the greatest number of Persian and Arabic nouns. Such of the Hindoos as have been connected with the Mussel-

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man courts, or admitted to any offices under that government have generally complimented their maſters by a compliance with theſe literary innovations. But the Bramins and all other well-educated Jentoos, whoſe ambition has not overpowered their principles, ſtill adhere with a certain conſcientious tenacity to their primeval tongue, and have many antient books written in its pureſt ſtyle; among which were probably the celebrated Fables of Pilpay (now not to be found.) They continue to apply it to the purpoſes of commerce in Surat, Guzarat and other places on the weſtern Coaſt; and their correſpondence circulates through all Hindoſtan, quite to the interior parts of Bengal; where ſeveral Bankers of this Religion, who have at different times emigrated from the higher countries, carry on a very extenſive traffic. The Characters in which it is written, though all derived from the Shanſcrit, deviate as much from their original exemplar, as our running-hand and italian differ from round-hand. It is ſaid that there are ſeven different ſorts of Indian hands all comprized under the general term *Naagoree*, which may be interpreted *Writing*; and the elegant Shanſcrit is ſtyled *Daeb Naagoree* or the *Writing of the Immortals*; which may not improbably be a refinement from the more ſimple and unpoliſhed Naagoree of the earlier ages. The word *Taagoree* is ſometimes

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times uſed to ſignify a looſe or inaccurate character of the Naagoree, but I never could diſcover that any preciſe diſtinction was implied by it. The Bengal letters, ſuch as diſplayed in the following ſheets, are another branch of the ſame ſtock; leſs beautiful than the refined Shanſcrit, but reſembling it no leſs than the Naagoree. They are uſed in *Aſſam* as well as in Bengal, and may be probably one of the moſt antient modes of writing in the world. The Bengaleſe Bramins have all their Shanſcrit books copied in this national alphabet, and tranſpoſe into it all the *Daeb Naagoree* manuſcripts for their own peruſal.

The dialect called by us the *Moors* is that mixed ſpecies of Hindoſtanic, which I have above deſcribed to owe its exiſtance to the Mahometan Conqueſts. In this idiom ſeveral elegant poems and tales have been compoſed by learned Perſian and Mogul authors, and are ſtill extant in the libraries of the curious. Theſe are always written in the Perſian hand, which is by no means calculated for expreſſing the ſound either of the Hindoſtanic vowels or naſal conſonants. The Mahometans of the lower rank have a few books on Religious ſubjects in this language, and in the Naagoree characters; which are alſo uſed by ſome of them in their petty accounts. Europeans on their arrival in India, reduced to a neceſſary intercourſe with Mahometan

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tan ſervants, or Sepoys, habitually acquire from them this idiom in that imperfect and confined ſtate which is the conſequence of the menial condition of their inſtructors: yet this curious ſyſtem of ſtudy hath produced more than one attempt to a Grammar and Vocabulary. The jargon however, ſuch as it is, proves utterly unintelligible to the villagers and peaſants both in Hindoſtan and Bengal, nor is uſed any where, but in large towns frequented by Mahometans and Strangers. On this dialect an ingenious Miſſionary long ſince publiſhed a laborious treatiſe in Latin. He is the earlieſt and may be deemed the only writer on the ſubject, for the latter compoſitions do not deſerve a name.

What the pure Hindoſtanic is to upper India, the language which I have here endeavoured to explain is to Bengal, intimately related to the Shanſcrit both in expreſſions, conſtruction and character. It is the ſole channel of perſonal and epiſtolary communication among the Hindoos of every occupation and tribe. All their buſineſs is tranſacted, and all their accounts are kept in it; and as their ſyſtem of education is in general very confined, there are few among them who can write or read any other idiom: the uneducated, or eight parts in ten of the whole nation, are neceſſarily confined to the uſage of their mother tongue.

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The Board of Commerce at Calcutta, and the ſeveral Chiefs of the ſubordinate Factories cannot properly conduct the India Company's mercantile correſpondence and negotiations, without the intermediate agency of Bengal Interpreters: for the whole ſyſtem of the Inveſtment, in every ſtage of its preparation and proviſion, is managed in the language of the country; in which all the accounts of the Aurungs, (or manufacturing towns) thoſe of the Company's Export Warehouſe, all propoſals and letters from agents, merchants, contractors, weavers, winders, bleachers &c. are conſtantly preſented; and into which all orders to Gomaſtahs, Aumeens and other officers for the purchaſe and procuration of goods muſt be tranſlated.

Important as this language muſt conſequently appear to the Commercial line, its adoption would be no leſs beneficial to the Revenue department. For although the Contracts, Leaſes and other obligations, executed between Government and its immediate dependants and tenants, continue to be drawn out in the Perſian dialect, yet the under Leaſes and engagements, which theſe in their turn grant to the peaſants and cultivators of the ground, and all thoſe copyhold tenures called *Pottahs* are conſtantly written in Bengaleſe. And it may even be doubted whether more than one third of all Jentoo Zemindars, Farmers and other Leſſees of the ſtate can read a ſingle word of their

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own accounts and repreſentations, as delivered in their Moonſhee's Perſian tranſlation.

The internal policy of the kingdom demands an equal ſhare of attention; and the many impoſitions to which the poorer claſs of people are expoſed, in a country ſtill fluctuating between the relics of former deſpotic dominion, and the liberal ſpirit of its preſent legiſlature, have long cried out for a remedy. This has lately been propoſed in the appointment of gentlemen of mature experience in the manners and cuſtoms of the natives to the ſeveral diviſions and diſtricts of Bengal, to act as juſticiary arbitrators between the head farmer and his under tenants: with whom the indigent villager might find immediate and effectual redreſs from the exactions of an imperious Landlord or graſping Collector, freed from the neceſſary delays of an ordinary court of juſtice, and the expence and inconvenience of a regular ſuit. Such a meaſure, by holding out to each induſtrious individual a near proſpect of property in his earnings and ſecurity in his poſſeſſions, promiſes, in the moſt effectual manner, to enſure ſtability to our conqueſts and popularity to our adminiſtration; and will probably ſet open the Britiſh territories as an aſylum for the diſcouraged huſbandman, the neglected artiſt, and oppreſſed labourer from every quarter of Hindoſtan. But this important commiſſion will be more immediately, and more exten-

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extenſively beneficial, in proportion as it is conferred on thoſe only whom a competent knowledge of the Bengaleſe has previouſly qualified for a perſonal inveſtigation of every unwarrantable exaction, and ſcrutiny into every complicated account.

Add to this, that there is not one office under the *Nazim* or Mogul adminiſtration, nor one provincial or ſubordinate court of juſtice in the kingdom where an interpreter for this language is not judged as neceſſary and as conſtantly employed as for the Perſian: and if any public notices are to be diſperſed through the country, or affixed in the great towns, they are always attended with a Bengal tranſlation. In ſhort, if vigour, impartiality and diſpatch be required to the operations of government, to the diſtribution of juſtice, to the collections of the revenues and to the tranſactions of commerce, they are only to be ſecured by a proper attention to that dialect uſed by the body of the people; eſpecially as it is much better calculated both for public and private affairs by its plainneſs, its preciſion and regularity of conſtruction, than the flowery ſentences and modulated periods of the Perſian.

Another ſingular advantage which it poſſeſſes, is its aptitude for the buſineſs of the compting-houſe. For the Bengal doctrine of numbers, both in the forms of the figures and in their application, nearly approaches to the ſyſtem adopted in Europe; from

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from which nothing can more eſſentially differ than the Perſian mode of cyphering, both in arrangement and application: ſo that thoſe who would be acquainted with the latter, have a new arithmetic as well as a new language to acquire; and if they have any concerns tranſacted through this medium, they muſt undergo the ſubſequent trouble of reducing their Perſian accounts to the European form; whereas thoſe of the Bengal accompt-ant require nothing more than an accurate copyiſt.

The great number of letters in the Bengal alphabet, and the intricate variety of their combinations may perhaps at firſt ſight ſtrike the learner as an almoſt inſuperable difficulty. But this is his only impediment; for the grammatical part is ſimple, tho' diffuſe, and compleat without being complex. Its rules are plain, and its anomalies few. So that if he will reſolve to gain a thorough knowledge of each particular article as he proceeds, without trifling away his time in anticipated peruſals, and needleſs references to the more advanced chapters, he will ſoon have reaſon to be ſurpriſed at the rapidity of his paſſage over ſo diſheartening an obſtacle.

Nothing need here be remarked on any particular method of ſtudy; that topic has employed much abler pens. Suffice it to mention, that I have ſelected for this grammar as clear a ſet of rules, and given it as comprehenſive an arrangement as I could deviſe.

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deviſe. The taſk was rendered very laborious by the great multiplicity of obſervations I had collected, and by the freſh matter which continually occurred from my repeated applications to the Shanſcrit; of which language I have thought neceſſary to include within my deſign ſuch of the grammatical principles, as might throw a direct, or even a collateral light on thoſe of the Bengaleſe. To the curious and intelligent this will probably be the moſt intereſting part of the work; and I was willing to omit nothing that might tend to inſtruct or to convince. For this reaſon I have been ſcrupulouſly minute in the inſertion of examples to every rule, and prolix in my obſervations upon general grammar. The path which I have attempted to clear was never before trodden; it was neceſſary that I ſhould make my own choice of the courſe to be purſued, and of the landmarks to be ſet up for the guidance of future travellers. I wiſhed to obviate the recurrence of ſuch erroneous opinions as may have been formed by the few Europeans who have hitherto ſtudied the Bengaleſe; none of them have traced its connexion with the Shanſcrit, and therefore I conclude their ſyſtems muſt be imperfect. For if the Arabic language (as Mr. Jones has excellently obſerved) be ſo intimately blended with the Perſian as to render it impoſſible for the one to be accurately underſtood without a moderate knowledge of the other; with ſtill more propriety

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priety may we urge the impoſſibility of learning the Bengal dialect without a general and comprehenſive idea of the Shanſcrit: as the union of theſe two languages is more cloſe and more general; and as they bear an original relation and conſanguinity to each other, which cannot even be ſurmiſed with reſpect to the Arabic and Perſian.

When the learner has made ſome proficiency in the firſt rudiments, he cannot follow a more able or more expeditious guide than Mr. Jones: who in the preface to his Perſian Grammar has preſcribed an admirable ſyſtem of ſtudy, the utility of which is abundantly proved by the wonderful extent of his own attainments. By an adherence to his plan this language may ſoon be acquired ſo far as to open the way to converſation and ſhort correſpondence with the natives; after which the progreſs of knowledge will ever be proportionate to the aſſiduity of the ſtudent.

It may not be ſuperfluous in this place to remark. that a grammar of the pure Bengal dialect cannot be expected to convey a thorough idea of the modern jargon of the kingdom. The many political revolutions it has ſuſtained, have greatly impaired the ſimplicity of its language; and a long communication with men of different Religions, countries and manners has rendered foreign words in ſome degree familiar to a Bengal ear.

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ear. The Mahometans have for the moſt part introduced ſuch terms as relate to the functions of their own Religion, or the excerciſe of their own laws and government; the Portugueſe have ſupplied them with appellations of ſome European arts and inventions: and in the environs of each foreign colony the idiom of the native Bengaleſe is tinctured with that of the ſtrangers who have ſettled there.

Upon the ſame principle, ſince the influence of the Britiſh nation has ſuperſeded that of its former conquerors, many terms of Britiſh derivation have been naturalized into the Bengal vocabulary. For as the laws, the revenues and the commerce are gradually falling into new hands and are conducted by a new ſyſtem, new denominations will neceſſarily ariſe to the excluſion of the old. The force of this obſervation may particularly be proved from thoſe places in which the greateſt part of the India Company's inveſtment is provided; where a great number of the terms relating to trade are directly borrowed from the Engliſh. So in all the country Courts of Juſtice the words *Decree*, *Appeal*, *Warrant*, *Summons*, and many others are conſtantly applied and underſtood by the whole body of the people.

The following work preſents the Bengal language meerly as derived from its parent the Shanſcrit. In the courſe of my deſign I have avoided, with ſome care, the admiſſion of ſuch words

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words as are not natives of the country, and for that reaſon have ſelected all my inſtances from the moſt authentic and antient compoſitions. But I would adviſe every perſon who is deſirous to diſtinguiſh himſelf as an accurate tranſlator to pay ſome attention both to the Perſian and Hindoſtanic dialects; ſince in the occurrences of modern buſineſs, as managed by the preſent illiterate generation, he will find all his letters, repreſentations and accounts interſperſed with a variety of borrowed phrazes or unauthorized expreſſions. Such I hope have no place in theſe ſheets; and as I cannot be accuſed of interfering with the province of thoſe who may have illuſtrated either of the other dialects of India, ſo I may with confidence affirm that I have not been guided or aſſiſted in my reſearches by thoſe of any preceding Author. The errors and defects of this compilation are entirely my own; however copious they may be found, I have employed the moſt unwearied application to correct and expunge them: and if I have been in the ſmalleſt degree inſtrumental in attracting the attention of the curious, or in gratifying the taſte of the diſcerning, I hope ſo much will be allowed me in the oppoſite ſcale.

The public curioſity muſt be ſtrongly excited by the beautiful characters which are diſplayed in the following work: and although my attempt may be deemed incompleat or unworthy of notice,

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notice, the book itſelf will always bear an intrinſic value, from its containing as extraordinary an inſtance of mechanic abilities as has perhaps ever appeared. That the Bengal letter is very difficult to be imitated in ſteel will readily be allowed by every perſon who ſhall examine the intricacies of the ſtrokes, the unequal length and ſize of the characters, and the variety of their poſitions and combinations. It was no eaſy taſk to procure a writer accurate enough to prepare an alphabet of a ſimilar and proportionate body throughout, and with that ſymmetrical exactneſs which is neceſſary to the regularity and neatneſs of a fount. Mr. Bolts (who is ſuppoſed to be well verſed in this language) attempted to fabricate a ſet of types for it, with the aſſiſtance of the ableſt artiſts in London. But as he has egregiouſly failed in executing even the eaſieſt part, or primary alphabet, of which he has publiſhed a ſpecimen, there is no reaſon to ſuppoſe that his project when compleated, would have advanced beyond the uſual ſtate of imperfection to which new inventions are conſtantly expoſed.

The advice and even ſollicitation of the Governor General prevailed upon Mr. Wilkins, a gentleman who has been ſome years in the India Company's civil ſervice in Bengal, to undertake a ſet of Bengal types. He did, and his ſucceſs has exceeded every expectation. In a country ſo remote from all connexion with

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European artiſts, he has been obliged to charge himſelf with all the various occupations of the Metallurgiſt, the Engraver, the Founder and the Printer. To the merit of invention he was compelled to add the application of perſonal labour. With a rapidity unknown in Europe, he ſurmounted all the obſtacles which neceſſarily clog the firſt rudiments of a difficult art, as well as the diſadvantages of ſolitary experiment; and has thus ſingly on the firſt effort exhibited his work in a ſtate of perfection which in every part of the world has appeared to require the united improvements of different projectors, and the gradual poliſh of ſucceſſive ages.

The gentlemen at the head of Indian affairs do not want to be told of the various impoſitions and forgeries with which Bengal at preſent abounds, in Pottahs, (or Leaſes) in Bonds and other written ſecurities of property; in Rowanahs and Duſtucks, in Orders and Notices of government iſſued in the country languages; as well as in all the tranſactions of commerce: and alſo in the Proceſſes, Warrants and Decrees of the ſupreme and inferior Courts of Judicature; all of which afford ample ſcope for the exertion of Mr. Wilkins's ingenuity.

His ſucceſs in this branch has enabled Great Britain to introduce all the more ſolid advantages of European literature among a people whom ſhe has already reſcued from Aſiatic ſlavery,

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very: to promote the circulation of wealth, by giving new vigour and diſpatch to buſineſs, and to forward the progreſs of civil ſociety by facilitating the means of intercourſe.

Even the credit of the nation is intereſted in marking the progreſs of her conqueſts by a liberal communication of Arts and Sciences, rather than by the effuſion of blood: and policy requires that her new ſubjects ſhould as well feel the benefits, as the neceſſity of ſubmiſſion.

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ERRATA.

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Many of the errors which are here pointed out, have been reviſed in the preſs, before the whole impreſſion was worked off. Such of them as may yet remain, the reader is deſired to correct.

Errata in the Preface.

Page iv	*line*	9	*for* Caſhmeere	*read*	Caſhmeer.
v	—	laſt	— arriſing	—	ariſing.
xxi	—	9	— ſuperceded	—	ſuperſeded.
xxii	—	11	— illuſtraed	—	illuſtrated.
	—	21	— excited	—	attracted.

Errata in the Grammar.

3	—	9	— anamalous	—	anomalous.
10	—	7	— Chaam*roo*	—	Chaamroo.
	—	12	— indifferetly	—	indifferently.
	—	15	— ſ,haal*eeaa*	—	ſ,haal*eeyaa*.
19	—	4	— ſh*o*winy*o*	—	ſ*o*-iny*o*.
28	—	19	— রনঃ	—	নরঃ
30	—	19	— দুতীয়া	—	দুইতীয়া

33 — 20 the figure রু *roo* ſtanding for ব্রু or r, with the ſhort *oo*, is omitted by miſtake.

36	—	14	— Thucydides	—	Pherecydes.
39	—	1	— কেনো	—	কেন

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Page 48 *line* 17 *for* হরিন *read* হরিনা

69 — 18 — রথি — রথী

78 — 12&13 muſt be tranſpoſed for lines 11 & 12, as the example relates to the uſage of the 6th caſe of the Shanſcrit pronoun মম *my* or *mine*.

84 — 12 after *other* inſert *rule*.

88 — 1 *for* third read ſecond.

109 — 10 — ঈকুবীর — ঈকুবের the poſ-
[ſeſſive caſe of ঈকু

123 — 1 — করয়েজি জ্ঞাসা — করয়ে জিজ্ঞাসা

143 — 4 — Maahaa — Mohaa.

146 — 14 — শুমিন — শুমান

147 — 9 inſtead of the word there uſed, ſupply রাজি *a ſinging man*, রাজী *a ſinging woman*.

Eraſe the lines 11, 12, 13 & 14. The example therein quoted is inſerted by miſtake: it relates to another article and is applied elſewhere.

line 16 *for* aſſume *read* aſſume.

— 18 — খুম্বু — খুম্বু and the
[ſame in two places in the 20th line.

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Page 148	*line* 6	*for*	ভাগ্যমব	*read* ভাগ্যমন্ত
177	— 1	—	Put	— But.
192	— 6	—	third	— ſecond.

As the letters জ and য—শ and স are convertible in Bengaleſe, the reader muſt not be ſurpriſed that I have uſed either of them in the ſame word indiſcriminately: A knowledge of their true application belongs only to the Shanſcrit, and will be of no uſe whatever in reading the popular dialect of Bengal.

ADDITIONS.

Page the 10th line the laſt ——— When two vowels come together, of which the latter is ই the letter ক্ত is ſometimes inſerted between them, with only a very ſlight naſal utterance; as তুক্তি for তুই গোসাক্তি for গোসাই &c. pronounced *too-ee* and goſaa-*ee* in both modes of ſpelling.

Page 121ſt at the top —— Sometimes verbs which have এ or ও in the firſt ſyllable of their infinitive, change them into ই and উ in their inflected ſtate; as মেষন *to mix*, আমি মিষি তোলন *to weigh*, আমি তুলি &c.

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ADVERTISEMENT.

It is recommended not to bind this book till the ſetting in of the dry ſeaſon, as the greateſt part has been printed during the rains.

The Bookbinder is deſired to place the plate facing page 209.

A GRAMMAR

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Bayerische Staatsbibliothek MÜNCHEN

A GRAMMAR OF THE BENGAL LANGUAGE.

CHAPTER I.

OF THE ELEMENTS.

IT is a general, but erroneous observation, that oriental languages are written and read from the right hand to the left; whereas all the languages most truly oriental, or such as properly belong to the whole continent of India, proceed from left to

A right

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right like thoſe of Europe. The Arabic and the Perſian are the grand ſources from whence the contrary method has been derived; and with theſe the very numerous original dialects of Hindoſtan have not the ſmalleſt connection or reſemblance.

The Natives of Bengal write with a certain ſlender and tough reed, very common in all the Eaſt; which they ſhape almoſt like an European pen. They write with the hand cloſed, in which they hold the pen, as the Chineſe do their writing pencil, preſſing it againſt the ball of the thumb with the tip of the middle finger. The nib or point of the pen is turned downwards towards the wriſt; while the thumb pointing upwards, and lying on the pen with its whole length keeps it firm againſt the middle joint of the fore finger.

As they have neither chairs nor tables, their poſture in writing is very different from ours: They ſit upon their heels, or ſometimes upon their hams; while their left hand held open ſerves as a deſk whereon to lay the paper on which they write, which is kept in its place by the thumb: ſo that they never write on a large ſheet of paper without folding it down to a very ſmall ſurface.

The

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The great number of letters, the complex mode of combination, and the difficulty of pronunciation are conſiderable impediments to the ſtudy of the Bengal language; and the careleſſneſs and ignorance of the people have much aggravated the inconvenience by the univerſal inaccuracy of their writings: Into which they introduce ſo many anamalous characters, and ſo frequently deviate from the original forms, that they ſeldom can read each others hand-writing without heſitation and interruption. Many of theſe ſpurious characters are now almoſt naturalized into the language, by long uſe, and the hurry of buſineſs: for which reaſon I have given in the Appendix ſpecimens of the moſt common.

The Shanſcrit, or ſacred language of Hindoſtan, from whence the dialect of Bengal immediately proceeds, is ſuppoſed by its profeſſors to be the moſt antient and moſt excellent in the world. They aſſert that it exceeds every other language in the number of its letters, and eſteem this exceſs as an incontrovertible argument of its antiquity and ſuperiority.

The Bengal Alphabet, like that of the Shanſcrit, conſiſts of

FIFTY

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FIFTY letters, in the following order.

First Series.

অ o	আ aa	ই ee	ঈ ee
উ oo	ঊ oo	ঋ ree	ৠ ree
ঌ lee	ৡ lree	এ a	ঐ i
ও o	ঔ ou	ং ung	ঃ oh

Second Series.

ক ko	খ k,ho	গ go	ঘ g,ho	ঙ ngoo-o
চ cho	ছ ch,ho	জ jo	ঝ j,ho	ঞ gnee-o
ট ta	ঠ t,ho	ড do	ঢ d,ho	ণ aano
ত to	থ t,ho	দ do	ধ d,ho	ন no
প po	ফ p,ho	ব bo	ভ b,ho	ম mo
য jo	র ro	ল lo	ব wo	——
শ sho	ষ sho	স so	হ ho	ক্ষ khy-o

It

It is uſual with the Natives, whoſe example I ſhall partly follow, to defer all explanation of the firſt ſixteen letters of the alphabet, until they have thoroughly inſtructed their pupils in the nature and uſe of the ſubſequent conſonants. The reaſon of which is evident: for as every conſonant is made to include in itſelf the ſhort vowel neceſſary to its enunciation, the firſt thing requiſite, is to account for this circumſtance, and to ſhew how the character which ſhould denote this ſhort vowel may be omitted without prejudice to perſpicuity and orthography.

The firſt elements of every ſcience muſt be plain, ſimple and eaſy of perception: but more particularly thoſe of letters; which, as they are generally taught in the early period of life, ſhould be diveſted of every ſuperfluity that may diſtract the attention, or clog the memory. This conſideration ſeems to have been altogether overlooked in the elements of our own language, where we call the figure C, *ſee*: and yet for the ſound *ka*, we write CA. In the ſame manner G is pronounced ſoft like J in our alphabet; although the hard ſound of *Gamma* prevails in more than the proportion of four to five in its application. H, we denominate *aitch*, which does not ſuggeſt the moſt diſtant idea of an aſpirate. To the letter Y we have affixed a name, which denotes neither the vowel

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vowel, nor the conſonant: W is defined from its form only, not from its uſe; and Z *zad*, or *izard* is an appellation equally uſeleſs and unintelligible. The conſequences of this perplexed ſyſtem are doubt, error and delay. In the languages of India theſe difficulties are greatly avoided, by giving to each ſeparate conſonant the ſame preciſe pronunciation in the alphabet, which it ever bears in compoſition; and by annexing to it the imperfect vocal ſound which every attempt at utterance muſt neceſſarily produce.

It is to be obſerved, that in the Bengal alphabet, all the names of the conſonants commence with the reſpective conſonants which they denote; as *ko*, *go*, *jo*, &c. Whereas in Engliſh, ſeven of them are preceded by a vowel: *ef*, *el*, *em*, *en*, *ar*, *eſs*, & *ex*. It follows from hence, that the ſhort vowel of the Bengaleſe is invariably ſubjoined to the conſonant with which it is uttered, and never precedes: as ক and গ always ſtand for k*o*, and g*o*, and in no caſe for *o*k, or *o*g.

Moſt of the Oriental languages are conſtructed upon the ſame principle, with reſpect to the omiſſion of the ſhort vowel. The Hebrew had no ſign to expreſs it before the invention of the Maſoretic points. In Arabic it is rarely inſerted, unleſs upon very ſolemn occaſions, as in the *Koran*. In the modern Perſian it is univer-

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univerſally omitted: ſo to all the conſonants in the Shanſcrit language this ſhort vowel is an invariable appendage, and is never ſignified by any diacritical mark: but where the conſtruction requires that the vowel ſhould be dropped, a particular ſtroke is ſet under the letter, to regulate the pronunciation; a nicety, to which the inaccuracy of the Bengaleſe has not yet given place.

This inſeparable ſhort vowel is differently uttered in different languages, according to the genius of each; and perhaps in ſome degree to the organs of ſpeech in the various nations by which it is uſed. In the Shanſcrit it is called *Soor*, (or utterance) and throughout Hindoſtan has the ſound of the ſhort *e* of the French. In Arabic it is denominated *Futtah*, (or open) becauſe the conſonant to which it is added, ſtands open to the ſucceeding letter; and is ſignified by a ſhort line over the conſonant. This *futtah*, or *fatha*, is generally expreſſed in European languages by the ſhort *a*; but in utterance much more reſembles our *u* in *butter*. The Perſians call this vowel *Zeber*, (or above) on account of its poſition, which is the ſame as in the Arabic; and with them it has the ſound of *e* in *yes*; but in Bengal, where a very guttural accent prevails, it has a more open and broad tone, like the ſecond *o* in the word *chocolate*: as ক ko, গ go &c.

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The arrangement of conſonants in this alphabet has a particularity, which I do not remember to have met with in any languages, but thoſe proper to India: namely, that it is compoſed with a kind of regularity approaching to metrical exactneſs, which renders it peculiarly eaſy to the memory. Thus in the ſeries of conſonants beginning with the letter ক ko, an evident rythm is formed by the alternate ſucceſſion of the ſimple and aſpirated letters; and a cadence is introduced after each fourth, by the intervening naſal. In the latter part of the ſeries this naſal is omitted after the letter ব wo: but in recital, a reſt or pauſe is obſerved, to make up for the deficiency.

I muſt here inform the reader, that the vowels as uſed in compoſition, when joined with conſonants, have a very different figure from thoſe, which he will have obſerved in the firſt ſeries of the alphabet. Not to anticipate a general account of the preciſe ſound, and nature of them, I ſhall here inſert a table of the forms of vowels in compoſition, correſponding to thoſe which are initial or ſingle; that the learner may not be at a loſs to read ſuch examples as immediately occur.

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A TABLE of the correſponding Vowels.

অ o	ক ko (the included vowel)		
আ aa	কা kaa	এ a	কে ka
ই ee	কি kee	ঐ i	কৈ ki or ko-i
ঈ ee	কী kee	ও o	কো ko
উ oo	কু koo	ঔ ou	কৌ kou
ঊ oo	কূ koo	অং ung	কং kung
	অঃ oh	কঃ koh	

ক ko, has the ſound of *k*; as করন koron to do.

খ k,ho, the ſame *k* aſpirated: as মাখন maak,hon butter.

গ go, is pronounced like *g* hard; as গমন gomon to go.

ঘ g,ho, the ſame *g* followed by an aſpirate, diſtinctly uttered. We have no ſound in Engliſh that reſembles it, but in ſeparate words; one ending with *g*, the next commencing with *h*, as in *tug-hard*. In this manner is pronounced ঘর g,hor a houſe.

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ঙ ngoo-o This letter, when pronounced in the alphabet, has a ſtrong naſal ſound like *nd* in the french word *quand*. It is never found but in words of Shanſcrit origin, and then is conſtantly compounded with ſome other letter; and has the ſound of *un*,' or *ung*, as in ঙ্ক unko ,compoſed of ঙ ngoo-o and ক ko in the word শঙ্কর ſhunkor a proper name.

চ cho, the ſoft *ch* in *charge*: as চামর chaamroo a proper name. It alſo frequently bears the ſound of *ſ* ſtrongly uttered; as in চলন pronounced indifferetly cholon or ſolon to go.

ছ ch,ho, is the ſame letter aſpirated; but in common diſcourſe it is univerſally pronounced like *ſh* in the word *diſ-hearten*; as ছালিয়া ſ-haaleeaa a ſon.

জ jo, pronounced indiscriminately like j or z; as জাব jaabo I will go; হাজার haazaar a thouſand.

ঝ j,ho' is the former letter aſpirated; as বুঝন booj,hon to underſtand.

ঞ gneeo, the ſecond naſal letter, never uſed but in Shanſcrit words, and in a compound form; when it bears a ſound approaching to *n* preceded by a naſal *g*; as পিঞ্জীরা peegnjeeraa a birdcage.

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ট to, the letter *t*, with a cloſe, thick or obtuſe ſound, produced by turning the tip of the tongue upwards to the roof of the mouth; as টাকা taakaa a Rupee.

ঠ t,ho, the ſame letter followed by a diſtinct aſpirate like the *th* in *ſweet-heart*; as ঠাকুর t,haak*oor* properly, a Deity, but uſed as a term of reſpect and adoration.

ড do, *d* with the tongue inverted upwards, as in the preceding letters; as ডর dor fear. ডাকন daak*on* to call for. This letter has frequently the ſound of *r*, and ſhould then have a ſmall ſtroke under it, thus ড় as বড় bo*ro* large. But in the hurry of writing the diacritical mark is commonly omitted.

ঢ d,ho, the ſame *d* with a ſeparate aſpirate; as ঢাকা d,haakaa written and pronounced *Dacca*, by Europeans, the name of a City.

ণ aan*o*, the third naſal of the ſeries, with a ſound like *n*, as in আণ aan*o*, the name of the letter. Its uſe is confined to the Shanſcrit; and it is never diſtinguiſhed from ন no by the Bengaleſe; which it is made to reſemble both in form and ſound

as

as সন্তোষ *ſhontoſh* joy, pleaſure.

ত *to*, the common *t*, as তুমি *toomee* you.

থ t,h*o*, the ſame letter, with a ſeparate aſpirate, as থাকন t,haak*on* to be, to remain.

দ d*o*, the letter *d*; as দেখন dak,h*on* to ſee.

ধ d,h*o*, *d* with an aſpirate; as বোধ bod,h knowledge.

ন gn*o* or n*o*, the fourth in the order of naſals; as নারী naaree a woman.

প p*o*, the common *p*; as পলান p*o*laan*o* to run away.

ফ p,h*o*. In repeating the alphabet here explained, the aſpirate of this letter is uttered diſtinctly, and ſubſequent to the *p*, like *p-h* in the word *ſhip-head*: But in common diſcourſe it is uſually pronounced like *ph* in Philip; as ফল Phol fruit, ফুল phool a flower.

ব b*o*, has the ſound *b*; as বরিসন bor*ee*ſh*on* to rain.

ভ b,h*o*, the preceding letter with an aſpirate; as ভাল b,haal*o*

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b,haalo good.

ম gmo, or mo, the fifth nasal; but has the sound of *m* in common discourse; as মানুষ maanoosh a man.

য jo, has the sound of *j*; as যুগল joogol a proper name. The same character with a stroke under it thus য় becomes the consonant *y*; as শয়ন shoyon accumbency, গিয়া geeyaa having gone. When য় yo follows a vowel or an open consonant at the end of a word, it drops its own included vowel, and forms a kind of diphthong with the preceding vowel; as in the English word boy: thus ভয় b,hoy fear, জায় jaay he goes &c.

র র ro, is distinguished from ব bo either by a stroke across or dot beneath it; as রাখন raak,hon to place.

ল ল lo, two forms of *l*, as বল bol strength. This letter in the common corrupted writing of modern Bengalese is usually confounded with ন no in shape; and not unfrequently in sound: an example of which may be seen in the explanation of the next letter.

ব wo, in the Shanscrit language is always used with the sound

ſound of *w*; but in the Bengaleſe it is never diſtinguiſhed from ব bo either in form or utterance. The word *nabob*, ſtrictly ſpeaking, is novaab or nowaab. In Perſian it is written نواب *navaub* with a و *vau*, and in Bengaleſe নবাব the ſecond letter in the word being a wo; but by the Natives it is indifferently pronounced nobaab, *novaab*, and *lovaab*; as they generally confound ন no and ন lo, ব bo and ব wo. ব wa, when ſubjoined to another conſonant, is by the Bengaleſe improperly pronounced *oo*; as দ্ব doo, প্ব poo, শ্ব ſhoo, &c. compounded of দ do and ব wo, প po and ব wo, শ ſho and ব wo.

শ ſho, ষ ſho, and স ſo. The compilers of Shanſcrit grammars have been no leſs ſtudious, than were the ancient Greeks in analyzing the elementary ſound of their ſeveral letters, and in diſtributing them agreeably to the ſeveral organs by which they are uttered. Thus they have a claſs of *kungtee* or gutturals, of *taaloopee* or palatials, of *duntee* or dentals, of *ooſhtaanee* or labials, and of *naaſikaa* or naſals. They have even gone further, and allotted certain ſounds to the region of the brain; of theſe there are four: ঋ ree, ট to, ড় ro, and ষ ſho; which are called *moordhence* or cerebrals.

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I believe no other language ever contained a ſubdiviſion of the ſimple ſound expreſſed by *ſh*, but by the writers of Shanſcrit শ *ſho* is ranked under the cerebrals, ষ *ſho* belongs to the palate, and স *ſo* is a dental. Theſe letters are by no means interchangeable in the original dialect; but each has its own office, and peculiar uſage. The modern Bengaleſe, equally careleſs and ignorant of all arts but thoſe of gain, indiſcriminately give the ſound of *ſh* to each of the three characters, and apply them indifferently, as chance or caprice directs; ſo that there is no poſſible difference to be obſerved in their pronunciation of শ *ſho* and ষ *ſho*, in the word বিশেষ *beeſhaſh* increaſe; nor in that of স *ſo* and ষ *ſho* in আশ্বাষ *aaſhwaaſh* reliance: they would indifferently write শুনন or সুনন *ſhoonon*, to hear; and ſo in other words: But ষ *ſho*, they generally confine to the middle or end of a word, and ſeldom uſe it is as an initial.

The rules which the Indian grammarians have laid down for the meer orthography of the Shanſcrit language would fill a volume; but as few or none of theſe are obſerved in the Bengal dialect, I have only taken notice of ſuch as have ſome ſingularity to render them curious, or which are peculiarly characteriſtic of this ancient idiom.

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হ ho, a ſtrong aſpirate; as হাহাকার haahaakaar lamentation.

ক্ষ khyo, is a compound character added to the ſett meerly to make the number of letters even, and the rythm of the alphabet compact; as there are but forty nine characters truly ſimple and elementary. ক্ষ is derived from a junction of the two letters ক ko, and ষ ſho; which having a very harſh ſound in combination, are ſoftened into ক্ষ khyo. This letter when tranſpoſed into the Perſian character, is frequently rendered by چ *che*, which is a collateral proof of its origin: Thus for khyo*tree* (one of the four primary Hindoo tribes) the Perſians ſubſtitute *chetree*, লক্ষ্মী lokhymee a proper name, they write *lechmee*: And if we were to give to ক্ষ khyo, its original ſound of *kſh*, there would be but little difference between le*ch*mee and le*kſh*mee. This letter is not much uſed by the modern Bengaleſe, and is confined to Shanſcrit words; as পরীক্ষা poreekhyaa trial by ordeal.

I have already mentioned, that by the original ſtructure of this language every conſonant inherently poſſeſſes the ſhort vowel on which its utterance depends; it is plain therefore on this

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this principle, that no two conſonants could have been joined together, and ſucceſſively pronounced in the ſame ſyllable; but that a vowel muſt neceſſarily have intervened. As an expedient to remedy this inconvenience, a ſet of diſtinct characters were invented, called ফলা P,holaa, or adjuncts. They are certain ſubordinate and ſubſidiary figures, that may be attached to each of the conſonants in the alphabet reſpectively, to provide againſt the too frequent recurrence of the internal vowel.

Theſe *P,holaa*, are preſented in a diſtinct ſeries or alphabet, conſiſting of eleven ſubſervient marks or ſigns, for different letters; which are here joined to ক ko, the firſt of the ſingle conſonants, and which may, in the ſame manner, be applied to all the other letters.

The twelfth word of the ſeries, (which ſeems to be added by the Bengaleſe meerly to fill up the rythm) relates to another ſubject, which will be explained in a ſubſequent remark.

The reader muſt remember, that the letter র ro, in its proper character, is never joined to any other letter or adjunct; but its figure is entirely changed by a connection with other conſonants, as will be ſeen in the following ſeries.

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The twelve P, HOLAAS.

Figure	Name	Power
ক্য	ky-*o*	ky-*o*
ক্র	k*o*r*o*	kr*o*
ক্ন	k*o*n*o*	kn*o*
ক্ল	k*o*l*o*	kl*o*
ক্ব	koo-*o*	kw*o*, or ſometimes koo.
ক্ম	k*o*m*o*	km*o*
ক্রি	kirr*ee*	kr*ee*
ক্লি	kill*ee*	kl*ee*
র্ক	ark*o*	rk*o*
ঙ্ক	ungk*o*	ungk*o*
ক্ষ	aſhk*o*	ſhk*o*
সিদ্ধি	ſh*ee*dd,h*ee*	———

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Theſe *P,holaas* may be comprehended by the following explanation:

ক্য kyo, is the letter য় yo added to ক ko, or any other conſonant; as বাক্য baakyo a word, সৈন্য ſhowinyo an army.

ক্র kro, is র ro ſubjoined to ক ko, or any other conſonant; as ক্রোধ krod,h anger, প্রথম prot,hom firſt.

ক্ন kno, in this figure ন no is joined to any other letter; as বিঘ্ন beeg,hno a calamity.

ক্ল klo, is ল lo added to any letter of the alphabet; as আম্ল aamlo acid.

ক্ব kwo, is ব wo added to another conſonant; as দ্বিতিয়া dweeteeyaa ſecond; নিশ্বাস neeſhwaaſh breath: But it is frequently pronounced *oo*, and confounded with the vowel ু *oo* in its compound ſtate; as they write দ্বই for দুই doo-ee two, শ্বনন for শুনন ſhoonon to hear.

ক্ম kmo, ম mo ſubjoined to any conſonant; as জন্ম jonmo birth.

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birth.

ক্রি kree, is the mixt letter ি ree in compoſition with any conſonant; as ক্রিষ্ণ kreeſhno the name of a Hindoo Deity. নৃপ nreepo a Prince.

ক্লি klee, the mixt letter ি lee ſubjoined to a conſonant.

র্ক arko, is র ro prefixed to a conſonant; as দর্পন dorpon a mirror. Ignorant writers erroneouſly double the letter to which this *arko Pholaa* is affixed; as আশীর্ব্বাদ for আশীর্বাদ aaſheerbaad prayer.

The Bengaleſe uſually tranſcribe all the *P,holaas* at length, as connected ſeverally with each of the conſonants; to make them more readily comprehended, and more eaſily retained. As I am not writing to children, this trouble would be unneceſſary, and ſuperfluous; and I ſhall content myſelf with conciſe remarks upon ſuch as are difficult, or anomalous.

The *P,holaa* ঙ ungko is compoſed of the ſeveral naſals prefixed in their order to their reſpective conſonants, each to thoſe of its own ſeries; and where the chain is interrupted, the letter ঙ *ngoo-o* ſupplies the deficiency.

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The *P,holaa* ঙ্ক *ungko* compleat.

ঙ্কো	ঙ্খো	ঙ্গো	ঙ্ঘো	ঙ্ঙো
ungko	ungk,ho	ungo	ung,ho	ung-*oo-o*
ঙ্চো	ঙ্ছো	ঙ্জো	ঙ্ঝো	ঙ্ঞো
ungcho	ungch,ho	ungjo	ungj,ho	ung-*ee-o*
ঙ্টো	ঙ্ঠো	ঙ্ডো	ঙ্ঢো	ঙ্ণো
ungto	ungt,ho	ungdo	ungd,ho	ung-aano
ঙ্তো	ঙ্থো	ঙ্দো	ঙ্ধো	ঙ্নো
ungto	ungt,ho	ungdo	ungd,ho	ungno
ঙ্পো	ঙ্ফো	ঙ্বো	ঙ্ভো	ঙ্মো
umpo	ump,ho	umbo	umb,ho	ummo
ঙ্যো	ঙ্রো	ঙ্লো	ঙ্ৱো	———
ungjo	ro	unglo	ungwo	
ঙ্শো	ঙ্ষো	ঙ্সো	ঙ্হো	ঙ্ক্ষো
ungsho	ungsho	ungso	ungho	ungkhyo

Examples; শঙ্কা shungkaa fear, চিন্তন cheenton to conſider, কম্বল kumbol a blanket &c. ঞ্চ ungcho is more frequently written in a contracted character, thus; ঞ্চ as পঞ্চানন punchaanon the title of a Hindoo Deity; literally the God with five faces. কার্য্যজ্ঞ kaarjjunclo affairs.

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The *P,holaa* ্ষ্ক aſhko ſeems calculated to ſhew the ſeveral changes of ষ ſho according to the different conſonants with which it happens to come in contact. I ſhall give this *P,holaa* alſo compleat.

ষ্ক	ষ্ক্ষ	ষ্গ	ষ্গ্ধ	ষ্ঙ্ক্ত
*a*ſhk*o*	*a*ſhk,h*o*	*a*dg*o*	*a*dg,h*o*	ungtr*o*
ষ্চ	ষ্চ্ছ	ষ্জ্য	ষ্জ্ঝ	ষ্জ্ঞ
*a*ſch*o*	*a*ſch,h*o*	*a*bj*o*	*a*bj,h*o*	*a*ggy*o*
ষ্ট্ম	ষ্ট্ম্য	ষ্ড্য	ষ্ঢ্য	ষ্ণ্য
*a*ſht*o*	*a*ſht,h*o*	*a*bd*o*	*a*bd,h*o*	*a*haan*o*
ষ্ত	ষ্ত্য	ষ্দ্য	ষ্দ্ধ্য	ষ্ন্য
*a*ſt*o*	*a*ſt,h*o*	*a*bd*o*	*a*bd,h*o*	*a*hungn*o*
ষ্প্য	ষ্প্য	ষ্ব্য	ষ্ভ্য	ষ্ম্য
*a*ſhp*o*	*a*ſhp,h*o*	*a*db*o*	*a*db,h*o*	*a*hm*o*
ষ্হ্য	ষ্র	ষ্ল্য	ষ্ব্য	
*a*hj*o*	r*o*	*a*hl*o*	*a*hb*o*	
ষ্ট্স্য	ষ্ট্স্য	ষ্ট্স্য	ষ্ট্স্য	ষ্ট্স্য
*a*tſh*o*	*a*tſh*o*	*a*tſ*o*	*a*th*o*	*a*tkhy*o*

Excluſive of theſe ſeveral *P,holaas* which have been explained above, almoſt any two or three conſonants may be blended together,

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gether, to provide for the omiſſion of the intervening vowels. In the Shanſcrit language their ſeveral forms eaſily unite and run together, to make one compound letter; like two drops of quickſilver upon approximation. The rules for the proper formation of theſe mixt characters, which ſhew how to remove occaſionally ſuch as are not compatible, and to ſupply their places with others that admit an union, occupy a conſiderable part of the Shanſcrit grammar; but are never attended to by the illiterate and careleſs race of modern Bengaleſe: by whom propriety of diction and orthography is not even conſidered as an accompliſhment.

The compound letters may be formed by three methods: either by placing one letter immediately under another; as দম্ভ *domb,h* cunning; or by blending two letters together, ſo as to make one character from their union; as বিদ্যা *beedyaa* a proper name; or by making the firſt of the two conſonants much ſmaller than the other letters; as কম্পবান *kompowaan* trembling. This laſt mode ſeems to be the moſt common.

সিদ্ধি *ſheedd,hee*, called the twelfth *P,holaa*, is a word always prefixed to the claſs of vowels contained in the firſt Series of the alphabet, page the fourth. *ſheedd,hee* is part of a Shanſcrit ſentence

tence সিদ্ধি রস্তু ſheedd,hee roſtco, which means *be it properly performed.* And as theſe words are uſually prefixed to the claſs of vowels, that ſeries has obtained the name of *ſheedd,hee.*

The SERIES সিদ্ধি Sheedd,hee.

সি	দ্ধি	র	স্তু
ſhee	dd,hee	ro	ſtoo
অ	আ	ই	ঈ
o	aa	ee	ee
উ	ঊ	ঋ	ৠ
oo	oo	ree	ree
ঌ	ঌ	এ	ঐ
lee	lee	a	i
ও	ঔ	অং	অঃ
o	ou	ung	oh

There cannot be a greater defect in the ſtructure of any language, than that the ſame letter or letters ſhould be applied to ſeveral different ſounds; and that a variety of different combinations of letters ſhould expreſs the ſame ſound. Theſe two circumſtances ſhould ſeem to comprehend almoſt all the poſſible faults

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faults in orthography, and yet are ſo common in the Engliſh language, that I have been exceedingly embarraſſed in the choice of letters to expreſs the ſound of the Bengal vowels; and am at laſt by no means ſatisfied with the ſelection.

But I am obliged to acquieſce in the application of the following vowels and diphthongs; of which, ſuch as are printed in Italic characters, are to be pronounced ſhort, and the reſt long: but the ſound to be given to the correſpondent long and ſhort vowels is preciſely the ſame; and differs only in meaſure, or time.

o aa ee oo a i o ou

o is generally to be pronounced like the ſecond *o* in chocolate; but ſometimes rather broader.

aa muſt have the ſound of *a* in *fal*ſe.

ee like *e* in h*e*, or *ee* in d*ee*p.

oo as *o* is ſounded in m*o*ve, or *oo* in t*oo*th.

a in every ſyllable where it occurs muſt conſtantly be pronounced like *a* in l*a*bour.

i is always to have the ſound of *i* in tr*i*al.

o is confined to the ſound of *o* in m*o*ſt.

ou muſt be pronounced like *ou* in h*ou*ſe.

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In the Series *ſheedd,hee*, which has been inſerted above, the characters ৠ *ree* and ৡ ree, ঌ *lee* and ঌ lee, ſeem to be of a mixed nature, as comprehending both a vowel and a conſonant: They are accordingly applied ſometimes in the one capacity, and ſometimes in the other. In the Series of *P,hokaas*, they held the place of conſonants, under the figures কৃ k*ree*, and ক্লৃ k*lee*. Here they are ranked among vowels, and not improperly, when it is conſidered, that each of them ſingly forms a perfect ſyllable, and cannot be connected, in the ſame ſyllable, with any vowel; which is directly oppoſite to the nature of a conſonant.

অ *o*, is always an initial letter, as অপমান *o*pomaan diſgrace. *NB.* This letter cannot poſſibly occur in the middle or at the end of a word, becauſe its place is ſupplied by the ſhort vowel included in the preceding conſonant; as for কঅরঅন k-*o*-r-*o*-n they write করন koron to do.

আ aa, is alſo initial; as আগে aaga before. For the reaſon above mentioned the অ *o*, or firſt part of this letter, is always dropped in the middle, or at the end of a word

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word after a conſonant; as *baap* a father is written বাপ্ and not বআপ

ই *ee*, as ইন্দ্র *eendor* the name of a Deity, দুই *dooee* two.

ঈ ee, the correſpondent long vowel.

উ *oo*, as উপর *oopor* above, বাউ baa-*oo* the air.

ঊ oo, the correſpondent long vowel; as উপরোধ *oopo-rod,h* compliment.

ঋ *ree*, as in ঋন *reen* a loan.

ৠ ree, its correſpondent long vowel; which never occurs in Bengaleſe.

ঌ *lee*, is never found but in Shanſcrit words, and in a compound ſtate; as ক্লপ্ত *kleepto* appointed.

ৡ lee, is ঌ *lee* doubled and pronounced long.

এ a, as এই a-*ee* this.

ঐ i, as in the Shanſcrit word ঐরাবত *iraabot* an elephant.

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ও o, as in যাওন jaaon to go.

ঔ ou, as in ঔষধ ouſhod,h medicine.

ং° ung, is of a compound ſpecies. In the Shanſcrit language it is called অনুস্বর *onoſwor*, and is there uſed as a ſubſtitute for the letter ম *mo*; but without its inherent vowel. The mixture of the vowel and conſonant is here eaſily diſcoverable; as the ſhort অ *o* is added only to mark that it begins the ſyllable. When a conſonant has the firſt place, the dot only is retained of ung; while the inherent vowel ſupplies the place of অ *o*; as ব°শী bungſhee a flute.

ঃ *oh*, the laſt figure of this claſs, is called বিসর্গ weeſorg, and is marked by two dots, one at the top and one at the bottom of the line. In the Shanſcrit language it is a ſubſtitute for the letters র *ro* and স *ſo*, which are uſed in the terminations of particular forms of declenſion &c. It has no peculiar ſound or utterance; but gives a certain forcible pronounciation (almoſt like an aſpirate) to the vowel which is immediately before it; as নর *nere* man, রনঃ *nereh* a man, in the nominative caſe.

The

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This figure, as uſed in the Bengal language, has quite loſt its original property, and is applied indiſcriminately to any vowel at the end of a word, without even altering the tone or force of utterance; but ſometimes ſeems to ſerve for a mark to denote that the inherent vowel of the final conſonant is not to be dropped; as যাব jaabo I will go, might by miſtake be pronounced jaab, as it is now written; but when weeſorg is added thus, যাবঃ jaaboh, the latter vowel is marked beyond the poſſibility of omiſſion.

The connected vowels are given in the following Series, by the Bengaleſe called বানান baanaan, and in Shanſcrit দ্বাদশ মাত্রাঃ dwaadoſho maatraah the twelve marks, or ſigns.

NAME	FIGURE & POWER		NAME
okaar	ক ko	কা kaa	aakaar
hroſweekaar	কি kee	কী kee	deerg,heekaar
hroſookaar	কু koo	কূ koo	deerg,hookaar
akaar	কে ka	কৈ ki or koi	ikaar
okaar	কো ko	কৌ kou	oukaar
onoſwaar	কং kung	কঃ koh	weeſorgyo

The

The plain ſtroke to the left of the firſt কৃ ko is here put as the mark of the ſhort vowel inherent in the conſonants, but this is never uſed on any other occaſion. The ſtudent will obſerve, that altho' ſeveral of theſe ſhort vowels precede in poſition the conſonants to which they belong, yet in utterance they are ſubſequent, and hold the ſecond place in the ſyllable.

The word হ্রস্ব hroſwo ſignifies ſhort, and দীর্ঘ deergh, means long. The ſyllable কার kaar is always uſed to denote the names of vowels. Thus okaar means the vowel o, hroſweekaar the ſhort vowel *ee* &c.

To avoid the hiatus which would be occaſioned by two vowels coming together without an intervening conſonant, a conſonant homogeneous to the preceding vowel is to be inſerted between them, (as in the golden canons of the Arabic) or one of the vowels is changed into its correſponding conſonant.

য় yo is homogeneous to এ a, ই *ee*, and ঐ i.

ব wo is homogeneous to উ oo, ও o, and ঔ ou.

Thus they write গীয়া geeyaa for গীআ gee-aa having gone; for দুতীয়া doo-ceteeyaa ſecond muſt be written দ্বিতীয়া dweeteeyaa.

But

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But ই *ee* may *follow* every other vowel without the inſertion of a conſonant; as জাই jaa-*ee* I go, not জায়ি jaay*ee*; দুই doo-*ee* two, not দ্বি dw*ee* or দুবি doow*ee*, এই a-*ee* this, not এয়ি ay*ee*, ওই o-*ee* that, and not ওবি ow*ee*.

So অ *o* or আ aa may *precede* every vowel, except এ a, without the intervention of a conſonant; as বাও baa-*oo* the air; লিখিলাওঁ leek,heelaa-o I wrote, a corrupt form of tenſe, &c. But when এ a follows অ *o* or আ aa, it is always changed into য় y*o* without its inherent vowel; as in নয় no*y* is not, for নএ no-a, contracted from নহে no-ha; জায় jaay he goes, for জাএ jaa-a.

When the vowel ঐ i is connected with any conſonant, thus, কৈ that conſonant does not drop its own included vowel; as কৈল is to be pronounced ko-il*o* he did, বৈল bo-il*o* he ſpoke; where each vowel retains its own power diſtinct, which thus nearly give the ſound of quil*o*, bwil*o*.

In ſome caſes ই *ee* has the ſound and properties of ঐ i, when it ſtands next to an open conſonant, with which it does not coaleſce: thus the word হইল was, is pronounced hwil*o*, or

or ho-ilo; as if it had been written হৈল

In many caſes, where the vowel আ aa immediately follows ই *ee* in the ſame word, (as in the preterite participles ending in ইয়া *eeyaa*) ই *ee* is frequently changed into য় *yo*, and united with the preceding conſonant by the *kvo pholaa*; as চড়্যা choryaa for চড়িয়া choreeyaa having aſcended; ছাড়্যা ch,haaryaa for ছাড়িয়া ch,haareeyaa having deſerted.

I muſt here remind the reader, that the letter ব *wo* has entirely loſt its proper uſe and power, in modern Bengaleſe; and even where it occurs in words of Shanſcrit origin, is now univerſally pronounced like ব *bo*; as বচন *wochon* a word, is always bochon, with the Bengaleſe; অগ্নিবত ogneewot like fire, they call ogneebot: and ſo in all caſes whatſoever. This uſage has reduced them to the neceſſity of inſerting the vowel ও *o*, or ঙ *oo* wherever the ſound of W is to be preſerved: as for বালা they write ওয়ালা oyalaa; for খবা khawaa freight, they ſubſtitute খওয়া kha-oyaa and thus confuſe all derivation and orthography.

In addition to theſe remarks, I ſhall ſet down a few of the moſt

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the moſt common contractions of letters, which are conſtantly uſed by all the Bengaleſe, as being more expeditious, as well as more elegant than a ſimple junction of the ſingle letters, whoſe office they perform.

 kro, ſtands for the kirro *Pho'laa.*

 *okto*, is  *to* blended with  *ko*; its regular form is 

 *koo*, ſtands for  *ko* with hroſwookaar.

 ungo, is compounded of  ngoo-o with *go* ſubjoined.

 *oggyo*, is another figure for the *Pholaa* 

 *moo*, is  *mo* and  *wo* compounded. The ſimple form is 

 *o*ſhno, for  i.e. aan*o* ſubjoined to ſho.

 ſh*oo*, initial and medial,  ſh*oo*, final; two figures for 

 This figure ſtands for both *otto* and  t*oo*.

 g*oo*, is uſed for 

 h*oo*, ſtands for

 *o*hro, is kr*o* *Pholaa* ſubjoined to h*o*.

 tr*o*, ſtands for 

 roo, is uſed inſtead of 

 *o*hl*o*, is  l*o* ſubjoined to  h*o*.

 *o*ndo, compounded of  aan*o* and d*o*.

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হ্জ *ohjo*, is হ *ho* and য জ *jo* blended together.

হ্ম *ohmo*, a compound of হ *ho* and ম *mo*.

স্তু *oſtoo*, is স *ſo*, and ত *to*, with hroſwcokaar ſubjoined.

স্ত্র *oſtro*, is the letter স *ſo* compounded with ত *to*, and the kro *Pholaa*.

হ্রু *joo*, ſtands for জু

গ্ধ *ogd,ho*, দ্ধ *odd.ho*, ন্ধ *ond,ho*, repreſent ধ্ *d'ho* ſeverally ſubjoined to গ *go*, দ *do*, and ন *no*.

ৎ this figure is called অর্দ্ধত *ordd,ho-to*, i.e. *ſemi-to*; for *ordd,ho* ſignifies *half*. It is uſed for the letter ত *to* without its internal vowel; and in the middle of a word is generally repreſented by ২ the numerical figure of *two*; as in বৎসর *botſoro* a year.

ত্য *otyo*, is the preceding ৎ blended with the *kyo pholaa*.

I ſhall now proceed to a few marks of reference commonly uſed by the Bengaleſe.

৭ This figure is always put at the top of every writing, and is meant as an invocation to Gonaſh, the Deity of Knowledge and Arts; it is called গনেশের আকড়ি Gonaſhar aak*oree*, or the crook of *Gonaſh*. So the Mahometans always begin with the letter ا *aleph*, as a token of the unity of God.

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ঁ chaandb*oo*ndaa, is a mark put over certain letters to give them a very forcible naſal expreſſion; as বাঁস baas a bamboo, to be pronounced *baangs*, with the naſal ſtrongly uttered.

ঈ Eeſhw*o*r. ঈশ্বর is properly one of the Deities of the Hindoo Trinity. The name of God was ſuppoſed too holy to be inſerted among the general claſs of words, and was therefore written at the top of the Page, and wherever this name ſhould occur in a ſentence, the mark here ſpecified was put as a reference to it. The form ſtill remains, but the uſage is degraded into a meer compliment: for in all petitions, or letters from inferiors to their ſuperiors, the name of the perſon addreſſed is now put at the top, and this ſign of reference occupies the place in the body of the letter, where the name ſhould regularly have been inſerted.

শ্রী ſree properly ſignifies proſperity; and is prefixed to every name which they mean to mention with reſpect; as শ্রীশ্রী রাম ſree ſree Raam. শ্রীশ্রী গনেশ ſree ſree Gonaſh.

One or more of theſe Titles of Hindoo Deities is firſt written on every piece of paper, as an amulet or charm, before any letter petition or other writing whatever, is committed to it. In the ſame manner the Mahometans univerſally apply their *Biſmillah* (or, *In the name of God.*) as we formerly wrote *Emanuel* at the top

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top of letters, and ſtill continue to commence a Ledger with LAUS DEO.

I ſhall here inſert a ſhort ſpecimen of the Bengal language and character as an exerciſe for the learner. It is an Epiſode extracted from the Dron Porb, or fifth book of the Mohaabhaarot, the grand Epic Poem of India. Throughout this work I mean to confine myſelf to examples taken from Poetry only; as we are ſure, that Verſe muſt have coſt the author ſome time and ſtudy in the compoſition; and is therefore likely to be moſt conformable to the true genius and character of the language: and the regularity of the meaſure is a great check upon the ignorance, or careleſſneſs of the copyiſt.

I might obſerve, that Bengal is at preſent in the ſame ſtate with Greece before the time of Thucydides; when poetry was the only ſtyle to which authors applied themſelves, and ſtudied proſe was utterly unknown. Letters of buſineſs, petitions, public notifications, and all ſuch other concerns of common life are neceſſarily, and of courſe, written without meaſure or rythm: I might almoſt have added, without Grammar. But all the compilations dedicated to Religion, to Hiſtory and to Morality, and all ſuch works as are expected or intended to ſurvive the compoſer, are invariably written in Verſe; and it is probable no other ſtyle will ever be adopted.

মহা

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মহাভাৰতেৰ দ্রোনপৰ্ব্ব মধ্যে এক অধ্যায়

Mohaabaarotar dronporbbo mod,hya ak od,hyaayo

মুনিঃ বলে সুন পরিক্ষিতের তনয়।
জেমতে সাত্যেকি বীর হইল পরাজয়॥

Mocneeh bola focno Poreekhyeetar toncyo
Jamota Saatyokee beero ho-ilo poraajoyo

এক কালে বসুদেব পিতৃ শ্রাদ্ধ করে।
নিমন্ত্রিয়া ভ্রাতৃ বন্ধু আনে সভাকারে॥

Ak kaala Eofoodab peetree fhraaddho kora
Necmontreeyaa bhraatree bondhoo aana fobhaakaara

সোমদত্ত বাহ্লিক আদি আর পঞ্চানন।
সাল্ব শিশু আইল পাইয়া নিমন্ত্রন॥

Somdot Baahleek aadee aar Ponchaanon
Saaloo fheefhoo aaeelo paaeeyaa neemontron

আইল অনেক রাজা নাহয় গননে।
সভাকারে বসুদেব কৈল অভ্যর্থনে॥

Aaee'o onak Raaj a naahoy gonona
Sobhaakaara Eofoodab ko-ilo obhyort,hona

নানা

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নানা বিধি আসনে বসিলা রাজা গনে।
একে একে সভাকারে পুছিল কথনে॥

Naanaa beedhee aafona bofeelaa Raajaa gona
Aka aka fobhaakaara pooch,heelo kot,hona

বসুদেব খুড়া সেনী সাত্যেকির বাপ।
সোমদত্ত দেখি তবে বড় হইল তাপ॥

Bofoodab khooraa Sanee Saatyokeer baap
Somdott dakhee toba boro ho-ilo taap

ডাকিয়া বলিল সেনী সুন সোমদত্ত।
সভা মাঝে বৈস তুমি এ কোন মহত্ত॥

Daakeeyaa boleelo Sanee foono Somdott
Sobhaa maajha bo-ifo teomee a kon mohott

আমা সভা নামানিস কোন অহঙ্কারে।
পৃথিবির মধ্যে কেবা নাজানে তোমারে॥

Aamaa fobhaa naamaanees kon ohungkaara
Preet,heebeer modhya kabaa naajaana tomaara

মর্য্যদা

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মর্য্যদা থাকিতে কেনো নাজাহো ওচিয়া।
আপন সদৃশ স্থানে ওচি বৈস গিয়া॥

এত সুনি সোমদত্ত কোপেতে জ্বলিন।
অগ্নির ওপরে জেন ঘৃত ঢালি দিল॥

সোমদত্ত বলে সেনী নাকরিস গরব্ব।
তোমার মহিমা জত আমি জানি সরব্ব॥

কোন দোষে দোষী আমি কহত সত্তর।
এত কটু ভাসা মোরে কহিস বর্ব্বর॥

তোমা হইতে নিচ কেবা আছয়ে মানুষে।
মোর অগোচর নহে জানিয়ে বিশেষে॥

এতেক সুনিয়া সেনী অতি ক্রোধ মন।
কোপে ডাক দিয়া বলে সুন সরব্ব জন॥

এত অহঙ্কার হইল আরে শলাঙ্গার।
পরনিন্দা ছিদ্র নাহি চাহো আপনার॥

ইহার ওচিত ফল দিব আমি তোরে।
এত বলি কোপে সেনী ওচিল সত্তরে॥

সেনী

সেনী দেখি সোমদত্ত ধাইল তখন।
হুড়াহুড়ি মহা যুদ্ধ করে দুই জন॥

তবে সেনী মহা কোপে ধরে তার চুলে।
দেখিয়া হইল হাস্য জত সভা তলে॥

কেশে ধরি চড় মারে বজ্রের সমানে।
এক চড়ে দন্ত ভাঙ্গি করে খানে খানে॥

তবে সভে ধাই দহা নিবারন কৈল।
অভিমানে সোমদত্ত দেশেরে চলিল॥

সভা মধ্যে সোমদত্ত পাইয়া অভিমান।
তপস্যা করিতে বনে করিল পয়ান॥

দ্বাদশ বৎসর সেই কৈল অনাহারে।
এক চিত্তে সোমদত্ত সেবে মহেশ্বরে॥

তপস্যায় বস হইল দেব দিগম্বর।
বৃষভে চড়িয়া আইল বনের ভিতর॥

শিব বলে বর মাগ সুনহ রাজন।
এত বলি সোমদত্তে ডাকে পঞ্চানন॥

ধ্যান

ধ্যান ভাঙ্গি সোমদত্ত দেখিল মহেশ।
বিভূতি ভূষন অঙ্গ জটা ভার কেশ॥

আনন্দিত সোমদত্ত দেখিয়া চান্দরে।
বিবিধ পুকারে রাজা অতি স্তুতি করে॥

সোমদত্ত বলে যদি হইলা কৃপাবান।
এক নিবেদন আমি করি তোর স্থান॥

সভা মধ্যে সেনী মোরে অপমান কৈল।
জতেক ভূপতি গন বসিয়া দেখিল॥

অগ্নিবত অঙ্গে দহে সেই অপমান।
এই নিবেদন আমি করি তোর স্থান॥

যদি মোরে বর দিবা দেব পসুপতি।
মহা ধনুর্দ্ধর হউক আমার সন্ততি॥

তার পুত্রে মোর পুত্র জিনুক সমরে।
রাজা গন মধ্যে জেন অপমান করে॥

ইহা বিনু অন্য বর নাহি চাহি আমি।
এই বর মোরে দেব আজ্ঞা কর তুমি॥

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হর বলে বর দিলু সুনহ রাজন।
তোর পুত্র জিনিবেক সেনীর নন্দন॥

প্রানেতে মারিতে তারে নাহবে সকতি।
এত বলি অন্ত ধ্যান হইল পসুপতি।

স্নিব স্থানে সোমদত্ত পাইয়া এই বর।
আনন্দিত হইয়া গেল আপনার ঘর॥

শির বরে ভুরিশ্রবা সাত্যকি জিনিল।
তার উপক্ষন এই তোমারে কহিল॥

An Episode from the Mohaabhaarot.

Moonee ſaid, 'Hear, O ſon of Pureekhyeeto,

'How the hero Saatyckee was overcome.

'On a certain time Boſoodab celebrated his father's obſequies,

'And aſſembled all his Relations and Friends by invitation.

'Firſt Somdott and Baahleek, then Punchaanon;

'Saaloo alſo and Sheeſhoo were invited, and came.

'Every Raajaa attended, more than could be numbered,

'And

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'And Boſoodab reſpectfully ſaluted them.
'All theſe Raajaas he placed on various ſeats,
'And to each of them by turns addreſſed his diſcourſe.
'But Sanee, uncle to Boſoodab and father of Saatyokee,
'Was much enraged to behold Somdott among them.
'He called to him, and ſaid, "Hear O Somdott,
"What arrogance is it to ſeat yourſelf in this aſſembly!
"By what preſumption haſt thou forgotten to reſpect us?
"Who in all the world does not know thee?
"While your honour is yet ſafe, why do you not riſe and depart?
"Be gone, and ſeat thyſelf among thy Fellows."
'Hearing this, Somdott kindled with anger,
'Like oil when caſt upon the fire.
'And Somdott replied, "Vaunt not thyſelf, O Sanee!
"For I am acquainted with all thy excellence.
"With what crime am I defiled, tell me quickly,
"That thou holdeſt this violent diſcourſe with me, O Wretch!
"Who among men is of leſs account than thyſelf?
"Neither is this hidden from me; I know it well."
'Sanee when he had heard this was exceedingly enraged,
'And

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'And wrathfully exclaimed, "Hear him, O ye people!
"Art thou become thus inſolent, O refuſe of thy family!
"Whilſt thou deſpiſeſt others, knoweſt thou not thyſelf?
"Soon will I give thee the proper reward of ſuch conduct."
'Sanee hearing this, ſtarted up in a paſſion,
'And Somdo't when he beheld Sanee aroſe immediately,
'So that a deſperate ſtruggle enſued between them.
'Sanee in great fury ſeized him by the hair,
'At which a laugh circulated through the whole croud.
'He held his hair, and ſtruck him a blow like a thunderbolt,
'And with that ſingle ſtroke demoliſhed all his teeth.
'Then all the company got up and ſeparated them;
'Somdo't in confuſion retired to his own country.
'Somdott being thus diſgraced in the midſt of the aſſembly,
'Retreated into the deſarts to paſs his life in prayer.
'Twelve years he conſumed in prayer and faſting,
'In ſingleneſs of heart calling upon the great Deity.
'The naked God was ſatisfied with his mortifications,
'And mounting his Bull came into the deſart.
'Sheew ſaid "Hear, O Raajaa, demand of me ſome favour."
'In theſe words the Deity with five heads addreſſed Somdott.

'Somdott

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'Somdott ſtarting from his contemplation, beheld the Deity,
'Whoſe body was covered with holy aſhes, and his hair clotted in a thouſand knots.
'Somdott was much elated to behold the Divinity,
'And humbled himſelf before him with the moſt reverential ſalutations.
'Then Somdott ſaid, "If You will really be my protector,
"Permit me to offer you a ſingle requeſt:
"Sanee has diſgraced me in a numerous company,
"And all the monarchs who ſate there beheld my misfortune.
"My body burnt like fire at the ignominious uſage:
"And therefore I humbly preſent this petition.
"If, O Lord of life, you mean to fulfill my wiſh,
"Grant that my ſon become a mighty warrior.
"Let my ſon conquer his ſon in battle;
"As He put me to ſhame in the midſt of the Raajaas.
"Except this, I have no boon to demand ——
"Beſtow this, O God! my only requeſt."
'The Deity anſwered "Hear O Raajaa, the favour is granted.
"Thy ſon ſhall overcome the ſon of Sanee;
"But his life it will not be permitted him to deſtroy."
'Thus

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'Thus ſpoke the Lord of life, and vaniſhed.

'Somdott having received this favour from the Eternal,

'Returned exulting to his own family.

'Thus by the help of the great Deity, Bhooreeſhrobaa vanquiſhed Saatyokee.

'And this hath explained to you the circumſtances of his fall.

CHAPTER II.

Of Substantives.

Genders are the firſt attribute of ſubſtantives, and are uſually divided into three claſſes; the maſculine, the feminine and the neuter; under which are included the ſubordinate and compound genders. In the Shanſcrit language (equally refined with either the Arabic or the Greek) theſe three diſtinctions are preſerved in their common number and order.

পুংলিঙ্গ poongleengo is the maſculine,

স্ত্রীলিঙ্গ ſtreeleengo the feminine, and

নপুংসক nopoongſoko, or ক্লীবলিঙ্গ kleewoleengo the neuter.

The Authors of this threefold diviſion of genders and of their pre-

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precedence, appear to have conſidered the neuter as a kind of *reſiduum* reſulting from the two others, and as leſs worthy or leſs comprehenſive than either: but this doctrine is liable to ſome objections. For the neuter (or that order of ſubſtantives defined by this term) ſeems to be of a more extenſive quality and power than the reſt; in ſo much that I ſhould hardly ſcruple to call it a genus, of which the maſculine and feminine are but the ſpecies. For from the whole claſs of ſubſtantives, ſome are ſelected to be maſculines, and others to be feminines; and all which are not thus ſpecified, remain as the others were previous to their ſelection, *neuter*.

In Latin and Greek we find many unaccountable refinements of gender, or rather unmeaning applications of a diſtinction without a difference. It would baffle the moſt able grammarian to aſſign a ſatisfactory reaſon why *pecus pecoris* ſhould be neuter, and *pecus pecudis* feminine; and ſo of a thouſand others. Common ſenſe requires that all general terms ſhould avoid ſuch diſcriminations; and we certainly muſt allow the conſtruction of thoſe languages to be moſt rational, in which *flocks* and *herds* are of no gender, but include animals of both. In the ſame manner when individuals are mentioned indefinitely, it is abſurd to ſpecify the ſex. We ſee an animal at a diſtance; muſt

we

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we know whether it be a he-goat or a ſhe-goat, before we venture to pronounce that it is a *goat*? Yet this knowledge muſt be pre-ſuppoſed in Greek and Latin, or it muſt be granted that the gender is there redundant and ſuperfluous.

The propoſition which I have here ſtarted is particularly connected with my preſent ſubject; becauſe in the Bengal language there is a great number of general neuter names of animals &c. to which may be added at pleaſure different terminations of ſpecification, ſubdividing the individuals of the claſs to which they refer, into the ſubordinate diſtinctions of male and female.

The terminations uſually applied upon this occaſion are, আ aa for the maſculine, and ঈ ee, or নী nee for the feminine: thus from বাঘ baagh, which ſignifies a tiger in general, are formed বাঘা baaghaa a (male) tiger, and বাঘনী baahgonee or বাঘী baaghee a tigreſs; from হরিন horeen a deer proceed হরিন horeenaa a buck, and হরিন্নী horeennee a doe.

If ঈ ee long terminates the maſculine, it is made ſhort before the ſign of the feminine; as হস্তী hoſtee an elephant, হস্তিনী hoſteenee a female elephant, সান্তিপুরী ſaanteepooree a man inhabiting Saanteepoor, সান্তিপুরিনী ſaanteepooreenee a woman

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woman of Saanteepoor.

It is not neceſſary that every noun comprehenſive of Sex ſhould be diſtinguiſhed by a particular termination, or mode of formation, expreſſly to denote its gender.

The Sex of human creatures, and the more general relations which they bear to each other, are of ſufficient conſequence to obtain different names, inſtead of modifications of the ſame name. Thus in almoſt all languages the diſtinctions of *man* and *woman*, *huſband* and *wife*, *father* and *mother*, &c. are ſignified by ſeparate terms. The ſame may commonly be ſaid of ſuch animals as are moſt connected with mankind: from hence *bull* and *cow*, *ram* and *ſheep*, *bear* and *ſow* &c. Thus in the Bengal language মানুষ maanoocho is a man স্ত্রী ſtree a woman পিতা peetaa a father, মাতা maataa a mother, পুরুষ poorooſho a huſband, নারী naaree a wife.

পুরুষ ছাড়িয়া নারী রহিবে কে মনে

poorooſho ch,haareeyaa naaree roheeba ka mona

"When the huſband is gone how ſhall the wife remain?"

upon the ſame principal আড়্যা aaryaa is a bull, and গাই gaaee a cow &c.

In other caſes different forms of the ſame word are applied to

diſtingui ſh the Sexes; and as all animals muſt be of one Sex, it is generally ſufficient that the feminine term only be marked by a proviſional inflexion: hence ছাগল ch,haagolo a he-goat ছাগলী ch,haagolee a ſhe-goat ভেড়া bharaa a ram, ভেড়ী bharee a ſheep কুক্কুড়া kookkooraa a cock কুক্কুড়ী kookkooree a hen; রাজহংস raajhungſo a gander রাজহংসী raajhungſee a gooſe.

টল টল করে জল মন্দ মন্দ বায়।
রাজহংস রাজহংসী খেলিয়া বেড়ায়॥

Tolo tolo kora jolo mondo mondo baay,
Raajhungſo raajhungſee khaleeyaa baraay.

"A ſoft breeze gently agitates the water,
"The gander and the gooſe ſport and ſwim."

The ſame form occaſionally takes place even when human beings are concerned, in a local or confined relation; thus we uſe the word *Jew* in a collective ſenſe, comprehending the whole people; but to expreſs a woman of that nation we muſt add a ſexual termination; as *Jeweſs*: ſo ব্রাহ্মন braahmon ſignifies a *Bramin*, or in general any perſon of the braminical tribe; but ব্রাহ্মনী braahmonee a *Bramineſs*, or woman only of that Sect.

এত

এত সুনি রামকৃষ্ণ হাসিতে লাগিল।
ব্রাহ্মন ব্রাহ্মনীকে প্রবোধ করিল॥

Ato ſoonee Raamo*kreeſhno* haa*ſeeta laageelo*
Braahmon Braahmo*neeka* pro*bodho koreelo*
"Hearing this Ramkriſhen began to laugh
"And ſatisfied the Bramin and Brameneſs."

In all circumſtances of this nature, the reader will find in the Bengal language a wonderful reſemblance to the Engliſh idiom, and turn of expreſſion.

In Shanſcrit, as in Greek and Latin, the names of all things inanimate have different genders founded on vague and incomprehenſible diſtinctions: as if there could be any reaſon for making Ætna feminine, which would not equally hold good with reſpect to Veſuvius or Caucaſus. But this ſeems to be the natural conſequence of connecting the gender of a noun too intimately with its termination. Had all inanimate ſubſtantives in Greek and Latin wanted theſe ſexual refinements, the form allotted to the neuter would have increaſed beyond its due proportion, and the ear have been tired with the perpetual recurrence of ſimilar ſounds: but it is ſurely more conſiſtent with nature, to make every noun *neuter* which is not the name of ſomething

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thing neceſſarily *maſculine* or *feminine*: and this is an invariable rule in the dialect of Bengal.

Of Cases.

A Shanſcrit noun, on its firſt formation from the general Root, exiſts equally independant of caſe as of gender. It is neither *Nominative*, nor *Genitive*, nor *Accuſative*, nor is impreſſed with any of thoſe modifications, which mark the relation and connection between the ſeveral members of a ſentence. In this ſtate it is called an *imperfect* or *crude* noun. Thus রাজন Raajon means Monarch; but implies neither *a* Monarch, *of* a Monarch, *to* a Monarch, nor any other predicament in which a Monarch can be ſuppoſed to ſtand. To make a nominative of this word, the termination muſt be changed, and a new form ſupplied; as রাজা raajaa a King রানী raanee a Queen. Thus we ſee that in the Shanſcrit at leaſt, the nominative has an equal right with any other inflexion to be called a caſe.

Every Shanſcrit noun is capable of ſeven changes of inflexion, excluſive of the vocative: and therefore comprehends two more than even thoſe of the Latin. I ſhall here give a ſhort explanation of them, in the order which has been fixed for them

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them by their own grammarians.

1 The Nominative, or *agent* in a ſentence; as রাজা রাজ্যতি raajaa raajyotee a King governs.

2 The *Paſſive* caſe, or ſubject of the action; as দেব° নমি dawung nomee I worſhip God.

3 The *Cauſal* caſe, pointing out the cauſe *by* which a thing is done; as দেবেন কৃত° dawano kreetung, made *by* God; or the inſtrument *with* which it is done; as দাত্রেন ছিন্ন° daatrano ch,heennung cut *with* a knife: or the ſubject *in* or *by* which it is ſuffered; as অক্ষ্না কানঃ okhynaa kaanoh blind *of* an eye.

4 The Dative, with the ſign *to* or *for*; as দেবায় দত্ত° dawaayo dottung given *to* God, ধর্ম্মায় ভদ্র° dhormaayo bhodrung good *for* religion.

5 The Ablative, implying the ſubject *from* whence anything proceeds; as দেবাৎ প্রাপ্ত° dawaat praaptung received *from* God.

6 The *Poſſeſſive* caſe, called by us the Genitive; as দেবস্য গৃহ° dawoſyo greehung the houſe *of* God.

7 The *Locative* caſe, definitive of ſituation, and generally known by the ſign *in*; as জলে jola *in* the water, গৃহে greeha

greeha *in* the houſe, তর্কে চতুর torka chotooro learned *in* judgement.

The Vocative in Shanſcrit is excluded from the number of caſes, as no inflexion is employed in its formation: but to the imperfect noun the ſign হে ha is prefixed; as হে রাজন ha raajon O king!

The Inflexions of which a Bengal noun is capable, are neither ſo copious nor ſo accurate; the terminations uſed for this purpoſe are four only, and conſequently we can reckon but five different caſes at moſt.

The nominative is not diſtinguiſhed by any rule of formation; for in moſt ſimple or abſtract terms, the crude noun of the Shanſcrit is adopted, without the inflexion which denotes the Shanſcrit nominative; but for concrete ſubſtantives, names of agents &c. where the termination undergoes a material alteration in the Shanſcrit, that alteration is generally uſed in the Bengal dialect; as রাজা raajaa a king, from the crude noun রাজন raajon; স্বামী ſwaamee a huſband, from স্বামিন ſwaameen. Example,

স্বামী বনিতার পতি স্বামী বনিতার গতি

Swaamee boneetaar potee ſwaamee boneetaar gotee

"The

"The huſband is the Lord of the wife, the huſband is the guide of the wife."

The Inflexion which moſt uſually occurs in Bengal nouns is made by the addition of the letter এ a; as দোষে doſha from দোষ doſh a crime: মানুষে maanooſha from মানুষ maanooſho a man; which may be called the *Oblique caſe* in general, from its frequent uſe.

This termination is occaſionally applied to five ſeveral caſes.

1 To the nominative (redundantly) as বীরে beera for বীর beero a warrior, *Vir*;

আমি যদি সেনাপতি হইব সমরে।
তবে অস্ত্র না ধরিবে কর্ন্ন মহাবীরে॥

Aamee jodee ſanaapotee ho-ibo ſomora
Toba oſtro naa dhoreeba Kornno mohaabeera.
"When I ſhall be General in the battle,
"Then Kornno *the great warrior* will not take up arms."

2 To the paſſive or ſubjective caſe: as যুধিষ্ঠিরে from যুধিষ্ঠির Jood-heeſhteer, a proper name; as

যুধিষ্ঠিরে ধরি দেহ এই নিবেদন

Jood-heeſhteera dhoree daho a-ee neebadon
"Seize and give me Jood-heeſhteer; this is my requeſt."

It

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3 It ſerves to convey the ſenſe of the third, fifth and ſeventh of the Shanſcrit caſes; as বানে baana with an arrow গগনে gogona from heaven: মাসে maaſa in the month: কলিকাতায় koleekaataay in Calcutta; as

চারি বানে চারি অশ্ব মারিল তক্ষণ

Chaaree baana chaaree oſwo maareelo tokhyon

"With four arrows he then ſtruck the four horſes."

এইত শ্রাবন মাসে ধারা বরিসে গগনে

A-eeto ſhraawon maaſa dhaaraa boreeſa gogona

"In this month ſhraabon the rains fall from heaven."

and this its proper uſe and application.

4 It is added to the termination of the poſſeſſive caſe, to form the dative: as দ্রোনেরে Dronara, to Dron

আর রথে করি তবে দ্রোনেরে লইল

Aar rot,ha koree toba Dronara lo-ilo

"He then brought another carriage to Dron."

5 It is alſo employed to diſtinguiſh the vocative, and may either be prefixed or ſubjoined:

Pre-

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Prefixed, as এ নাথ তুমি মোরে করিনা পরাধিন

A naat,ho *toomee* mora *koreelaa* poraadheen

"O maſter! you have reduced me to a foreign ſubjection."

Subjoined, as সুন নৃপবরে *ſhoono nreepobora* hear O Prince! from নৃপবর *nreepoboro* a Noble or Prince.

The ſecond or paſſive caſe of inanimate nouns is almoſt always the ſame as the nominative, and is very rarely diſtinguiſhed by a change of termination.

আর বান এড়ে বীর পূরিয়া সন্ধান ।
দুশ্বাসনের অঙ্গ কাটি করে খান খান ॥

Aar baan ara b*ee*r p*ooree*yaa ſondhaan

D*ooſh*waaſonar ungo kaat*ee* k*o*ra khaan khaan

"The hero having well pointed his aim, ſhot another arrow,

"And cutting the body of D*ooſh*waaſon, hewed it in pieces."

In this diſtich the words বান baan, সন্ধান ſondhaan, অঙ্গ ungo and খানখান khaankhaan are in the paſſive or ſubjective caſe.

The ſame conſtruction alſo takes place occaſionally even in proper names; as

খরি

ধরিবারে যায় দ্রোন রাজা যুধিষ্ঠির

Dhoreebaara jaay Dron Raajaa Jood, heeſhteer

"Dron goes to ſeize Raajaa Jood, heeſhteer."

But this caſe ſhould be formed by the termination এ a when the noun ends with a conſonant, and by রে ra or কে ka when it terminates with a vowel: as

বহুত বচনে কহিল অর্জুনে

Bohoot bochona koheelo Orjoona

"He addreſſed much diſcourſe to Orjoon."

সাত্যকিরে ভুরিশ্রবা করে পরাজায়

Saatyokeera Bhooreeſhrobaa kora poraajaay

"Bhooreeſhrobaa defeated Saatyokee."

আর দশ বানে বীর কর্ন্নকে মারিল

Aar doſh baana beer Kornnoka maareelo

"The hero ſtuck Korno with ten more arrows."

I have obſerved ſome few inſtances, wherein this caſe is made to reſemble the dative in termination; as in the book called Beedyaa Soondor;

বিদ্যা সুন্দরেরে নইয়া কালিকা কৌতুকি হইয়া
কৈলাস শিখরে উত্তরিল

Beedyaa

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Beedyaa Soondorara lo-iyaa kaaleekaa koutookee ho-iyaa
Ko-ilaas seekhora ootoreelo.

"Beedyaa having obtained Soondor (her lover) and Kaalee-
"kaa being made contented, arrived at the foot of Koilas
"Seekhor (a mountain.)"

This second case, with its Shanscrit termination, is not totally lost among the Bengalese; tho' the very persons who use it are utterly ignorant of the principles on which it is formed, and of the grammatical reason for which it is applied. All petitions, letters &c. in the Bengal language, commence with certain customary phrases of compliment in pure Shanscrit, of which the Writer knows nothing more than the general purport; after this compliment is constantly inserted the sentence লিখিত° কার্য্যঞ্চ আগে Leekheetung kaarjyuncho aaga, which signifies "I have written the affair (i.e. the affair which is the subject of the letter or petition) here beyond." The word in the passive case is কার্য্যঞ্চ Kaarjyuncho: the syllable cho is an *enclytic*, added only to fill up the metre, (for the line is a verse of eight syllables) the word without this termination is কার্য্য° kaarjyung, the second Shanscrit case of কার্য্য kaarjyo an affair. The same form occurs in the word নিবেদন neebadon a petition; which in the established formulary for the commencement

of

of all petitions is written নিবেদনঞ্চ neebadonuncho for নিবেদন neebadonung.

The third, fifth and ſeventh caſes of the Shanſcrit are likewiſe frequently ſupplied by the termination তে ta, which is added to the nominative, when it ends with a vowel, and to the oblique caſe when the laſt letter of the noun is a conſonant; as অগ্নিতে ogneeta *with* fire, from অগ্নি ognee fire. জলেতে jolata *with* water, from জল jolo water. ঢাকাতে dhaakaata *from* Dacca. রথেতে rot,hata, *in* a carriage, or *from* a carriage. ভূমেতে bhoomata *on* the ground.

অগ্নিতে পোড়ায় সৈন্য দ্রোন বিদ্যমান

Ogneeta poraay ſo-inyo Dron beedyomaan

"He deſtroyed the army *with* fire in Dron's preſence."

জলেতে হইল পূর্ন সংগ্রামের স্থল

Jolata ho-ilo poorno ſungraamar ſt,holo

"The field of battle was filled *with* water."

রথেতে চলিল গিয়া

Rot,hata choleelo geeyaa

"He haſted away *in* the carriage."

মূর্চ্ছিত হইয়া বীর রথেতে পড়িল

Moor-

Moorchch'heet ho-iyaa beer rot,hata poreelo

"The hero becoming ſenſeleſs fell *from* the carriage."

সারথির মুণ্ড কাটি পাড়িল ভূমেতে

Saarot,heer moondo kaatee paareelo bhoomata

"Having wounded the charioteer on the head, he felled him *to* the ground."

The ſixth Shanſcrit caſe, or poſſeſſive form of noun, is conſtructed by adding the letter র ro to the nominative if it ends with a vowel, or to the oblique caſe, if the laſt letter of the word be a conſonant: as বনিতার boneetaar genitive of বনিতা boneetaa a wife. স্বামীর ſwaameer from স্বামী ſwaamee a huſband. মধুর modhoor ſweet, the genitive of মধু modhoo, honey. মানুষের maanooſhar from মানুষ maancoſho a man. কৃষ্ণের kreeſhnar from কৃষ্ণ Kreeſhno the name of a Hindoo Deity. Example.

কামানের হুড়হুড়ি বন্দুকের দুড়দুড়ি
সম্মুখে বানের গড় হয়

Kaamaanar hoorohooree bondockar doorodooree

ſommcokha baanar gor hoy.

"There is a twanging of bows, and report of guns,

"ſurely there muſt be a fortreſs of arms before me."

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কৃষ্ণের বচনে পার্থ ধনু অস্ত্র নিল

Kreeſhnar bochona paart,ho dhonco oſtro neelo

"At the words of Kreeſhno the Vizier took up his bow and arms."

Some nouns ending with vowels increaſe a ſyllable in all the oblique caſes, by prefixing to the ſign এ a the conſonant correſpondent to their terminating vowel; as ভাইয়ের bhaaeeyar from ভাই bhaaee a brother. পাণ্ডবের paandowar from পাণ্ডু paandoo the name of an ancient Hindoo family: and this form (tho' very ſeldom uſed by the moderns) ſeems moſt conſiſtent with the orthography of the language.

ভাইয়ের মরন দেখি সিন্দুবীর বেগে।
হাথে গদা করি গেল অভিমন্যু আগে॥

Bhaaeeyar moron dakhee ſeendcobeer baga
Haat,ha godaa koree galo Obheemonyoo aaga

"Seendoobeer ſeeing the death of his brother, taking his
"Mace in his hand, haſted to Obheemonyco."

হাহাকার সব্দ হইল পাণ্ডবের দলে

Haahaakaar ſobdo ho-ilo paandowar dola

"There was much lamentation on the part of the Paandoos."

The

The *dative* is diſtinguiſhed by the final এ a added to the genitive, as I have already remarked; thus

রাজারে কহিল বীর সুন নৃপবর

Raajaara koheelo beer ſoono nreepobor

"The hero ſaid *to* the Raja, hear O Prince!"

Various Interjections ſerve to point out the Vocative, and they will be noticed in their proper place; at preſent I ſhall only obſerve that the particle রে ra is commonly uſed in this ſenſe, and may be added either to the word with which it is immediately connected in conſtruction, or to any other member of the ſentence, either noun or verb, as the compoſer finds moſt convenient; an inſtance of the latter mode appears in this hemiſtych,

যাওরে রজনি তুমি মরিয়া

Jaa-ora rojonee toomee moreeyaa

"O night! periſh and depart from us.

where যাওরে রজনি jaa-ora rojonee is put for যাও jaa-o রজনিরে rojoneera go, O night. For an example of this interjection being joined to its immediate ſubject, I ſhall quote the following little poetical ſong.

গীত

গীত

ভব সিন্ধু পারৱে কে যাবা ভাইরে
হরি নামের নৌকাখানি শ্রী গুরু কাণ্ডারি
বাহ বাহ বল্যা ডাকে দুই বাহু পসারি
চাম্পর নিতাইয়ের ঘাটে অদান খেবা বয়
কত অন্ধ অন্তর তারা সব পার হয়

Bhobo ſeendhoo paarora ka jaabaa bhaaeera
Horee naamar noukaakhaanee ſhree gooroo kaandaaree
Baaho baaho bolyaa daaka dooee baahoo poſaaree
T,haakoor neetaaeeyar ghaata odaan khawaa boy
Koto ondho otoor taaraa ſobo paaro hoy.

AN ODE.

'O Brothers! which of you will croſs the ocean of the world!
'There is the boat of the name of Horee; (the Deity) Shree Gooroo (our Tutor) is the pilot;
'He hath ſummoned us, crying out,' "row, row, and ſtretch wide both your arms;"
——'In the port of Neetaace T,haakoor (a famous Divine) we pay nothing for the paſſage,
'And there all the lame and blind are ferried over.'

The

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The particle হে ha, the ſign of the Shanſcrit vocative, is frequently applied to Bengal nouns in the ſame ſenſe; as

নাগৰহে গিয়াছিনাম নগৰেৰ হাটে

Nagorha geeyaach'heelaam nogorar haata

"O Naagor, I have been to the market at the City."

The Vocative is alſo expreſſed by the crude noun, and by the nominative caſe of the Shanſcrit indifferently, without any interjection: as

হাসিয়া কহিল কৃষ্ণ সুনহ ৰাজন

Haaſeeyaa koheelo kreeſhno ſoonoho Raajon

"Kreeſhno laughing ſaid, hear O King."

কৰ্ন্ন বলে মহা রাজা কর অবধান

Kornno bola mohaa Raajaa koro obodhaan

"Kornno ſaid, O great King, employ ſage conſideration."

As it may be curious to obſerve at one view the connection and reſemblance between a Shanſcrit and Bengal noun, and to trace in a corrupted language the gradual progreſs of deviation from its original ſource; I ſhall here inſert a ſubſtantive declined after both methods, and ranked according to the Shanſcrit mode of arrangement, which I think at leaſt equal in merit to the ſyſtem adopted by European Grammarians.

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First Declenſion, a Subſtantive ending with a Conſonant.

	Shanscrit.		Bengalese.	
1	বানঃ baanoh		বান baano	an arrow
2	বান baanung		বানে baana	an arrow
3	বানেন baanano		বানেতে baanata	with an arrow
4	বানায় baanaayo		বানেরে baanara	to an arrow
5	বানাৎ baanaat		বানেতে baanata	from an arrow
6	বানস্য baanoſyo		বানের baanar	of an arrow
7	বানে baana		বানে baana	in an arrow
Voc:	হে বান ha baano		এ বান a baan	O arrow

Second Declenſion, a Subſtantive terminated by a Vowel.

1	অগ্নিঃ ogneeh	অগ্নি ognee	fire
2	অগ্নিং ogneeng	অগ্নিকে ogneeka	fire
3	অগ্নিনা ogneenaa	অগ্নিতে ogneeta	with fire
4	অগ্নয়ে ognoya	অগ্নিরে ogneera	to fire
5	অগ্নেঃ ognah	অগ্নিতে ogneeta	from fire
6	অগ্নেঃ ognah	অগ্নির ogneer	of fire
7	অগ্নৌ ognou	অগ্নিতে ogneeta	in fire
Voc:	হে অগ্নে ha ogna	এ অগ্নি a ognee	O fire

A

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A third Declenſion might be formed for thoſe nouns which change their terminating vowel into a conſonant in the oblique caſe: as ভাইয়ে bhaaeeya and পাণ্ডবে paandowa, oblique caſes from ভাই bhaaee a brother and পাণ্ডু paandoo a proper name &c. But theſe occur too ſeldom to require a ſeparate claſs: and occaſional anomalies are leſs fatiguing to a learner than a tedious multiplicity of rules.

The ſpecimens of declenſion here inſerted will have ſhewn, that Bengal nouns fall very ſhort of the powers and of the preciſion, which a greater variety of inflexion gives to thoſe of the Shanſcrit: yet the examples which I have already quoted from ancient books, prove that a ſingle oblique caſe has been uſed in many different ſenſes, like the dative in Greek, and ablative in Latin. But in modern language the ſyllable এ a or তে ta at the end of a word, is generally confined to the ſenſe of the *ſeventh caſe* as definitive of ſituation; and may conſtantly be rendered into Engliſh with the ſign *in*: as নগরে nogora *in* the City; ঘাটে ghaata *in* the Port; নামে naama *in* the name; মাসে maaſha *in* the month &c.

The third and fifth caſes are uſually ſupplied by certain particles anſwering to prepoſitions in Latin and Greek; and which compenſate for the defective ſyſtem of inflexion in Bengal nouns.

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as well as in thoſe of moſt of the European languages. The uſe of theſe particles will be explained in a ſeparate Chapter.

Of Numbers.

In the preceding ſection I have inſerted the ſingular number only, as a ſpecimen of declenſion, becauſe the Bengal language has no proper form of dual or plural; both of which every Shanſcrit noun contains, and each declined with ſeven caſes like the ſingular. But as this work is by no means intended to comprehend the whole grammatical ſyſtem of the Braminical dialect, I have taken no notice of the great variety of its declenſions, nor explained the difference of their inflexions as occaſioned by the difference of gender, as well as of termination. I have alſo omitted to deſcribe the modes of forming Shanſcrit ſubſtantives of different genders from the ſame root. Everything that immediately relates to my ſubject, I ſhall uſe my utmoſt endeavours to inſert; but a compleat grammar of the Shanſcrit would furniſh ample matter for a conſiderable volume, and prove a formidable taſk to the moſt experienced philologer.

I have ſaid that Bengal nouns have neither *dual* nor *plural* numbers, I may add that neither is wanted. The *dual* is found in no modern language, and probably never exiſted but in the Arabic and its branches, in the Shanſcrit, and in the Greek.

That

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That the idea of multitude is not confined to the plural number is clear beyond a doubt, becauſe ſingular nouns are uſed in all languages with a collective ſenſe, almoſt as frequently as plurals: thus, *men love to ſtudy*, and *man loves to ſtudy*, are phrazes perfectly equivalent. So alſo we join to a noun in the ſingular number an epithet of indefinite plurality, to convey a plural meaning: *many a man*, is written by the Bengaleſe বহুত মানুষ bohoot maanooſh. Perhaps it might be ſafely urged that the ſingular number has more occaſion for an accurate ſpecification than the plural: at leaſt this is the only circumſtance which can account for the extenſive uſage of the article, or repreſentative of unity in moſt of the modern dialects of Europe.

In the Bengal language the ſame form of noun ſerves for the ſingular and plural; ſo that in an indefinite ſentence no diſtinction of number is obſerved or provided for; as in the following verſes.

সৈন্য সৈন্য মহা যুদ্ধ হইল আচম্বিতে।
রথি গন আইল চড়িয়া দিব্য রথে॥
হস্তী হস্তী যুদ্ধ হয় মহা শব্দ করে।
অশ্ব আস্বার যুদ্ধ হয় বিবিধ প্রকারে॥

ſo-inyo ſo-inyo mohaa joodho ho-ilo aachombeeta
Rot,hee gono aaeelo choreeyaa deebyo rot,ha

Hoſtee

Hoſtee hoſtee joddho hoy mohaa ſhobdo kora
Oſwo aaſwaar joddho hoy beebeedh prokaara

"Troop with troop; on a ſudden there became a mighty batt'e;
"The Leaders halted in their ſtrongeſt chariots:
"Elephant and elephant; the war raged with a terrible noiſe;
"Horſe and horſeman; the fight kindled in various conjunctures."

In this paſſage the words *troop*, *elephant*, *horſe* and *horſeman* &c. are taken collectively, and may be equally underſtood to be of the plural, or ſingular number. Where unity is to be ſpecified, the word এক ako one, muſt be uſed like the article *a* or *an*, which latter I ſhould conceive to be a corruption of the word *one*. Example;

এক লাফে ধরিলেক তাহার চিকুর ।
এক চড়ে দন্ত গুলা করিলেক চুর ॥

Ako laapha dhoreelak taahaar cheekoor
Ako chora donto goolaa koreelak choor

"With a ſudden jump he ſeized his lock of hair,
"And with a ſingle blow ſhattered all his teeth."

Numerals may be joined to nouns in the ſingular number, without any confuſion of expreſſion, as we ſay fifty *horſe* (for *horſemen*) twenty *head* of cattle (for *heads*) ſo in Bengaleſe,

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সত সত হস্তী বীর মারে এক ঘায়

Scto ſoto hoſtee beer maara ako ghaay

"With one blow the hero ſtruck a hundred elephants."

Nouns of animation, and more particularly ſuch as relate to mankind, generally have their plural number diſtinguiſhed by the addition of certain words of amplification or multitude, which ſerve in a ſubordinate capacity, inſtead of a variation of form to the principal noun. Of theſe words, that which moſt commonly occurs in modern Bengaleſe is লোক lok a Shanſcrit word for a man, or in its collective ſenſe *people*; as

সর্ব লোক কহে যাও রাজার নিকট

Sorwo lok koha jaao Raajaar neekot

"All the people ſay, go before the Rajaa."

লোক lok when added to another ſubſtantive gives it a plural ſenſe; as প্রজা projaa a peaſant, প্রজালোক projaalok peaſants. তাঁতী taangtee a weaver, তাঁতীলোক taangteelok weavers.

But this uſage is very rare in books; in which plurality is moſt uſually ſignified by the word গন gono a multitude or army; as পণ্ডিত pondeet, a learned Indian, or Pundit, পণ্ডিত গন pondeetgono Pundits. সৈন্য ſo-inyo a troop, সৈন্য গন

ſo-inyo

ſoi-nyo gono Troops.

নক্ষ নক্ষ সৈন্য গন বিনাসিন রনে

Lokhyo lokhyo ſo-ino gono beenaaſeelo rona

"He annihilated millions of Troops in the battle."

বিদ্যার আভাস দেখি হইল বিস্ময়।
সকল পণ্ডিত গন হইল পরাজয়॥

Beedyaar aabhaas dakhee ho-ilo beeſmoy

Sokolo pondeet gono ho-ilo poraajoy.

"On beholding the wonderful extent of his knowledge,

"All the Pundits were aſtoniſhed, and were overcome."

দল dolo is another word of the ſame purport and uſage as গন gono; thus

ভয় পাইয়া পাণ্ডু দল সকল পলায়।
দুর্য্যোধন রাজা হইল আনন্দিত কায়॥

Bhoy paaeeyaa paandoo dolo ſokolo polaay

Doorjodhon Raajaa ho-ilo aanondeet kaay.

"The Paandoos being terrified, all fled,

"And Raja Doorjodhon was elated at heart."

Sometimes alſo গন gono and দল dolo are both applied together to give greater ſtrength to the expreſſion; as

অর্জ্জুনের

অর্জ্জুনের রন দেখি বড় বিচক্ষন।
ভঙ্গ দিয়া যায় তবে কুরু দল গন॥

Orjoonar rono dakhee boro beechokhyon
Bhungo deeyaa jaay toba kooroo dol gon
"On ſeeing the wonderful battles of Orjoon,
"All the Kooroos fled from the battle."

This form of plural may be uſed in the oblique caſe; the ſign of inflexion being added to the latter word only: as from কুরুগন kooroogono the Kooroos, may be formed কুরুগনে koorogona; as

দেখিয়া কুরুগনে লাগে চমৎকার

dakheeyaa kooroogona laaga chomot kaar
"On beholding it, aſtoniſhment ſeized the Koorcos"

If the firſt word had been in the oblique caſe, it would have been neceſſary to underſtand the latter in its full, and proper meaning; as পাণ্ডু গন paandoo gono the Paandoos, পাণ্ডবের গন paandowar gono the multitude or army of the Paandoos.

পাণ্ডবের গনেরে জয়দ্রত কৈন জয়

Paandowar gonara joydrot ko-ilo joy
"Joydrot conquered the army of the Paandoos."

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গুলা goolaa is added to names of animals and things to form a plural, but not to thoſe concerning mankind, as in this hemiſtych from the Raamaayon, or hiſtory of Raam.

সিংহনাদ শব্দ করিয়া বানর গুলা আইসে

ſeenghonaad ſhobdo koreeyaa baanor goolaa aaeeſa

"On his making a noiſe like the lion, the apes approached."

Thus is uſed গরু গুলা goroo goolaa cows, from গরু goroo a cow; অস্ত্র গুলা oſtro goolaa arms, from অস্ত্র oſtro a weapon, &c.

দিগ deeg properly ſignifies *a ſide*; but when following another ſubſtantive, generally conveys a plural ſenſe to it; eſpecially in an oblique caſe; as পাসণ্ড paaſondo a ſinner, পাসণ্ড দিগের paaſondo deegar *of ſinners* or *on the part of ſinners*; as

সকল পাসণ্ড দিগের পাপ ক্ষয় হইল।
নিতাই চৈতন্য আসি দরশন দিল॥

Sokol paaſondo deegar paap khyoy ho-ilo
Neetaaee cho-itonyo aaſee doroſhon deelo

"The faults *of all ſinners* were obliterated,
"When Neetaaee and Choiton viſited them."

This

This word is more particularly applied to form the inflexions of the pronouns both perſonal and poſſeſſive, with which it is conſtantly uſed by the moderns in their converſation and correſpondence.

যুদ্ধতে পড়িয়া সবে স্বর্গ পুরে জায়।
বন্ধু গনে তাহার দিগের না দেখি উপায়॥

Jooddhata poreeyaa ſoba ſworgo poora jaay
Bodhoo gona taahaar deegar naa dekhee copaay.

"Thoſe who fall in battle all go to Paradiſe,
"But I ſee no remedy for their wives (or literally, *the wives on their part.*")

I muſt not omit that in the modern and corrupt dialect of Bengal the ſyllable রা raa is ſometimes added to the nominative of a ſingular noun to form a plural; as ছান্যা ch'haalyaa a child ছান্যারা ch'haalyaaraa children.

CHAPTER III.

OF PRONOUNS.

নামবাচ্য naambaachyo literally ſignifies *the implication of a name*, and therefore may be ſaid nearly to correſpond to the term *Pronoun*. It would be difficult to account for the variety of

of words which have been allotted to this claſs by European grammarians; Perſonals, Reflectives, Demonſtratives, Interrogatives, Indefinites &c. many of which cannot poſſibly be taken for ſubſtitutes, or repreſentatives of nouns. Among theſe exceptions to claſs the ſigns of the firſt and ſecond perſons, may perhaps be deemed too great an affectation of ſingularity, or an unwarrantable licentiouſneſs of criticiſm; yet the authors of the Shanſcrit grammars univerſally confine the term naambochyo to the third perſon. The other two are ranked in the chapter of nouns, tho' diſtinguiſhed by a peculiar inflexion.

I and *thou*, the hinges upon which all diſcourſe is turned, are not pronouns; they are perſonals, and nothing elſe: that is, they denote the preſence and perſonality of the collocutors, *I* being invariably the ſign of the perſon who ſpeaks, and *thou* that of the perſon ſpoken to. They are not the ſubſtitutes for their names, becauſe thoſe names could not be applied without circumlocution, preplexity and abſurdity. They are not *pronouns*, becauſe they differ altogether in implication, power and extent from that which is moſt aſſuredly a pronoun, the ſign of the third perſon. *I* and *thou* teſtify the act of diſcourſe, *he* excludes from a participation in it: *I* and *thou* have no gender, *he* has both a feminine and a neuter. The firſt and ſecond perſonals

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ſonals ſhould ſeem to be confined to rational and converſable beings only; the third ſupplies the place of every object in nature: wherefore it muſt neceſſarily be endued with a capacity of ſhifting its gender reſpectively as it ſhifts its ſubject; and hence it is in Shanſcrit frequently denominated an *adjective*.

One of the demonſtratives *hic* or *ille* uſually ſerves for this purpoſe, and generally the latter, which in Arabic has no other name than ضمير الغايب dhemeer el ghaayb *the pronoun of the abſentee*, for whoſe name it is a ſubſtitute.

In moſt languages where the verb has a ſeparate inflexion for each perſon, that inflexion is ſufficient to aſcertain the perſonality; but in Bengal compoſions, though the firſt and ſecond perſonals occur very frequently, nothing is more rare than the uſage of the pronoun of the third; and names of perſons are inſerted with a conſtant and diſguſting repetition, to avoid, as it ſhould ſeem, the application of the words *he* and *they*.

The Bengal perſonals do not reſemble thoſe of the Shanſcrit in any of their inflexions: but as the caſes of the latter (in the ſingular number) are ſometimes applied in the more antient writings, I ſhall here exhibit them in their own form and order.

The ſecond perſon is always ranked before the firſt, and the third before the ſecond. Thus the roots of the firſt and third perſonals

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perſonals are যুষ্মদ্ অস্মদ্ *thou* and *I*.

	First Perſonal.	Second Perſonal.
1 caſe.	ত্বং° thou	অহং° I
2	ত্বা° thee	মা° me
3	ত্বয়া with thee	ময়া with me
4	তুভ্যং° to thee	মহ্যং° to me
5	ত্বৎ from thee	মৎ from me
6	তব of thee	মম of me
7	ত্বয়ি in thee	ময়ি in me

Sometimes the form of the ſecond caſe is ত্বা মা and the fourth and ſixth তে মে Example.

জীবনে মরনে বাপি রাধাকৃষ্ণ গতি মম

"In life and death may Raadhaakreeſhno be *my* Guide."

I ſhall collect in this chapter all ſuch words as uſually come under the head of pronouns in the European ſyſtem of grammar, whether declinable or aptotes. Such of them as are ſubject to inflexion, have a regular but peculiar method of declenſion, which differs from that of ſubſtantives, both in the formation of the oblique caſes and in the general uſage of a plural number.

I

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I ſhall divide them into three claſſes: the firſt comprehending all ſuch words whoſe nominative ſingular ends in ই *ee*; the ſecond containing thoſe which terminate in া a; and third compoſed of words incapable of inflexion.

And firſt of Nominatives in ই ſuch as আমি I, তুমি you আপনি ſelf, এই this, ওই that &c. Example.

এই ক্ষনে দ্রোন আমি বিনাশিব রনে

"At this juncture *I* will defeat Dron in the battle."

সৈন বনে রাজা তুমি ভুবনে বিক্ষাত

"So-ilo ſaid, Raajaa, *you* are famous in the world."

In the ſecond or *paſſive* caſe the terminating ই *ee* of the nominative is conſtantly changed into আ aa; as আমা me তোমা you &c.

তোমা বিনে ধরে তারে নাহি হেন জন

"Except *you*, there is no one able to ſeize him."

The third, fifth, and ſeventh of the Shanſcrit caſes are repreſented by adding the termination তে to the *paſſive*; as আমাতে *with*, *from*, *by*, or *in* me; তাহাতে *with* &c. him, her, or it: as

তাহাতে অনেক সৈন্য করিনেক চুর

"with

"*With* it he cut in pieces all the troops."

It is to be remembered that altho' I have given the termination তে as the ſign of the third and fifth caſes of the pronouns, yet the moderns very ſeldom uſe either of them; but apply certain particles anſwering to prepoſitions when they would expreſs the ſenſe of theſe caſes: a circumſtance which I have already remarked in the chapter of ſubſtantives.

The dative is formed by the termination রে ra added to the paſſive caſe; as আমারে to me, তোমারে to you &c.

এই হেতু তোমারে আমি কহি এ রাজন

"On account of this I ſpeak *to you*, O King."

The ſyllable কে ka is ſometimes ſubſtitued for রে in this caſe.

আনিয়াছ আমাকে আপনে আজ্ঞা দিয়া

"You yourſelf ordered *me* to be brought hither."

NB. This dative caſe frequently ſupplies the place of the paſſive, like that of ſubſtantives; as in the preceding example and in this which follows.

ব্রহ্মা যদি আপনে আসিয়া করে রন ?
তোমারে ধরিতে সে নারিবে কদাচন ?

"If

"If Brohmaa himſelf ſhould come and fight,
"He ſhall by no means avail to take *you* priſoner."

The *poſſeſſive* is made by omitting the final এ a of the dative; as আমার *of me*, or *mine*; তোমার *of you*, or *your's*; আপনার *of ſelf*, or *own*; as

মহা ধনুদ্ধর হওক আমার সন্ততি

"Let *my* ſon become a mighty bowman."

আনন্দিত হইয়া গেল আপনার ঘর

"He went exulting to *his own* houſe."

Excluſive of the termination in তে ta, which is the ſign of the ſeventh as well as of the third and fifth caſes, the pronouns poſſeſs a ſeparate form of inflexion peculiar to the *locative* caſe; being the ſame with that of ſuch ſubſtantives as end in আ aa where the এ a final is changed into য় yo, as inſtanced in the preceding chapter in the word কলিকাতায় from the nominative কলিকাতা In the ſame manner to the paſſive caſe of the pronouns which always end in আ aa is added the letter য় yo; as আমায় in me তোমায় in you তাহায় in him &c.

তোমার দুঃখেতে আমার উপজিল দয়া।
অদৈন্য করিব তোমায় দিয়া পদ ছায়া॥

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"My compaſſion is excited by your ſufferings,

"I will cauſe *in you* unceaſing bliſs under the ſhadow of my feet."

বৈকুণ্ঠ ছাড়িয়া আমি আইনাম তোমার ঠাক্রি।
সিন্নি দিয়া পুজ আমায় দুঃখ রবে নাক্রি ॥

"Having left the ſkies, I am come to your habitation.

"Give me ſweetmeats and worſhip me, and your troubles ſhall not remain."

The nominative plural always ends in রা raa, and is formed either by changing the final ই *ee* of the nominative ſingular into রা raa; as আমরা *we*, from আমি I; তোমরা *ye*, from তুমি *you*: or by adding আ aa to the poſſeſſive caſe; as তাহারা *they*, from তাহার *of him*; আপনারা *ſelves*, from আপনার *of ſelf*. Examples.

সত্য কহ নারী আমরা পাইয়াছি ডর

"Speak truth, O woman, for *we* are afraid."

তোমরা সকলে থাক রাজার রক্ষনে

"Do *ye* all remain in defence of the Raajaa."

The ſame inflexion ſerves alſo for the paſſive caſe plural; as

তোমরা জতেক ভাই বিধি কৈল ঠাক্রি ঠাক্রি

"*You* Brethren, how many ſoever, *Beedhee* hath conſigned to different places"

The

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The other oblique cafes of the plural are expreſſed by the ſeveral inflexions of the word দিগ joined to the ſecond or fixth caſe of the ſingular; as আমারদিগে আমারদিগেরে তোমারদিগের &c. an example of which has been already inſerted in the ſecond chapter.

In common diſcourſe this plural termination দিগের is frequently contracted to দের as আমাদের of us তোমাদের of you &c.

After theſe general rules it may not be improper to give the declenſion of each pronoun ſeparate, with ſuch remarks as they may reſpectively require.

1ſt. perſonal আমি I.

	Singular.		Plural.	
1	আমি	I	আমরা	we
2	আমা	me	আমরা	us
3	আমাতে	*with* or *by* me	আমারদিগেতে	by us
4	আমারে	to me	আমারদিগেরে	to us
5	আমাতে	from me	আমারদিগেতে	from us
6	আমার	of me	আমারদিগের	of us
7	আমায়	in me	আমারদিগে	in us

2d. per-

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2d personal তুমি you.

	Singular.		Plural.	
1	তুমি	you	তোমা	ye
2	তোমা	you	তোমা	you
3	তোমাতে	*by* or *with* you	তোমারদিগেতে	*by* or *with* you
4	তোমারে	to you	তোমারদিগেরে	to you
5	তোমাতে	from you	তোমারদিগেতে	from you
6	তোমার	of you	তোমারদিগের	of you
7	তোমায়	in you	তোমারদিগে	in you

It is to be obſerved that the vowel ু *oo* of the perſonal তুমি is changed into ো o in all its inflexions both of the ſingular and plural; for which particularity there is no other than the authority of eſtabliſhed uſage.

The inflexions of আমি and তুমি in the fourth and fixth caſes of the ſingular, and in the nominative plural are commonly contracted in poetry; as

মোরে	তোরে	for	আমারে	তোমারে
মোর	তোর	for	আমার	তোমার
মোরা	তোরা	for	আমরা	তোরা

Examples.

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তুমি যদি দয়া নাথ না করিবা মোরে ।
এ ভব সাগর মাঝে কে তরাবে মোরে ॥

"If you, O maſter, will not take compaſſion on me,
"Who will ſteer me through this dangerous ocean?"

এই ক্ষনে রথ মোর চালায় সত্তর ।

"Now ſwiftly drive my chariot."

রায় বলে বাসা দিলে হইলাম পুষোসী ।
আমি পুত্র সম তোর তুমি আমার মাসী ॥

"Raay ſaid, you have given me a habitation, and I am your debtor.
"I will be as your child, and you ſhall be to me an aunt."

ইহার উচিত ফল দিব আমি তোরে ।

"I will give you the merited reward of this conduct"

The word which properly ſignifies *thou*, is তুক্তি of which তোরে and তোর above quoted, are probably inflexions; but as in Engliſh we have altogether ſubſtituted *you* for *thou* in polite converſation; ſo in Bengaleſe, cuſtom has eſtabliſhed তুমি in the place of তুই both in books and diſcourſe: nor is the latter ever applied but in contempt or anger.

The nominative of the proper pronoun of the third perſon ends in এ a, and is therefore deferred to another part of the chapter.

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The word ইনি is ſometimes uſed in diſcourſe for the third perſonal *he*, and its inflexions are ইনা ইনাতে ইনারে ইনার ইনায় ইনারা &c. but I have never met with a ſingle inſtance of it in books.

আপনি *ſelf* is a reciprocal or reflective pronoun; and is declined as follows.

	Singular.	Plural.
1	আপনি	আপনারা &c. As the plurals of all theſe words are formed by the inflexions of দিগ and have no difference or variation, I ſhall not burthen the Reader with any more of them.
2	আপনা	
3	আপনাতে	
4	আপনারে	
5	আপনাতে	
9	আপনার	
7	আপনায়	

The poſſeſſive caſe আপনার is occaſionally contracted to আপন when prefixed to another ſubſtantive, with which it coaleſces; as

সকল আপনভাবে জান

"He conſiders all men in his own ſituation."

The demonſtratives are এই or এহি this, and অই or অহি that.

Singular.

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	Singular.		Plural.	
1	এই	অই	ইহারা	ওহারা
2	ইহা	ওহা	&c.	.
3	ইহাতে	ওহাতে	.	.
4	ইহারে	ওহারে	.	.
5	ইহাতে	ওহাতে	.	.
6	ইহার	ওহার	.	.
7	ইহায়	ওহায়	.	.

Cuſtom has eſtabliſhed that the এ *a* of এই ſhould be conſtantly changed into ই *ee*, and the অ *o* of অই into ও *co*, in all the oblique caſes; and has alſo ordained that in all the words of this claſs, whoſe nominative terminates in a pure vowel, the letter হ *ho* ſhall be inſerted before the ſign of the oblique caſe; as ইহা ওহা &c.

এই and অই when coupled with nouns, do not change their caſe like the adjectives and demonſtratives of Latin and Greek, but continue in the nominative, like thoſe of the Engliſh; whatever inflexion the ſubſtantive to which they belong many have aſſumed; as

এই মতে প্রতিজ্ঞা করিল পুনঃপুনঃ

"To *this* effect he repeated his promiſe ſeveral times."

We

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We muſt now proceed to the third diviſion, conſiſting of words whoſe nominative ends in এ a.

Some of theſe are of both claſſes; as আপনে the ſame as আপনি ſelf, এ a contraction of এই *this*: and others are confined to the preſent form only, ſuch as সে *he*, (the pronoun of the third perſon) যে *who* or *whoever*, (the relative and contional) and কে *who*? (the Interrogative.)

আপনে and এ are nominatives, as well as আপনি and এই

Examples.

কৃপা করি সেনাপতি হইবা আপনে

"You favouring our cauſe, ſhall yourſelf be the commander."

পঞ্চজন্য শংখ কৃষ্ণ বাজান আপনে।

"Ponchojonyo, the ſhell of Kreeſhno, ſounded of itſelf."

অবিচারে চোর বলেন এ কোন বিচার

"Without inveſtigation they pronounce me a thief, what juſtice is *this*?"

N.B. As এই is contracted to এ ſo is অই to ঐ

সে the pronoun of the third perſon, is the ſame in all genders, and is thus declined.

Singular.

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	Singular.		Plural.	
1	সে	he, ſhe, it.	তাহারা	they.
2	তাহা	him &c.	তাহারা	them.
3	তাহাতে	*by* or *with* him	তাহারদিগের	by them.
4	তাহারে	to him.	&c.	&c.
5	তাহাতে	from him.	.	.
6	তাহার	of him.	.	.
7	তাহায়	in him.	.	.

In all the oblique caſes of this pronoun, the স ſo of the nominative is changed into ত in which particularity it reſembles the pronoun of the Shanſcrit.

All the words of this diviſion, as well as that above quoted, add the ſyllable হা haa to their oblique caſes; thus,

দুরে থাকিয়া তাহা দেখে সর্ব্ব জন

"All the people beheld *him* from afar."

But this addition is occaſionally diſpenſed with in the inflexions of the fourth, ſixth and ſeventh caſes of the ſingular, and in the nominative plural, where a contracted form was aſſumed as was alſo obſerved in the caſes of আমি and তুমি Thus they uſe তারে for তাহারে তার for তাহার তায় for তাহায় and তারা for তাহারা

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Examples.

অতএব তারে তুমি কর সেনাপতি ।

"Therefore do you conſtitute *him* the commander."

এক লাফে পড়ে তার রথের উপর ।

"With one ſpring he darted upon *his* chariot."

বনমালা গলে দোলে মনি শোভা তায় ।

"A chaplet of flowers waves upon his neck, *in it* was an ornament of jewels."

দাস দাসী জত তারা পলাইয়া গেল ।
জত কিছু ছিল দ্রব্য বেচিয়া খাইল ॥

"Howmany ſoever male and female ſlaves there were, *they* are all fled,

"And have ſold whatſoever they had for their ſubſiſtance."

সে and এ are ſometimes oppoſed to each other, inſtead of the two regular demonſtratives এই and ঐই thus,

সে দেশে কি রস আছে এ দেশে তাহারা

"In *that* kingdom what are the pleaſures? In *this* kingdom they are theſe."

সহ or স is the Shanſcrit pronoun. It is ſometimes uſed for

for a demonſtrative in Bengaleſe; as

সহ চরিগন কয় কারে হিরা করে ভয়

"*Thoſe* damſels exclaim, whom does Heeraa fear?

যে is moſt commonly uſed in a conditional ſenſe, for *whoever* and *whatever*; and like সে has the ſame form for all genders: thus,

যে জন আপনা বুঝে পরদুস্থ তারে সুঝে।
সকলে আপন ভাবে জানে ॥

"*Whoever* well knows himſelf, by him is felt the calamity of "another; and he conſiders all men as himſelf."

This word is frequently doubled to convey more clearly a conditional meaning; যে যে *what what*; that is, *whatever*; as

করুনা করিয়া বলে রাজা যুধিষ্টিরে।
যে যে কথা বলিল নারদমুনি বরে।

"Raajaa Joodheeſteer weeping repeated,
"*Whatſoever* words the great Naarodmonee uttered."

যে is alſo the relative *qui* of the Latin, and agrees with সে like the antecedent *is*; as

যে বিধি করিন চাঁদে রাহুর আহার।
সেই বুঝি ঘটাইন সন্যাসী তাহার ॥

"Beedhee

"Beedhee, *who* made the moon the food of the Raahoo,
"I know *he* brought the Sonyaasee to her."

যে has the same mode of inflexion as সে thus, 1 যে 2 যাহা 3 যাহাতে 4 যাহারে 5 যাহাতে 6 যাহার 7 যাহায় &c. But the fourth and sixth cases are most usually contracted into যারে and যার as

দিয়াছে যে কড়ি যারে দিগুন সুনায় তারে

"Whatever cowries he had given to each person, he charges,
"him double the quantity."

কে is the interrogative *who*? (but its neuter *what*? is কি and is indeclinable.) Example.

আশ্বিনে এ দেশে দুর্গা পুজিমার পুচার।
কে জানে তোমার দেশে তাহার সঙ্কার॥

"In the month aasween in this kingdom the Idol Doorgaa is celebrated,
"*Who* in your kingdom knows its figure?"

কে is declined like the preceding words: and like them has its fourth and sixth cases generally contracted into কারে and কার as

কারে সেনাপতি করি কে করিবে পার

"*Whom*

"*Whom*, muſt I chooſe for commander? *Who* will bear us "through the ocean of the battle?"

কারে and কার are ſometimes ſubjoined to collective words in a relative ſenſe, referring to the particular *perſon*, who may have been previouſly mentioned in the ſentence or diſcourſe: thus সভা is an aſſembly, সভাকারে implies the *perſons* whom ſome aſſembly is ſuppoſed to contain. দুই is the numeral *two*, দুহা is a paſſive caſe derived from a modification of it; and from thence comes দুহাকারে *the two perſons* (of whom ſome mention has already been made.) Examples.

একে একে সভাকারে পুছিন কথনে

"He aſked *the perſons in the aſſembly* one by one ſome queſtion."

দুহাকার বানে দুহে হইন জর্জ্জর

"By the darts of each of *theſe two*, (i.e. the perſons who have been previouſly deſcribed as fighting together.) they were both "pierced full of wounds."

The vowel এ the termination of the nominative caſe to theſe pronouns, is frequently added to collective nouns, to give them a perſonal or relative ſenſe: Thus from লোক people, is formed লোকে *thoſe* people; from সভা an aſſembly, comes সভে *thoſe perſons* who compoſe the aſſembly; from সকল ſignify-

ſignifying *all*, is made সকলে all *the people*: ſo এক means *one*, একে one *perſon*. দুই is *two*, but give it the termination এ a, and inſert the letter হ্ ho, as deſcribed when the nominative ends in a pure vowel, it becomes দুহে and ſignifies two *perſons*, or *the* two *perſons*. Examples.

সর্ব্ব লোকে কহে যাও রাজার নিকট

"All *thoſe* people ſay, go before the Raajaa."

সভাতে বসিয়া সভে করয়ে বিচার

"Sitting in the aſſembly, *thoſe aſſembled* conſulted together."

দেখি কৃষ্ণ অর্জুন দুহে করে পুনিপাত

"Orjoon ſeeing Kreeſhno *they both* gave a ſalutation."

The word দুহে ſo compleatly aſſumes the character of a pronoun, that it becomes capable of all its inflexions; and is thus declined: 1 দুহে 2 দুহা 3 দুহাতে 4 দুহারে 5 দুহাতে 6 দুহার 7 দুহায় Examples.

তবে সভেউঠি দুহা নিবারন কৈল

"Then the people in the aſſembly aroſe and ſeparated *thoſe* "*two perſons*."

বানবৃষ্টি করে দুহে দুহার উপর।
দুহাকার বানে দুহে হইল জর্জ্জর॥

"*Thoſe*

"*Thoſe perſons* caſt at *each other* a ſhower of arrows,
"And by *each other's* darts they were *both* pierced full of wounds."

A repetition of theſe and other ſuch words, implies a diſtributive or reciprocal relation of perſons; as দুহে দুহে *each other*, or *both*; অন্যে অন্যে *each other*, from অন্য *another*; একে একে *one* by *one*, or ſometimes *oneanother*.

একে একে সভাকারে পুছিন কথনে

"He aſked them all *one by one* ſome queſtion."

একে একে করে বীর বানের প্রহার।

"The Heroes attacked *each other* with darts."

অন্যে অন্যে সারথী কাটিন অস্ব রথ।
দুহে মহা বলবন্ত দুহে মহা সত্ত॥

"The charioteers reciprocally hacked *each other's* horſes and carriage;
"*Both* exceedingly ſtrong, and *both* exceedingly brave."

In all languages there are certain particles expreſſive of doubt as to number, quantity, perſonality, quality &c. and correſpondent reſponſives, ſimply reverſing the ſame indefinite terms, in which the antecedent was propounded; as *how many? ſo many. how much? ſo much. any one? no one. ſuch as, ſo* &c. Theſe are uſually denominated *indefinite pronouns*, and therefore

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I have added them to this chapter. They are all aptotes in Bengaleſe, as in Latin and Greek; and in Shanſcrit are ranked with other indeclinable particles, in the claſs elegantly called নিপাত or *without leaves*, from their producing no inflexions.

কত koto *how many? quot*; তত toto *ſo many, tot.*

কত দিন ছিন রাজা অরন্যের মাঝে

"*how many* days was the Raajaa in the deſert?

কত is often doubled, like the conditional যে to add energy to the expreſſion; as

কত কত বীর মারে বৃক্ষের পুহারে

"*What a number* of Heroes did he deſtroy by the ſtrokes of his club!"

জত is a conditional, and implies *how many ſoever.*

জত অস্ত্র এড়ে বীর তত পেনে কাটি

"*How many* darts *ſoever* the Hero flung, *ſo many* he ſhivered and threw down."

কেহ *any one, ſome one.* কিচ্ছু *anything, ſomething.* কেহনা *not any one, no one.* কিচ্ছুনা *not anything, nothing.*

যায় রনে যোদ্ধাগন কেহ নাহি স্থির

"All the warriors go from the fight; there is not *any one* that "remains unmoved."

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অবশ্য করিব যুদ্ধ নাহি কিছু ডর

"I will aſſuredly fight, for there is not *any* fear."

কোন কিবা and কেবা are interrogatives and ſignify *who*, or *what*? and are indeclinable; as

করিব কোন উপায় "*What* remedy ſhall I apply?

কিবা রূপ কিবা গুন কহিনেক ভাট

"Bhaat ſaid, *what* beauty *what* wiſdom!

নিজ is an indeclinable poſſeſſive ſignifying *own*, (*proprius*) and is joined to any other noun, in a reflective ſenſe referring to the leading ſubſtantive in the ſentence; as

এই রূপে রামাগনঃ কহে পরস্পর।
স্নান করি যায় সভে নিজ নিজ ঘর॥
আনছলে পুন চাহে ফিরিয়া ফিরিয়া।
পিঞ্জিরের পাখি মত বেড়ায় ঘুরিয়া॥

"In this manner the beautiful women talk to one another,
"And having bathed, each goes to her *own* houſe.
"Again with ſecret glances they look at him repeatedly,
"Fluttering round and round like birds in a cage."

নিজ গৃহে প্রবেসিল রাজার কুমার

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"The ſon of the Raajaa arrived at *his own* reſidence."

রাবনেরে বধি রাম সীতা আনে নিজ ধাম

"Raam having defeated Raabon, brought Seetaa to *his own* "Palace."

আপ্ত is another reflective aptote, which is always blended with its immediate ſubject; as

আপ্ত কথা ব্যক্ত কৈনা এই দুখে মরি

"You have betrayed *our ſecrets*; and I die of this injury."

Many other indeclinable particles are formed from ſeveral pronouns by adding to them the terminations ন *no*, ত *to*, এক *ako*, or হ *ho*; as কেন from কে জেন from জে তেন the returning particle to জেন হেন from এ a contraction of এই এত and এইত from the ſame, জতেক from জত এতেক from এত সেহ from সে &c.

I ſhall conclude this ſection with an inſtance of each of them.

কেন *why* or *what*? as

আজি কেন মন মোর করে ওচাটন

"Today why is my heart afflicted?

রানীর দেখিয়া হান জিজ্ঞাসয়ে মহিপান
কেন কেন কহ সবিশেষ

"Be-

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"Beholding the condition of the Raanee, the ſhepherd of the
"world ſaid, *what what* is this? tell me the whole of it."

জেন *as* or *like*, তেন *ſo* or *ſuch*; as

মৃত্যু কালে জেন ঔষধ নাথায়।
তেন মত দুর্য্যোধন অজ্ঞানের প্রায়॥

"*As* at the time of death a man refuſes all medicine,
"*So* Dcorjodhon becaine almoſt void of reaſon."

হেন *this*; as হেন কালে সাত্যকি উচিন ভূমে হইতে
"At *this* inſtant Saaty*o*k*ee* aroſe from the ground."

এত *this*; as এত বলি যুঝিতে চলিল বীর বর
"Saying *this*, the great Hero haſted to engage."

এইত *this*; as এইত শ্রাবন মাসে ধারা বরিসে গগনে
"In *this* month Shraab*o*n the rain falls from heaven."

জতেক *howmany ſoever*; as

জতেক দেখিয়া পুত্র পৌত্র পরিবার।
কেহ কার নহে পার্থ সকল সংহার॥

"*Howmany ſoever* children, grandchildern and relations I ſaw,
"O Paart,h*o*! there are none of them left, they are all ſlain."

এতেক *this*; as

এতেক সুনিয়া সেনী অতি ক্রোধ মন।
কোপে ডাক দিয়া বলে সুন সর্ব্ব জন॥

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"Having heard *this*, Sanee much enraged,
"Exclaimed in great anger, Hear O all ye people!"

সেহ *that*; as

ধনু যদি কাটা গেল অন্য ধনু নয়।
সেহ ধনু কাটি এড়ে দ্রোন মহাসয় ॥

"When his bow was broken he took another bow,
"But the valiant *Dron* ſhivered *that* bow alſo."

জ *jo* and ত *to* are frequently affixed to ſubſtantives in the conditional ſenſe of জেন and তেন as জখন at what time ſoever, (*when*) তখন at the ſame time (*then.*) Example.

সেনী দেখি সোমদত্ত উঠিল তখন

"Somdott beholding Sanee, aroſe *at the ſame time.*"

CHAPTER IV.

OF VERBS.

THE Shanſcrit, the Arabic, the Greek and the Latin verbs are furniſhed with a ſet of inflexions and terminations ſo comprehenſive and ſo complete, that by their form alone they can expreſs all the different diſtinctions both of perſon and time.

Three

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Three ſeparate qualities are in them perfectly blended and united. Thus by their root they denote a particular act, and by their inflexion both point out the time when it takes place, and number of the agent.

In moſt of the modern languages of Europe, as in many of the dialects of Aſia, theſe ſeveral modifications of the verb require to be ſeparately defined by pronouns, particles and auxiliary verbs. In Perſian for inſtance, as well as in Engliſh, the verb admits but of two forms, one for the preſent tenſe, and one for the aoriſt; and it is obſervable that while the paſt tenſe is provided for by a peculiar inflexion, the future is generally ſupplied by an additional word, conveying only the idea of time, without any other influence on the act implied by the principal verb. It is alſo frequently neceſſary that the different ſtate of the action, as perfect or imperfect, be further aſcertained, in each of the tenſes paſt, preſent and future. This alſo in the learned languages is performed by other variations of inflexion; for which other verbs and other particles are applied in the modern tongues of Europe and Perſia.

Every Shanſcrit verb has a form equivalent to the middle voice of the Greek, uſed through all the tenſes with a reflective ſenſe; and the former is even the moſt extenſive of the two in its

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its uſe and office: for in Greek the reflective idea can only be adopted intranſitively, when the action of the verb deſcends to no extraneous ſubject; but in Shanſcrit the verb is both reciprocal and tranſitive at the ſame time; as আপূপ° পচতি সূদঃ *a cook prepares bread.* আপূপ° পচতে সূদঃ a cook prepares bread *for himſelf.* The ſimple tranſitive is called in Shanſcrit পরস্মৈ পদ Poroſmai pod; the reflective আত্মনে পদ Aatmonee pod.

The verbs of the Engliſh, however deficient of inflexions, have a very copious ſtock of auxiliaries: excluſive of thoſe which are common to moſt languages, the uſage of the word *to do* in its preſent and paſt tenſes, joined to infinitives or verbal nouns is peculiar to our idiom, to the Perſian, and to the Bengaleſe. In the latter the verb করন *to do* is uſed through all its tenſes as an auxiliary: thus they ſay indiſcriminately বরিসে *it rains*, and বরিসন করে *it does rain*; রনিনাম *I fought*, and রন করিনাম *I did fight.*

As neither the Shanſcrit, the Bengaleſe, nor the Hindoſtanic have any word preciſely anſwering to the ſenſe of the verb *I have*, the idea is always expreſſed by আমার স্থান আছি *eſt mihi*, and conſequently there is no auxiliary form for the Bengal

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Bengal verb correſpondent to *I have* written; but the ſenſe is conveyed by নিখিনাম or নিখিয়াছি

There is no occaſion for the application of an auxiliary to the future and ſubjunctive tenſes, as they are both provided for by ſeparate inflexions of the ſimple verb; in which inſtances the Bengal verb has certainly the ſuperiority over thoſe of the Engliſh, which otherwiſe they ſeem greatly to reſemble.

I ſhall firſt preſent a paradigm of the auxiliary verb, becauſe it is neceſſary to the formation of various tenſes in all the other verbs.

The verb ſubſtantive *to be* ſeems in all languages defective and irregular. In Shanſcrit it is called অর্দ্ধ ধাতুক *ſemi-verb*, becauſe it wants the form for the reflective ſenſe.

It may be curious to obſerve that the preſent tenſe of this verb both in Greek and Latin (perhaps I might add in the Perſian) appears to be directly derived from that of the Shanſcrit, for which reaſon I here inſert it.

SINGULAR.	DUAL.	PLURAL.
অস্মি *I am*	স্বঃ *we two are*	স্মঃ *we are*
অসি *thou art*	স্থঃ *ye two are*	স্থ *ye are*
অস্তি *he is*	স্তঃ *they two are*	সন্তি *they are*

This

This verb in Bengaleſe has but two diſtinctions of time; the preſent and the paſt, the terminations of the ſeveral perſons of which ſerve as a model for thoſe of the ſame tenſes in all other verbs reſpectively.

The firſt Bengal auxiliary আছি *I am.*

Preſent tenſe.

Singular.		Plural.	
আছি	*I am*	আছি আমরা	*we are*
আছিস	*thou art*	আছ	*ye are*
আছে	*he is*	আছেন	*they are*

Paſt tenſe.

আছিনাম	*I was*	আছিনাম আমরা	*we were*
আছিনি	*thou wert*	আছিনা	*ye were*
আছিন	*he was*	আছিনেন	*they were*

আ the terminating vowel of the ſecond perſon plural of the paſt tenſe, is frequently changed into এ and they write indiſcriminately আছিনা and আছিনে *ye were*; as

জটি টাকা দিয়াছিনে সব গুনি খোটা

"Whatever Rupees you gave are all defective."

The firſt ſyllable of the verb ſubſtantive আছি is always dropped, when joined in its auxiliary capacity to the participles of

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of other verbs; as কহিতেছি *I am ſpeaking*, not কহিতে আছি গিয়াছিনাম *I had gone*, not গিয়া আছি নাম

Examples.

যে নাজ পাইয়াছি কহিতে নাজ পাও

"The diſgrace which I have ſuffered is diſgraceful even to be "uttered."

আট পনে আধ সের পাইয়াছিনি

"Thou hadſt purchaſed half a ſeer for eight Pons."

The ſame uſage occaſionally obtains with the paſt tenſe of আছি when connected with adjectives, or other words, and not ſubſervient to the participle of another verb.

শিশু ছিনাম বৃদ্ধ হইনাম চিন্তিতে চিন্তিতে

"I was young, but became old by repeated anxiety."

But notwithſtanding this inſtance, the tenſes of the verb ſubſtantive হওন *to be* are moſt commonly applied with ſubſtantives or adjectives, as thoſe of আছি are with participles.

Of Conjugations.

The verbs of the Bengal language may be divided into three claſſes, which are diſtinguiſhed by their penultimate letter.

1. The ſimple and moſt common form has an open conſonant immediately preceding the final letter of the infinitive; as

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করন *to do*, দেখন *to see*, চিনুন *to think.*

2. The second conjugation is compoſed of thoſe words whoſe final letter is preceded by ও pure, (that is, with another vowel or an open conſonant before it) as জাওন *to go* হওন *to become* পাওন *to acquire.*

3. The third claſs conſiſts entirely of cauſals derived from words of the firſt or ſecond conjugation, and is known by having আ for its penultimate letter; as ডরান *to cauſe to fear*, or *to terrify*, from ডরন *to fear*; লিখান *to cauſe to write*, from লিখন *to write*; খাওয়ান *to make to eat*, from খাওন *to eat.*

The ſeveral tenſes of each of theſe conjugations are formed exactly upon the ſame principle: the only difference conſiſts in the mode of applying their diacritical terminations, and is contained in the following rule.

In the firſt and third conjugations the final ন *no* only of the infinitive is dropped, to make room for the ſigns of the tenſes; while verbs of the ſecond claſs throw away the two letters ও o, and ন no. Thus লিখি *I write*, from লিখন লিখাই *I cauſe to write*, from লিখান জাই I *go*, from জাওন হই I *become*, from হওন

The ſource or original ſtamen of a Bengal verb of the firſt conjugation muſt generally be ſought for among the primary roots of the

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the Shanſcrit, which never enter into compoſition. Thus ঢ়ুকৃঞ্ or কৃ (called *kru* by Dupont) is the Shanſcrit root which implies *the idea of action*, and from whence proceed both the verb *to do*, and alſo a great number of nouns expreſſive of different modifications of the ſame idea, all derived from the two radicals ক and ঋ or র as কর্ত্তা an agent, কর্ম্ম an action কার্য্য an affair, কার a particle of agency ſubjoined to other words, &c.

From the Shanſcrit infinitive করন° is formed a Bengal word করন which, though in conſtruction it bear the ſenſe of a verbal noun, and be declined in the manner of a ſubſtantive, is always conſidered by the more learned Bengaleſe as the *root*, or infinitive of their verb: and thus ſeems rather to reſemble the infinitives of the Arabic, than thoſe of the Greek or Latin; as in the following inſtances, where মরন *to die* and জীবন *to live* are applied ſubſtantively for *life* and *death*, and aſſume the ſign of the oblique caſe.

মরনের কালে রাজা গোবিন্দ ভাবিয়া।
স্বর্গপুরি চলি গেল রথেতে চড়িয়া॥

"At the hour *of death* the Raajaa reflected upon Goveend,(God)
"and mounted in his car went haſtening to Paradiſe."

জীবনে মরনে বাপি রাধকৃষ্ণ গতি মম

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"In *life* and *death* may the paternal care of Raadhaakreeſhno *be* "my ſupport!"

Verbs of the ſecond conjugation are derived from ſuch Shanſcrit roots as have only one conſonant; and as it ſeems contrary to the idiom of the Bengal language to admit of monoſyllabic infinitives, the ſyllable ওন is added to the Shanſcrit root to make up the deficiency.

Thus from জা Shanſcrit *to go*, is formed জাওন Bengaleſe; and from গৈ *to ſing*, গাওন

From the verbal noun, as above deſcribed, I ſhall deduce the ſeveral tenſes uſed by the Bengaleſe, and illuſtrate the rules for each by ſelect examples.

The preſent tenſe indefinite is formed by ſubſtituting the perſonal terminations applied in conjugating the word আছি for the final ন of the infinitive in the firſt and third conjugations, and for ওন in the ſecond; as from দেখন *to ſee* comes দেখি *I ſee*, from জাওন *to go* জাই *I go*, and from ডরান *to terrify* is made ডরাই *I terrify*.

Example.

অগ্নি বর্ন সব দেখি সঘনে আকাষ।
দিবসেতে ধুম কেত্ত করয়ে পুকাষ॥

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" *I ſee* all the Heavens as it were in a cloud of fire,
" The ſtar Dhoomkatoo diſplays its brightneſs in the open day."

সমর্থ সংগ্রামে পড়ি স্বর্গ জাই আমি।
এই পাপে ধনঞ্জয় জাবে অধোগামি॥

" Falling in the line of battle I *aſcend* to Paradiſe,
" But thou, O Dhonongjoy, for this crime wilt go to hell."

The form for the participle preſent is the ſame with that of the firſt perſon of this preſent tenſe; as দেখি *ſeeing* or I *ſee*, আসি *coming* or I *come*; as

শকুবীর ভঙ্গ দেখি দ্রোনের নন্দন।
অর্জুন সমরে আসি দিল দরশন॥

" The ſon of Dron *beholding* the flight of the Kooroos, *coming*
" into the preſence of Orjoon, diſcovered himſelf!"

The firſt gerund or ſupine is formed from this participle, by adding to it the termination of the oblique caſe তে as কান্দিতে *in* or *by weeping*, মরিতে *in dying*, হইতে *in becoming* &c. Example.

কান্দিতে কান্দিতে রানী হইল মুর্চ্ছিত

" *By repeated weeping* the Raanee became ſenſeleſs."

This gerund commonly ſupplies the place and the uſe of our in-

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infinitive mood; for when two verbs come together, the ſecond in conſtruction generally bears this form, and muſt be attended with the ſign *to* in tranſlation; as

বুঝিতে নাপারি প্রাননাথ এ আর কেমন পিরিতি

"I am not able *to conceive*, O maſter of my ſoul, what manner "of affection this can be."

শিশু সঙ্গে বেরাইন রাখিতে গোধন।
বন মধ্যে বনৎকার কৈন নারীগন॥

"He conducted the children *to tend* the cattle; but in the deſart "he uſed violence with the women."

তপস্যা করিতে বনে করিন পয়ান

"He retired to the deſart *to pray*."

The ſame oblique caſe of the participle preſent, and ſometimes its nominative, is joined to the contracted form of the tenſes of the verb ſubſtantive আছি to make a definitive preſent, and paſt tenſe; as লিখিতেছি I *write* or *am writing* (literally I *am in writing*) বলিছে *he ſays*, করিতেছিলাম I *did* or *was doing*, &c.

মালিনী বলিছে আমি দুখিনী মালিনী

"The Herb-woman ſays, I am but a forlorn peaſant."

It

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It is alſo joined to the preſent tenſe of the verb চাহন *to be willing* to expreſs a future of determination or deſire &c, like the Perſian خواہم as নিখিতে চাহি I *will* write, I am deſirous to write, জাইতে চাহি I *want to go*, I *will go*.

The indefinite preterite is made by adopting for the infinitive termination the ſign of the paſt tenſe of আছি as দেখন *to ſee* দেখিনাম I *ſaw*, নওন *to take* নইনাম I *took*, করান *to cauſe to make* করাইনাম

আমি দেখিনাম অপরূপ রূপের বাজার

"I beheld a moſt beautiful perſon, an aſſemblage of charms."

In the dialect of ſome particular provinces of Bengal the laſt ſyllable নাম of this tenſe is changed into নু or নাও in the firſt perſon: and the copyiſts adopt the alteration in their Books; as may be obſerved in the *Beedyaaſoondor*, where নাও is almoſt conſtantly written for নাম as among a number of inſtances

কৃপা কর রাধানাথ নইনাও সরন

"Befriend me, O Raadhaanaat,ho! I have aſſumed thy protecti-
"on."

হর বনে বর দিনু সুনহ রাজন

"The God ſaid, hear O Raajaa, I have granted the favour."

From

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From this tenſe proceeds a ſecond gerund with an ablative form and ſenſe, and to be conſtrued with the ſign *in* or *from*; as শুনিলে *in hearing*, or more properly *in having heard* &c.

পাণ্ডব বিজয় কথা অমৃত নহরি।
শুনিলে অধর্ম্ম হবে পরলোক তরি॥

"The relation of the victories of Paandob is a river of the wa-
"ter of life.
"*In having heard it*, my ſins are pardoned and I am cleanſed
"among the Porolok." (the ſouls of the deceaſed)

রায় বলে চাতরি কহিলে কিবা হবে

"Raay ſaid, what will be the event *of* thus *deceiving*?"

The vowel আ being added to the participle of the preſent tenſe forms that of the paſt; as মরিয়া *having died* হইয়া *having become* &c.

This participle like the former is prefixed reſpectively to the auxiliary words ছি and ছিনাম to expreſs a farther diſcrimination of the paſt tenſe. The firſt of theſe tenſes we may ſtyle the *perfect preterite*, and the latter the *preterpluperfect*; thus জিনিয়াছি *I have conquered* গিয়াছিনাম *I had gone* &c.

Example.

আমি জে হই সে হই আমি জে হই সে হই।
জিনিয়াছি পলে বিদ্যা ছাড়ি জাব নাই॥

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"I am what I am, I am what I am."

"But as I *have conquered*, (in the conditions of the marriage)

"I will not go and quit Beedyaa."

নাগরহে গিয়াছিনাম নগরের হাট

"O Naagor, I *had gone* to the market in the city."

The ſecond perſon of the imperative is formed from the infinitive, by throwing away the final ন as করন *to do* কর *do thou*, সিখন *to learn* সিখ *learn thou*, সিখান *to cauſe to learn* (i.e. *to teach*) সিখা *teach thou*, খাওন *to eat* খাও *eat thou.*

মহা বলবান ভীম কর সেনাপতি

"*Make* the mighty athletic Bheem your general."

যাওরে রজনি তুমি মরিয়া

"O Night, *do thou*, having periſhed, *depart.*"

The other perſons of the imperative reſemble thoſe of the preſent tenſe reſpectively: except only the third, which has a termination peculiar to itſelf, and unlike every other part of the verb. It is derived from the ſecond perſon by the addition of ুক as জিন *conquer thou* জিনুক *let him conquer*, হ *be thou* হুক *let him be*; পড়া *fell thou*, from পড়ান *to cauſe to fall* পড়াুক *let him fell.* Example.

মহা ধনুদ্ধর হুক আমার সন্ততি

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"*Let* my ſon *become* a mighty Bowman."

The letter হ is ſometimes added to the ſecond perſons of the imperative and preſent tenſe, to give weight and energy to the expreſſion. I conceive it to be a contraction of হে the ſign of the Shanſcrit vocative ſubjoined to the verb, which is a very common idiom of the Bengaleſe. Examples.

শিব বলে বর মাগ সুনহ রাজন

"The God ſaid, *hear* O Raajaa, demand ſome favour."

যদি না করহ মোর বাক্যের পালন।
তিক্ষন বানে খণ্ড খণ্ড করিব এখন॥

"If *you do* not ſurely obey my words,
"I will immediately cut you in pieces with my ſharp ſcymetar.

ইতাম is the termination of the conditional or ſubjective, which is added to the radical letters of the infinitive: as from ধরন *to ſeize* proceeds ধরিতাম *I would ſeize*, যাইতাম *I would go* from যাওন &c.

সেনাপতি আগে যদি করিতাম কর্ন্নেরে।
এক দিনে ধরিতাম রাজা যুধিষ্টিরে॥

"If *I had* before *made* Kornno a general,
"In one day *I ſhould have ſeized* Raajaa Joodheeſhteer."

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পক্ষি হইয়া জন্মিতাম থাকিতাম বৃন্দাবনে।
অবশ্য কৃষ্ণের নাম সুনিতাম শ্রবনে॥

" *Were I* a bird, *I would remain* in the woods of Breendaabon:
" ſurely *I ſhould hear* in mine ear the name of Kreeſhno."

The future is formed by adding the termination ইব to the radicals of the infinitive; as লিখিব I *will write*, কহিব *I will ſpeak* পাইব I *ſhall acquire* &c.

কি কহিব সোভা রতি মন লোভা মদন
মুহিত লাজে

" How *ſhall I deſcribe* her beauty! Rotee eagerly wiſhes it, and
" Modon is envious and aſhamed."

But often, in the ſecond conjugation, the ſign of the future is contracted to ব as যাব I *will* go, not যাইব &c. হব for হইব as

একা যাব বর্দ্ধমান করিয়া যতন

" *I will go* alone to Burdwan, upon mature conſideration."

বিসয় আসয় বুঝি রাজ পুত্র হবা

" Beyond all doubt, I am convinced you *muſt be* a Raajaa's ſon."

From this tenſe ſeems to proceed the third gerund with the ſenſe of *for* or *on account of*, by adding the termination বার as

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as লিখিবার *for to write* করিবার *for to do.*

করিবার মানভঙ্গ কবি কহে কত রঙ্গ

"*For to diſſipate* his paſſion, he uſed various kinds of verſes."

It ſometimes has the ſenſe of a genitive; as

আসিবার কালে মিত্র নহিল দরশন

"At the time *of my coming* my friend was not preſent."

এ enclytic is frequently added to this gerund as well as to every part of ſpeech.

সাজিয়া আইল সভে করিবারে রন

"They all came ready prepared *for to fight.*"

The third perſon ſingular of the future, and of the ſimple preterite frequently aſſumes the termination এক inſtead of the regular form; as কহিলেক for কহিল *he ſpoke,* হইবেক for হইবে *he will be.*

দশ বান বিন্ধিলেক কর্ণের হৃদয়

"*He ſhot* ten arrows into Kornno's body."

কে বুঝিবেক এ ঘোর "Who *will underſtand* this "calamity!"

The letter ক is one of the enclytics, and is ſubjoined to various tenſes of verbs, as চ is to the accuſative of ſubſtantives without

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without any particular meaning, meerly to fill up the meaſure of the verſe, or as a diſtinction of dialect.

Negative verbs are formed by the particle ন or না prefixed or ſubjoined to any of the tenſes; as

না জানি কি হইন রাজা যুধিষ্ঠির

"I *know not* what is become of Raajaa *Joodheeſhteer*."

কি করি বলনা আন সুলোচনা কেমনে
আনিব তারে

"You *tell me not* what I muſt do, O my love with bright eyes,
"how ſhall I bring him?"

নাহি the Shanſcrit negative is frequently applied in compoſition for the regular Bengal word; as

দ্রোন বলে সুন রাজা বচন আমার।
ইহার বিনে যুক্তি আমি নাহি দেখি আর॥

"Dron ſaid, O Raajaa attend to my word,
"Except this I *ſee not* any other counſel."

When ন or না is prefixed to the verb ſubſtantive হওন the open vowel of the penultimate is uſually dropped in all the inflexions of the tenſes; as নহে inſtead of নহয় and নহিন for নহইন thus in an inſtance lately quoted.

আসিবার কালে মিত্র নহিন দরশন

"At

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"At the time of my arrival, my friend *was not* viſible."

The Shanſcrit নাহি very often adopts the place as well as the form of this negative verb and particularly in the third perſon of the preſent tenſe.

নাহি ধন নাহি জন নাহিক স্বহায়।
কেমতে বিধী জজ্ঞ না দেখি উপায়॥

"I have no treaſure (*non eſt gaza*) I have no ſervants, I have no "aſſiſtance,

"How ſhall I perform this ſacrifice? I ſee no method."

Paradigm of an active verb.

Preſent tenſe indefinite.

	Singular.		Plural.
করি	I do	করি আমরা	we do
করিস	thou doſt	কর	ye do
করে	he doth	করেন	they do

Definite Preſent.

করিতেছি	I am doing	করিতেছি আমরা	we &c.
করিতেছিস	thou art doing	করিতেছ	ye are doing
করিতেছে	he is doing	করিতেছেন	they are doing

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Simple Preterite.

করিনাম	I did	করিনাম আমরা	we did
করিলি	thou didst	করিলা	ye did
করিল	he did	করিলেন	they did

Imperfect Preterite.

করিতেছিলাম	I was doing	করিতেছিলাম আমরা	we [were doing
করিতেছিলি	thou wert &c.	করিতেছিলা	ye were &c.
করিতেছিল	he was &c.	করিতেছিলেন	they &c.

Perfect Preterite.

Singular.		Plural.	
করিয়াছি	I have done	করিয়াছি আমরা	we &c.
করিয়াছিস	thou haft done	করিয়াছ	ye have done
করিয়াছে	he hath done	করিয়াছেন	they have done

Preter-pluperfect.

করিয়াছিলাম	I had done	করিয়াছিলাম আমরা	we [had done
করিয়াছিলি	thou hadst &c	করিয়াছিলা	ye had done
করিয়াছিল	he had done	করিয়াছিলেন	they had &c.

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Singular.		Plural.	
		Future.	
করিব	I ſhall or will do	করিব আমরা	we ſhall do
করিবি	thou ſhalt do	করিবা	ye ſhall do
করিবে	he ſhall do	করিবেন	they ſhall do
		Conditional or Aoriſt.	
করিতাম	I ſhould do	করিতাম আমরা	we &c.
করিতিস	thou ſhould'ſt do	করিতা & করিতে	ye &c.
করিত	he ſhould do	করিতেন	they ſhould do
		Imperative.	
. . . . .		করি আমরা	let us do
কর	do thou	কর	do ye
করুক	let him do	করেন	let them do

Infinitive, or verbal Noun, করন to do.

Participles.

Preſent, করি doing. Paſt, করিয়া having done.

Gerunds and Supines.

করিতে করিনে করিবার in writing, from writing, to write &c.

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The paſſive voice is very ſeldom uſed by the Bengaleſe: but is formed from a peculiar participle of the active verb, applied to the ſeveral tenſes of যাওন *to go*, exactly in the ſame manner as the paſſives of the Engliſh are compounded of a participle, and the ſeveral tenſes of the auxiliary verb *to be*.

This paſſive participle may be formed from infinitives of the firſt conjugation, by changing the final ন into আ as from লিখন *to write* লিখা *written*, কাটন *to cut* কাটা *cut*.

Example.

যাছিন রাজার পুত্র কহিন তাহায়।
পড়িবা সকল পুথি জত লিখা যায়।

"There was a Raajaa's ſon, to whom he ſaid,
"You ſhall read all books whatever *that are written*."

ধ্বজ কাটা গেল তার অল্প অল্প সরে।
দুই বীরে হানাহানি সংগ্রাম ভিতরে॥

"His ſtandard *was cut* into pieces by the arrows,
"And there was a violent conflict between the two Heroes in
"the midſt of the battle."

In verbs of the ſecond claſs, the paſt participle of the active ſerves alſo for the paſſive voice; but few words of this conjugation are thus applied: দিয়া however ſignifies both *having given*, (active) and *given*; (paſſive) as

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কি কারন দিয়া গিয়াছিন সে টাকা

"On what account had thoſe rupees *been given*?

I have never ſeen verbs of the third conjugation uſed paſſively.

যাওন *to go*, or in its auxiliary capacity *to be*, is irregular in the paſt tenſes.

It is declined as follows.

Preſent tenſe indefinite	যাই I go.		
Definite preſent	যাইতেছি I am going,		
which is often contracted to	যাচ্ছি		
Irregular preterite	গেনাম I went.		
Preterimperfect	যাইতেছিনাম I was going.		
Perfect preterite	গিয়াছি I have gone.		
Preterpluperfect	গিয়াছিনাম I had gone.		
Future	যাইব	or	যাব I ſhall go.
Conditional	যাইতাম I would go.		

Imperative যা go thou, যাউক let him go, যাইয়ামরা let us go, যাও go ye, যান let them go.

Participles যাই going, গিয়া and যাইয়া having gone.

Tho' the irregular participle গিয়া is always uſed to form the paſt tenſes of যাওন yet in other caſes, where the auxiliaries ছি and ছিনার are not applied, the participle যাইয়া regularly formed from the infinitive, not unfrequently occurs; as

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কাছে যাইয়া হাস্যা হাস্যা করয়েজি জ্ঞাসা।
কে তুমি কোথায় ঘর কোন খানে বাস্যা ॥

"*Having gone* near, and ſmiled repeatedly, ſhe makes enquiry,
"Saying who are you, where is your houſe, and in what place
"is your abode?"

Gerunds and ſupines যাইতে গেনে যাইবার in going, from going, to go &c.

Other verbs ſometimes ſupply the place of যাওন in forming the paſſive voice, as পড়ন to fall, পাওন to acquire, and হওন to be, compounded with the paſſive participle: nor is it contrary to the Bengal idiom to ſay মারাপড়িনাম or মারা পাইনাম or মারা হইনাম *I was beaten*, altho' in books we very ſeldom ſee any other mode of expreſſion than মারা গেনাম

দেওন *to give* is alſo irregular, and is made to reſemble a verb of the firſt conjugation by throwing away the vowel এ of its firſt ſyllable through all the tenſes, except ſome perſons of the imperative; as দি *I give*, ſeldom or never দেই · দিনাম *I gave*, not দেইয়াম · দিতেছি *I am giving*, not দেইতেছি · দিয়াছি *I have given*, not দেইয়াছি &c.

Imperative দেও or দেহ *give thou*, দেউক *let him give*

দি আমরা *let us give*, দেহ *give ye*, দেন *let them give*.

হওন *to be*, লওন *to take*, &c, are regular, as their firſt conſonant retains the inherent vowel through all the inflexions; thus হই I *am*, নই I *take*, not হি and নি হইলাম I *was*, নইলাম I *took*, হইতে হইয়া নইতে নইয়া &c.

পাওন *to acquire* is declined exactly like the verbs of the third conjugation, the vowel আ conſtantly preceding all the diacritical terminations; as

Preſent tenſe indefinite	পাই I acquire.
Definite preſent	পাইতেছি I am acquiring.
Paſt tenſe	পাইলাম I acquired.
Preter imperfect	পাইতেছিলাম I was &c.
Perfect preterite	পাইয়াছি I have acquired.
Preterpluperfect	পাইয়াছিলাম I had acquired.
Future	পাইব I ſhall acquire.
Conditional	পাইতাম I would acquire.
Imperative	পা or পাও acquire thou.
Gerunds and ſupines	পাইতে পাইলে পাইবার in acquiring, from acquiring, to acquire &c.

In this manner verbs of the third claſs are univerſally conjugated; as করাই করাইলাম করাইব &c.

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Example.

রাবণেরে বধি রাম সীতা আনে নিজ ধাম
করাইল পরীক্ষা দাহনে

"Raam killing Raawon brought Seetaa home to his own resi-
"dence, and *caused her to perform* the ordeal with fire."

রথ চালাইয়া দেহ অতি সিঘ্রতর

"*Having caused* the car *to hasten*, give it me with all expedition."

নদিয়া শান্তিপুর হইতে থেয়ুড়া আনাইব।
নৌতুন নৌতুন জাতে থেয়ুড় শুনাইব॥

"I *will cause* the sacred odes *to come* from Nodeeyaa in Saanteepoor;
"I will *make you hear* odes constantly new."

Some few verbs admit a contracted form in many of their tenses, particularly in the simple preterites; as for আসিনাম I came, they usually put আইনাম for করিনাম I made or did কৈনাম

But this remark most properly belongs to prosody, as those words are generally so contracted to suit the rythm of the verse. Several instances of this contraction may be found dispersed about this work: one will suffice in this place.

তোমা ছাড়ি যাব যদি অন্যের নিকটে।
তবে কেন তোমা নাগি আইনাম সঙ্কটে॥

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"If I ſhould now forſake you and go to another,

"Why then *came* I through ſo many dangers to viſit you?"

Another very extraordinary contraction is that of নাপারি I *cannot*, (from the verb পারন *to be able*) into নারি as,

ভাবিয়া করিতে নারি স্থির

"I *cannot* bring my reflections to any fixed point"

আমি কহিবার চাহি রাজারে রানীরে।
কি বুঝিয়া করে মানা নারি বুঝিবারে॥

"I am deſirous to addreſs the Raajaa and Raanee,

"What they have heard that hinders me, I *cannot* diſcover."

I have already ſhewn that the verb ſubſtantive of the Shanſcrit very nearly reſembles thoſe of the Greek and Latin; but perhaps it would not be ſuſpected that all the verbs in *mi* are formed exactly upon the ſame principle with the Shanſcrit conjugations, even in the minuteſt particulars.

Thus from দা the root which ſignifies *to give*, the preſent tenſe is made by adding the ſyllable মি and doubling the firſt conſonant. It is thus declined,

Singular.	দদামি	দদাসি	দদাতি
Dual.	দদ্ব	দত্থঃ	দত্তঃ
Plural.	দদ্ম	দত্থ	দদতি

To

To form the paſt tenſe, we muſt apply the ſyllablic augment as in the Greek; and in fact the very ſame letter: for অ in Shanſcrit anſwers to *e pſilon*: thus it becomes অদদম্ I *gave*.

The future has the letter স্য for its characteriſtic as we find in the Greek, and it omits the reduplication of the firſt conſonant as দাস্যামি I *will give*.

I cannot inſert the Greek form for want of types; but the learned reader will not fail to be convinced of the ſimilitude. Let me add that the reduplication of the firſt conſonant is not conſtantly applied to the preſent tenſes of the Shanſcrit, more than to thoſe of the Greek.

The natural ſimplicity and elegance of many of the Aſiatic languages appear to be greatly debaſed and corrupted, by the continual abuſe of auxiliary or ſubſidiary verbs: at leaſt this inconvenience has evidently affected the Perſian, the Hindoſtanic and the Bengal idioms. The mode of expreſſion to which I allude, might have been a conſiderable embelliſhment to language, if applied with judgement and caution; but the perpetual repetition has both deſtroyed the good effect of an occaſional relief to the ear by a ſtudied variety of phraſe: and alſo debilitated the vigour of its periods, by a cumbrous addition of unmeaning ſyllables. The

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The Shah nameh, the moſt nervous, the moſt accurate, and moſt poetical work ever compoſed by the Perſians, is become hardly intelligible to a modern reader from the great number of original, pure and ſimple verbs with which it abounds. Theſe have long ſince given place to circumlocutory and unwieldy decompounds, formed of Arabic nouns, and the pliant auxiliaries کردن نمودن کردیدن or other ſuch un-emphatic ſubſtitutes. But it is not wonderful that the Perſians, who could formerly obliterate their own proper alphabet, in a ſuperſtitious adoption of the Arabic character, which by no means ſuited the genius of their language, ſhould now ſacrifice the purity and propriety of their phraſes to a habit of idleneſs, or an affectation of novelty.

The ſame circumſtance has equally prevailed in the Hindoſtanic and Bengal dialects. Of the latter the verb করন has ſwallowed up every faculty, and engroſſed every action to which the form of verb is applicable: and had it not happened that the infinitive of a verb is always conſidered and uſed as a noun, we might have attributed to the poverty of the language, or to a defect in its ſyſtem, that dull uniformity of expreſſion, which is now become its principal characteriſtic. We are however enabled to trace the greateſt part of the original Bengal verbs from the roots of the Shanſcrit: and we may find them all in their

ſub-

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ſubſtantive capacity applied to the ſeveral tenſes and inflexions of করন ·

Thus by an unaccountable caprice the Bengaleſe always expreſs the phraſe '*I repreſent*' by নিবেদন করি from the verb নিবেদন *to repreſent*; as

এই নিবেদন আমি করি তোর স্থান

"*I make* this *repreſentation* to you."

And yet that they formerly uſed to conjugate this verb through all its tenſes may be ſeen from the following inſtance.

তোমা বিনে মোর দুঃখ নিবেদিব কায়

"To whom except yourſelf *ſhall I repreſent* my miſery?"

Every reader muſt be diſguſted at the exceſſive uſage of this compound form of verb, and it is on the exceſs only that I mean to criticize.

Every page of this work will afford freſh proofs of what I have advanced; I believe it will be found to proceed from a lazy indulgence to the memory, and from a want of education in the natives.

The number of pure verbs now uſed by them is very inſufficient to the beauty and energy of a language; but that they once poſſeſſed a portion adequate to both purpoſes may eaſily be

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comprehended from the following liſt, which I have ſcrupulouſly confined to thoſe only, whoſe tenſes may be found in authentic books.

I have ſelected ſuch as moſt immediately ſpring from the Shanſcrit Dhaats, which I have alſo inſerted in a correſpondent column; that while I ſupport my preſent argument of the copiouſneſs of the Bengaleſe, I may alſo bring additional teſtimony of my former aſſertion reſpecting its original derivation.

A ſhort liſt of VERBS.

Shanſcrit Root & Infinitive.		*Bengal Infinitive.*	
অর্চ্চ	অর্চ্চন°	অর্চ্চন	to offer up.
অংশ	অংশন°	অংশন	to partake.
অর্থ	অর্থন°	অর্থন	to require.
অঙ্ক	অঙ্কন°	অঙ্কন	to mark.
আন্দোল	আন্দোলন°	আন্দোলন	to ſwing (intrans:)
আরূপ	আরোপন°	আরোপন	to ſow, to plant.
আনী	আনয়ন°	আনন	to bring.
উৎতর	উত্তরন°	উত্তরন	to arrive.
কৃ	করন°	করন	to do.

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ক্রুন্দ	ক্রুন্দন°	কান্দন	to weep.
কম্প	কম্পন°	কাঁপন	to tremble.
খণ্ড	খণ্ডন°	খণ্ডন	to break in pieces.
খেল	খেলন°	খেলন	to play.
খাদ	খাদন°	খাওন	to eat.
খস	খসন°	খসন	to drop off.
গঢ	গঢন°	গড়ন	to make.
গৌ	গান°	গাওন	to ſing.
গদ	গদন°	গাদন	to ram down.
গল	গলন°	গলন	to melt. (intrans:)
গর্ব্ব	গর্ব্বন°	গর্ব্বন	to be proud.
গন	গনন°	গনন	to number.
গুন	গুনন°	গুনন	to underſtand.
গর্জ্জ	গর্জ্জন°	গর্জ্জন	to bellow.
গুঞ্জ	গুঞ্জন°	গুঞ্জন	to hum, to buz.
জ্ঞা	জ্ঞান°	জানন	to know.
ঘুর	ঘোরন°	ঘোরন	to revolve.
চুব	চুম্বন°	চুম্বন	to kiſs.
চর	চরন°	চরন	to graze (intrans:)
চিন্ত	চিন্তন°	চিন্তন	to think.
চল	চলন°	চলন	to go.

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ছাদ	ছাদন°	ছাওন	to cover.
জি	জয়ন°	জিনন	to conquer.
জপ	জপন°	জপন	to recite the bead-roll.
জ্বল	জ্বলন°	জ্বলন	to burn. (intrans:)
জাগ্	জাগরন°	জাগন	to be awake.
জ্ব	জ্বরন°	জ্বরন	to be ſick.
জীব	জীবন°	জীবন	to live.
ঝ্	ঝরন°	ঝরন	to ooze out.
তাড়	তাড়ন°	তাড়ন	to beat.
ত্যজ	ত্যজন°	ত্যজন	to renounce.
ত্	তরন°	তরন	to be ferried.
দহ	দহন°	দহন	to burn.
দংশ	দংশন°	দংশন	to bite.
দুহ	দোহন°	দোহন	to milk.
দুঃখ	দুঃখন°	দুঃখন	to be diſtreſſed.
দুল	দোলন°	দোলন	to ſwing.
দা	দান°	দেওন	to give.
ধৃ	ধরন°	ধরন	to take, to ſeize.
ধুন্	ধুনন°	ধুনন	to bow cotton.
ধ্যৈ	ধ্যান°	ধেয়ান	to meditate.
নিস্তৃ	নিস্তারন°	নিস্তারন	to be bleſſed.

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নিবৃ	নিবারন°	নিবারন	to forbid & to ſeparate.
নী	নয়ন°	নওন	to take, to accept.
নিন্দ	নিন্দন°	নিন্দন	to vilify, to defame.
নিবিদ	নিবেদন°	নিবেদন	to petition.
পট	পটন°	পটন	to turn. (intrans:)
পত	পতন°	পতন	to fall.
পদ	পদন°	পদন	to walk.
পৃ	পারন°	পারন	to be able.
পূজ	পূজন°	পূজন	to worſhip.
পরাঽয়	পলায়ন°	পলান	to flee.
পুষ	পোষন°	পোষন	to cheriſh, bring up.
পূ	পূরন°	পূরন	to fill.
পরামৃষ	পরামর্ষন°	পরামর্ষন	to conſult.
প্রশন্স	প্রশংসন°	প্রশংসন	to praiſe.
পড়	পড়ন°	পড়ন	to fall.
প্রবিশ	প্রবেশন°	প্রবেশন	to enter.
পচ	পচন°	পচন	to rot.
পত	পতন°	পাতন	to ſpread.
প্রসৃ	প্রসারন°	প্রসারন	to embrace.
প্রনম	প্রনমন°	প্রনমন	to ſalute.
ফল	ফলন°	ফলন	to bear fruit.

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বস	বসন°	বসন	to ſit.
বিন্ধ	বিন্ধন°	বিন্ধন	to bore, to pierce.
বন্দ	বন্দন°	বন্দন	to reſpect.
বর্ষ	বর্ষন°	বরিষন	to rain.
বন্ধ	বন্ধন°	বান্ধন	to bind.
বধ	বধন°	বধন	to kill.
বর্ন্ন	বর্ন্ন°	বর্ন্নন	to extol.
বৃ	বারন°	বারন	to prevent.
বঞ্চ	বঞ্চন°	বঞ্চন	to cheat.
বিদ্	বিদারন°	বিদারন	to break (intrans:)
বিভজ	বিভজন°	বিভাজন	to diſtribute in ſhares.
বদ	বদন°	বলন	to ſpeak, to ſay.
বৃধ	বর্দ্ধন°	বাড়ন	to grow.
বিত্	বিতরন°	বিতরন	to beſtow.
বাদ	বাদন°	বাজন	to ſound as an inſtrument.
বকি	বঙ্কন°	বঙ্কন	to bend.
ভী	ভয়ন°	ভয়ন	to fear.
ভৃ	ভরন°	ভরন	to fill.
ভাস	ভাসন°	ভাসন	to float.
ভজ	ভজন°	ভজন	to adore.
ভুজ	ভোজন°	ভোজন	to eat.

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মজ্জ	মজ্জন°	মজ্জন	to be ripe.
মহ্	মহন°	মহন	to worſhip.
মান	মানন°	মানন	to mind.
মুষ	মোষন°	মোষন	to defraud.
ম্	মারন°	মারন	to beat.
মদ	মদন°	মাদন	to be intoxicated.
মৃজ	মার্জন°	মাজন	to ſcour.
মীল	মীলন°	মীলন	to join & to mix.
মৃগ	মার্গন°	মাগন	to require.
মৃ	মরন°	মরন	to die.
যা	যান°	যাওন	to go.
যাচ	যাচন°	যাচন	to want.
যুদ্ধ	যুদ্ধন°	যুদ্ধন	to make war.
রক্ষ	রক্ষন°	রক্ষন	to place.
রুষ	রোষন°	রোষন	to be angry.
রধ	রন্ধন°	রন্ধন	to cook.
রচ	রচন°	রচন	to compoſe.
লিখ	লিখন°	লিখন	to write.
নুম্ফ	নুম্ফন°	নুফন	to catch.
লিপ	লেপন°	লেপন	to plaiſter.
লঘ	লঙ্ঘন°	লঙ্ঘন	to leap over.

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নভ	নভন°	নভন	to take.
নোক	নোকন°	নোকন	to ſee.
নী	নয়ন°	নওন	to take.
নম্ফ	নম্ফন°	নাম্ফন	to jump.
নগ	নগন°	নাগন	to touch.
শী	শয়ন°	শয়ন	to ſleep.
শান	শানন°	শানন	to whet, to grind.
শঙ্ক	শঙ্কন°	শঙ্কন	to fear.
শীল	শীলন°	শীলন	to be juſt.
শিখ	শিখন°	শিখন	to learn.
শুষ	শুষকন°	শুকন	to dry. (intrans:)
সাধ	সাধন°	সাধন	to pacify.
সজ্জ	সজ্জন°	সাজান	to harneſs.
সান্তব	সান্তবন°	সান্তান	to appeaſe.
সাম	সামন°	সামন	to be quiet.
সস্পৃহ	সস্পৃহন°	সস্পৃহন	to wiſh.
সম্	সমরন°	সমরন	to remember.
হন	হনন°	হানন	to cut.
হৃ	হারন°	হারন	to loſe in play.
হাস	হাসন°	হাসন	to laugh.

I have

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I have not inſerted in this liſt many of the moſt common, and popular verbs of the Bengaleſe; which are either more corrupted in paſſing through ignorant hands, and therefore bear leſs analogy to the Shanſcrit: or which perhaps are really vulgar expreſſions adopted ſince the decline of learning.

I have not inſerted the cauſal verbs, which are derived from ſimple terms by the introduction of the letter আ. Their number would only have ſwelled my catalogue, without ſerving to any uſeful or curious purpoſe.

I have inſerted few ſuch verbs as are compounded of a particle prefixed or added to the Shanſcrit root. This claſs is very copious and comprehenſive, as the ſame word will have various and even contrary ſignifications according to the particles with which it is combined.

I have not inſerted ſuch words as in their formation from the Shanſcrit infinitives have altered, dropped, or exchanged their radical conſonants, except ſuch as are expreſſly convertible by the ſtrict rules of the Shanſcrit; as a ſimple conſonant for its correſpondent aſpirate, a দ for a ত or a ব for a প &c. Such alterations as are not conformable to theſe principles muſt be imputed to the difficulty of pronouncing many of the Shanſcrit combinations of letters, or to the indolent habits of the moderns.

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Such for inſtance as দেখন *to ſee*, from দর্শন° বেঁকন *to bend* (intrans:) from বঙ্কন° &c. Theſe verbs alone would fill a copious vocabulary.

I have not inſerted ſuch words as have not been applied in the ſeveral moods and tenſes of verbs, by ſome or other of the antient authors. Shanſcrit muſt formerly have been much more current in Bengal than we now find it, or the more learned Bramins muſt not at that time have thought it infinitely beneath their dignity to compile books in the ভাসা or language of diſcourſe. There are a thouſand terms which have the form of infinitives, and are derived from Shanſcrit roots, but which have not once ſerved in the capacity of verbs. If ever the Bengaleſe ſhould acquire a knowledge of the liberal ſciences, and a taſte for refined compoſitions, this unappropriated ſtock will afford equal reſources to the Poet and the Philoſopher. It is a mine which in ſkillful hands would well repay the trouble of working.

In the Shanſcrit language as in the Greek, there are forms of infinitives and of participles comprehenſive of time; there are alſo other branches of the verb, that ſeem to reſemble the gerunds and ſupines of the Latin. All theſe modifications of the verb, together with nouns of agency, and every other derivative from a Dhaat, (which is not characteriſed by one or other of

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of the temporal inflexions) are arranged by the Shanſcrit grammarians in a ſeparate chapter, immediately following that of verbs.

কৃৎ is the general name for all the terminations by which theſe ſeveral forms are diſtinguiſhed; and the claſs itſelf is for this reaſon denominated কৃদন্ত or words ending with a কৃৎ

The number of theſe terminations, including thoſe which on account of the different letters that occur at the end of the Dhaat, have two or more proviſional forms to the ſame meaning, may amount to about one hundred; and therefore a Shanſcrit verb muſt ſupply a variety of derivatives at leaſt as copious as thoſe of the Greek: and ſome terms I think I have met with, whoſe meaning could not be fully rendered by a ſingle word in any other language.

But as the ſcope of my work does not admit of a diſtinct chapter for the কৃদন্ত claſs, and as an explanation of them is by no means neceſſary for the underſtanding of the Bengal language, it will ſuffice to have here given a general idea of the manner in which this part of the ſcience of grammar has been treated by the Bramins. I ſhall therefore confine myſelf to a ſpecies of কৃদন্ত (if I may be allowed to borrow the expreſſion) which belongs to the Bengal idiom only.

The

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The form which I would deſcribe, is a noun of reciprocation, implying either a mutual co-operation or a mutual oppoſition. This noun is compoſed of the participle of the paſſive voice prefixed to the participle preſent of the active: as of the verb হানন *to wound* হানা is the paſſive participle *wounded*, and হানি the active participle *wounding*. Theſe two united make হানাহানি *a mutual wounding*; as

দুই বীরে হানাহানি সংগ্রাম ভিতরে

"There was *a mutual wounding* by the two heroes in the midſt "of the battle."

Upon the ſame principle are formed the following words and many others.

কাটাকাটি	from কাটন	to cut.
ধরাধরি	from ধরন	to ſeize.
মারামারি	from মারন	to beat.
দেখাদেখি	from দেখন	to behold.
ডাকাডাকি	from ডাকন	to call.
মিষামিষি	from মিষন	to mingle.
জড়াজড়ি	from জড়ন	to wreſtle.

জড়াজড়ি করি দুহে পড়ে ভুমিতলে

"The two warriors *wreſtling with each other* fell to the ground."

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This kind of alliterative ſound is particularly pleaſing to a Bengal ear; for which reaſon a great number of words has been formed in imitation of this ſpecies, which preſerve their reciprocative energy, tho' derived from common nouns. Such are

কানাকানি *with ear to ear*, (that is *a mutual whiſpering*) from কান *an ear.*

মুখামুখি *face to face*, from মুখ *the face.*

গলাগলি *a mutual embracing*, from গলা *the neck.*

চুলাচুলি *a mutual plucking of the hair*, from চুল *the hair.*

দেশাদেশি *a mutual inhabiting of the ſame kingdom.*

বলাবলি *a mutual exertion of ſtrength.*

Some few words of this ſort ſeem to imply completion; as

মাসামাসি *a complete month.* বেলাবেলি *a complete day.*

তরাতরি *complete haſte.*

A third claſs, which may be referred to this ſpecies, conſiſts of words contrived to imitate certain ſounds, by the reiteration of particular letters or ſyllables. Theſe have not the letter আ inſerted in the middle, and do not convey any mutual or reciprocative meaning.

থরথরি a noiſe like that of trees in a ſtorm.

ঝরঝরি a noiſe like the daſhing of waves.

ঝনঝন a noiſe like the falling of a ſhower.

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ঠনঠন a noiſe like the tinkling of bells.
হুড়হুড়ি a noiſe like the rattling of carriages.
দ্বড়দ্বড়ি a loud noiſe as of guns.
মকমকি a croaking like that of frogs.

Example.

ঝরঝরি জলের বাওর থড়থড়ি।
দুই জনে সুইয়া থাকিব গলাধরি॥

"There is the daſhing of the water, and the whiſtling of the "breeze;
"I will enfold you in my arms and we will ſleep together."

And theſe terms are often further diſtinguiſhed by the word শব্দ which in its more enlarged ſenſe ſignifies noiſe in general; as

অবিশ্রান্ত পড়ে চোট করে হানাহানি।
ঝনঝন ঠনঠন শব্দ মাত্র শুনি॥

"Wounds fall without ceaſing, and inflict reciprocal gaſhes,
"I hear only the din and claſhing ſound of the battle."

Sometimes a noun is repeated in the oblique caſe either with a reciprocative idea, or to gratify the taſte for alliteration; as

মনেমনে with a hearty good will, or ſpontaneouſly, from মন the heart.
দন্তেদন্তে with tooth to tooth.

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অন্যেঅন্যে one another.

ঘরেঘরে from houſe to houſe &c.

মনেমনে মহা রাজা করেন বিচার

"The Maahaa Raajaa of his own accord makes inveſtigation."

দুই হস্তী মিষামিষি দন্তেদন্তে কষাকষি
কম্পবান পাণ্ডুর নন্দন

"The two elephants were mingled in the conflict, with tooth "againſt tooth, ſtruggling with each other; and the ſon of "Paandoo trembled."

অন্যেঅন্যে সারথী কাটিন অস্ব রথ

"The charioteers hacked one another's horſes and carriage."

CHAPTER V.

Of Attributes and Relations.

ALL the terms which ſerve to qualify, to diſtinguiſh, or to augment either *ſubſtance* or *action*, are claſſed by the Shanſcrit grammarians under the head of বিশেষন which literally ſignifies *increaſe* or *addition*. According to their arrangement, a ſimple ſentence conſiſts of three members, কর্ত্তা *the agent*,

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agent, ক্রিয়া *the action* and কর্ম্ম *the ſubject*: which in a grammatical ſenſe are reduced to two: শব্দ the *noun*, (whether agent or ſubject) and ক্রিয়া the *verb*. All ſuch words as tend to ſpecificate or to amplify the noun, are denominated শব্দ বিশেষন which we may conſtrue *adjectives* or *epithets*; and ſuch as are applied to denote relation or connection are called শব্দযোগ or connectives of nouns, and by European grammarians are ſtyled *prepoſitions*.

Thoſe particles which in any manner affect the verb, have the name of ক্রিয়াবিশেষন or *attributes of verbs*.

In this chapter therefore I ſhall include all the terms which relate to either of theſe diviſions; and ſhall claſs them under their reſpective heads: শব্দবিশেষন and শব্দযোগ will then rank together as attributes of nouns, and the ক্রিয়া বিশেষন will be made to compriſe conjunctions as well as adverbs: becauſe the former are employed to denote the relations of tenſes, in the ſame manner as prepoſitions are to mark thoſe of nouns; and therefore properly belong to verbs, which are the hinges of every ſentence.

Thus I hope I ſhall be found to comprehend all the parts of ſpeech, as generally diſtinguiſhed, without paying a ſervile attention

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tion to the received ſyſtem of grammatical arrangements.

শব্দবিশেষন or the ſimple adjective of the Bengaleſe, has no variation of gender, caſe or number. In this reſpect it perfectly reſembles the idiom of the Engliſh; for as we uſe the word *great* indiſcriminately to a maſculine or feminine noun; ſo the Bengaleſe ſay মহারাজা a *great* prince, and মহারানী a *great* princeſs: So আইবড় an adjective with a maſculine termination is applied to a feminine. Example.

এক পুত্রী আইবড় বিদ্যা নাম তার

"He has one daughter *unmarried*, her name is Beedyaa."

Neither is the adjective ſubject to inflexion; but the ſign of the caſe is confined to the ſubſtantive with which it agrees; as

মহা নাদে রোদন করয়ে সৈন্য গন

"The troops lamented with *a mighty noiſe*."

So alſo its form is confined to the ſingular number, even when joined to a plural noun; as

সকল পণ্ডিতগন হইল পরাজয়

"*All the Pundits* were overcome."

But thoſe derivative attributes, which are alternately adjectives and concrete nouns, generally preſerve the diſtinctions of gender which they all poſſeſs in the Shanſcrit.

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Here therefore I ſhall endeavour to give a conciſe deſcription of the ſeveral forms of adjectives with their derivation, as far as they uſually occur in the Bengal language.

1. Verbal concretes, or participles of agency immediately formed from Shanſcrit roots, have the termination তা for the maſculine, and ত্রী for the feminine.

Maſculine.		Feminine.	
কর্ত্তা	*an agent.*	কর্ত্রী	from কৃ
দাতা	*a giver.*	দাত্রী	from দা

2. Maſculines ending in আ and আন derived from crude nouns in ন and ৎ have their feminine termination in অতী

Maſculine.		Feminine.	
যুবা	*a young man, (juvenis)*	যুবতী	from যুবন
শ্রীমান	*rich,*	শ্রীমতী	from শ্রীমৎ

কোন অভিনাসে বিরহ বাতাসে জ্বালাইলা যুবতী

"How eagerly didſt thou enflame the *young girl* with the breath "of perfidy!"

3. Concretes are made from abſtract terms by adding ঈ for the maſculine, and ইনী for the feminine; as

Maſculine.		Feminine.	
পাপী	*criminal.*	পাপিনী	from পাপ *a crime.*
দুঃখী	*miſerable.*	দুঃখিনী	from দুঃখ *miſery.*

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জনমদুখিনী মোরে করিলেক বিধি

"God hath made me *miſerable from my birth.*" (ſpoken by a woman)

The ſame form is applied to local poſſeſſives; as বঙ্গীয় *a man of Bengal* বঙ্গীয়িনী *a woman of Bengal* &c.

4. When the maſculine ends with a conſonant, or ই ſhort, the feminine termination is ঈ long; as

Maſculine.		Feminine.
সতি	*conſtant.*	সতী
সুমুখ	*beautiful.*	সুমুখী

Example.

সীতা গো পরম সতী তার শুন দুর্গতি

"O woman! Seetaa was very *conſtant.* Hear her unfortunate "ſtory."

Adjectives and concrete nouns implying cauſe, poſſeſſion, plenty &c. aſſume the terminations কার অঙ্কর বান বৎ and বন্ত· মান মন্ত ধর and ধাম as

ধুম্বুকার *ſmoak-making*, from ধুম্ব *ſmoak.*
ভয়ঙ্কর *cauſing fear*, from ভয় *fear.*

ধুম্বকার ধুম্বু করি কৈল অন্ধকার

"The ſmoak-maker, producing a ſmoak, cauſed a compleat "darkneſs."

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পুন্যবান *holy*,	from	পুন্য *holineſs*.
বলবৎ & বলবন্ত *ſtrong*,	from	বল *ſtrength*.
বুদ্ধিমান *wiſe*,	from	বুদ্ধি *wiſdom*.
ভাগ্যমন্ত *fortunate*,	from	ভাগ্য *proſperity*.

জাহার ঘরে সদাবাস লক্ষ্মী আর অনন্ত।
সেই জন পুন্যবান বড় ভাগ্যমন্ত॥

"In the houſe of whomſoever Lokhmee and Ononto conſtantly [reſide,
"That man is *holy* and moſt *fortunate*."

ভাগ্যধর *proſperous*.	from	ভাগ্য *proſperity*.
গুনধাম *intelligent*,	from	গুন *knowledge*.

রাজা বড় ভাগ্যধর কাছে নদী দামোদর

"The Raajaa is moſt *proſperous*; near him is the river Daamodar."

5. The negative particles অ নি নির and বি prefixed to words form adjectives of privation; as

অচল *motionleſs*,	from	চলন *to go*.
অমৃত *immortal*,	from	মৃত *to die*.
অপূর্ব্ব *unprecedented*,	from	পূর্ব্ব *before*.
অসক্ত *weak*,	from	সক্ত *ſtrong*.

অপূর্ব্ব করিব ব্যূহ অদ্ভুত মানুষে

"I

"I will conſtruct an *unprecedented* caſtle, wonderful among "men."

নিপাত	*leafleſs*,	from	পাত	*a leaf.*
নির্ধন	*poor*, (*inops*)	from	ধন	*wealth.*
নিরস্ত্র	*unarmed*,	from	অস্ত্র	*a weapon.*
নির্ভয়	*fearleſs*,	from	ভয়	*fear.*

দুহে হইন নিরস্ত্র করিয়া মহা রন

"The Heroes were both without weapons, having ſupported a "mighty conflict."

বিসম	*incomparable*,	from	সম	*like.*
বিযোগী	*widowed*,	from	যোগ	*union*

আসাড়ে নবিন মেঘ গভির গর্জন।
বিযোগীর যমসম সংযোগীর প্রান॥

"In the month Aaaſaar the new cloud makes a deep bellowing; "To the widow like the miniſter of death, but life to the wife."

6. An elegant claſs of compound attributes is produced by the junction of a ſubſtantive and an adjective, or of two ſubſtantives; as

মৃগাক্ষ *ſtag-eyed*, from মৃগ *a ſtag*, and অক্ষ *an eye.*
নির্ভয়হৃদয় *of an undaunted breaſt.*
মহামতি or মহামনি *of a great heart.*

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ক্রোধমন *of an angry diſpoſition.*

হরিস অন্তর *of an agreeable humour.*

দুরাচার *wicked,* from দুর *diſtant,* and আচার *an inſtitute of religion.*

ব্রাহ্মনের অমান্য করিস দুরাচার ।
আজি আমি ইহার করিব প্রতিকার ॥

"Doſt thou diſhonour the Bramin, O *wicked wretch*!
"I will to-day make an ample reparation for it."

মৃত্তকল্পা having the appearance of death, from মৃত *death,* and কল্প *figure.*

গুনসাগর *learned,* (litterally, a ſea of learning) from গুন *ſcience,* and সাগর *the ocean.*

অধোমুখ with a down-caſt countenance, from অধো *down,* and মুখ *the face.*

আকার ſignifying *figure* or *appearance* is frequently added to an adjective or ſubſtantive to form a compound epithet of ſimilitude; as

মানুষাকার *like a man.*
সুক্লাকার *of a white appearance.*
রক্তাকার *like blood,* &c.

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7. The terminations তর and তম form the comparative and ſuperlative degrees of Shanſcrit adjectives; as মন্দ *bad*, মন্দতর *worſe*. মন্দতম *worſt*. দূর *diſtant*, দূরতর *more diſtant*, দূরতম *moſt diſtant*.

But the latter of theſe inflexions is never uſed by the Bengaleſe; and the former very ſparingly; and always in a ſenſe that might perhaps rather be termed an indefinite augmentation, than a compariſon; Thus

আনন্দিত বৃকোদর যুদ্ধ করে ঘোরতর

"Brokodor elated fights *more fiercely*."

The definitive compariſon is expreſſed by a ſimple adjective, both in the Bengaleſe and Hindoſtanic idioms: And the inferior ſubject is diſtinguiſhed by a particle anſwering to *than*; as

সুগ্রীব হইতে বালী রাজা অতি মহা বীর।
রঘুনাথের বাণে তেহ হইল অস্থির॥

"Baalee Raajaa was a much greater hero *than* Soogreeb,
"Yet even he was put to flight by the weapons of Roghoonaath."

Attributes of augmentation may be prefixed to all ſimple adjectives, to enlarge or extend their power; ſuch are বড় *great* পরম *very*, বহুত *much* or *many*, অতি *much*, &c. as বড় সুন্দর *very fair*, অতি অনুপাম *extremely beautiful*, পরমসতী *remarkably conſtant*.

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Example.

বড় সুন্দর সেই অতি অনুপাম ।
সুনিনাম বিদ্যার পতি অতি গুনধাম ॥

"This perſon *very* fair and *extremely* beautiful,
"I have heard to be the *moſt* accompliſhed huſband of Beedyaa."

অতি is prefixed to the comparative degree to form a ſuperlative; as

রথ চানাইয়া দেহ অতি সিঘ্রতর

"Cauſe the chariot to come hither *moſt* expeditiouſly."

Adjectives are frequently doubled to augment their meaning as বড় বড় *very large*, ছোট ছোট *very ſmall*.

Example.

ছোট বড়সিতে মারে বড় বড় যিন ।
প্রানে না মারে তবু মুখে রাখে চিন ॥

"With a ſmall hook he ſtrikes a *very large* fiſh;
"It does not affect his life, yet imprints a mark in his mouth."

The particle সম prefixed to a word, makes a kind of ſuperlative; as পূর্ন *full*, সমপূর্ন *very full*.

The ſame particle ſubjoined, is a contraction of সমান and like it denotes ſimilitude or reſemblance; as

তোমাসম যোদ্ধাপতি নাহিক আমার

"We

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"We have no warrior *like* yourſelf."

মেঘের বিক্রমসম মাঘের হিমানি

"The cold of the month Maagh is *like* the ſtrength of the "cloud."

মহাভারতের কথা অমৃত সমান।
কাসীরাম দাস কহে শুন পুন্যবান॥

"The words of the Mohaabhaarot, *equal to immortality*
"Kaaſeeraam Daas utters; hear them O ye righteous!"

So alſo are uſed তুল and তুল্য from the Shanſcrit infinitive তুলন° *to weigh*; as

বেদ তুল্য জানি আমি তোমার বচন

"I conſider your counſel as *equally weighty* with the Bades."

Under the claſs of *Attributes to nouns*, I comprehend শব্দ যোগ or *Prepoſitions*. They are ſubſtitutes for caſes, which could not have been extended to the number neceſſary for expreſſing all the ſeveral relations and predicaments in which a noun may ſtand, without cauſing too much embarraſſment in the form of a declenſion.

Moſt of the particles applied in this capacity are nouns expreſſive of ſituation, order, connexion, or ſome other relation; and as they have generally a reference to *place*, are indifferently

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uſed in the nominative, and in the ſeventh caſe with the locative termination এ as ওপর or ওপরে *above*, ভিতর or ভিতরে *within*, &c.

But to diſtinguiſh the শব্দযোগ or words having only a relative ſignification, from the principal ſubſtantives to which they relate, it is neceſſary to obſerve that the noun *in regimine* with a prepoſition ſhould properly be in the poſſeſſive caſe, and prior in poſition; as they ſay পৃথিবীর মধ্যে *in the midſt of the world*, but never মধ্যে পৃথিবীর becauſe the world is the *containing ſubject*; and মধ্যে ſerves only to mark the nature of the connexion, which ſubſiſts between the world and ſome other ſubject; as

পৃথিবীর মধ্যে কেবা নাজানে তোমারে

"Who *in the world* (i.e. of thoſe perſons contained in the world) "is unacquainted with you?"

The moſt common of the শব্দযোগ are theſe which follow. ভিতর *within*, মধ্যে মাঝে *in the midſt of*; (anſwer to the ſeventh, or locative caſe) সহ সহিত সঙ্গে *with, together with*, হইতে *by*; (the third Shanſcrit caſe) as

কৃষ্ণ হইতে গড়া হইয়াছিল এই ঘর

"This houſe was erected *by* Kreeſhno."

হইতে *from*; (the fifth caſe) as

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হেন কালে সাত্যেকি উঠিল ভূমি হইতে

"At that inſtant Saatyokee aroſe *from* the ground."

বিনা বিনে or বিনু *without.* (*fine*)

বাহির *without*, on the outſide. (*extra*) Example.

মেঘের বিক্রম সম মাঘের হিমানি।
ঘরের বাহির নহে যেই যুবা বনি॥

"The cold of the month Maagh is like the ſtrength of the cloud;
"Then I ſay the youth ſhould not be *without* the houſe."

আগে *before*, either in time or place.

কারন বিষয় হেতু *on account of.*

দিগে *towards.* তরে *inſtead of.* তলে নাম or নাব *below, beneath, down.* উপর *above, upon.* নিকট স্থান *near; to, at.* (*apud*)

স্থান is a very difficult word. It properly ſignifies *place*, (ſtatio) and is derived from the dhaat স্থা which anſwers to *ſto*; as in Virgil.

"Dum *ſtabat* regno incolumis ——" i.e. While he *remained* ſecure in his kingdom.

But স্থান muſt generally be conſtrued *to* or *from* in Engliſh; as

এক নিবেদন আমি করি তোর স্থান

"I make one requeſt *to you.*" [apud te]

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স্থির স্থানে সোমদত্ত পাইয়া এই বর

"Somdott having obtained this favour *from* God," [apud Deum]

স্থির is derived from the ſame root, and ſignifies *ſtabilis, immotus*, ſo that স্থির স্থান means *apud immobile numen.*

The word স্থান ſeems in very early times to have been adopted by the Perſians, who formed of it an inſeparable particle of *place*; as گلستان *a bed of roſes*, هندوستان *India*, literally, a country of ſwarthy people.

The doctrine of derivatives from one language to another has been ſo much abuſed by fanciful and unwarrantable inſtances, drawn from the meer reſemblance of ſounds, that every hint now ſtarted on the ſubject is deſpiſed as frivolous, or ſuſpected as fallacious. If I might venture to propoſe a rule in ſuch caſes, it ſhould be this;

Whenever in a compound word we find one or more of the component ſyllables, which are entire words, having a preciſe and ſeparate meaning in ſome other language, tho' not in that where the compound term is uſed, we need not ſcruple to pronounce the original dialect to be that from whence the ſignificant ſyllables proceed; as in the preſent inſtance, where ستان taken by itſelf as a Perſian word, conveys no idea whatever,

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ever, but when joined to other words, denotes place or situation. স্থান in Shanſcrit actually ſignifies *a place* or *ſtation*, and is itſelf derived from a primary root of the ſame language.

But if a ſimple term be found to exiſt in two languages, and to have the ſame ſignification in each, I would then enquire whether that word be not derived, in one of them, from ſome general term or root; and wherever ſuch root were found, I would pronounce that language to be the original: thus *ſerpens* a ſerpent comes from *ſerpo*, but I do not doubt that the latter owes its derivation to সর্প the Shanſcrit word for a ſerpent, which ſprings from the dhaat সৃপ্ a general term for *gliding motion*.

Let me here curſorily obſerve, that as the Latin is an earlier dialect than the Greek, as we now have it, ſo it bears much more reſemblance to the Shanſcrit, both in words, inflexions and terminations.

ক্রিয়া বিশেষন *Adverbs* require no deſcription or remark.

Adverbs of time.

এখন now. তখন or ততক্ষন then.
কদাচ ever. কদাচন never.
কখন at any time. যখন whenſoever.
এখনতক or এই পর্য্যন্ত yet.

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পুনরপি once more. ইহার পর afterwards.
সদা সর্ব্বদা always. ফের again.
আজি to day. কল্য to morrow, or yeſterday.
পরসু the day after to morrow, or the day before yeſterday.
তরসু two days hence.
দিনে by day. রাত্রে রজনীতে by night.
প্রভাতে in the morning. বৈকালে in the afternoon.
পূর্ব আগে before. পশ্চাৎ পাছে after, ſince.

Adverbs of place.

এখানে here. ওখানে there.
হের hither. হোর thither.
কোথা কোথায় whither. স্থানেস্থানে in different places
নিকট nigh. দূর far off.
ফের back, (rurſus) from ফেরন to turn.
ইতি *thus far*, the formulary at the concluſion of a book, or writing.

Adverbs of ſpecification &c.

কেন why? কি কেমন what? how?
অতি very. প্রায় almoſt.
কিছু ſcarcely. এবং particularly.
বিস্তারিত videlicet. নিশ্চয় অবশ্য certainly. না not.

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All indeclinable adjectives may be uſed adverbially in Bengaleſe, as the neuter gender of adjectives in Greek and Latin.

Conjunctions.

ও and.
আর alſo, moreover.
যদি if, although, when.
কিন্তু but, yet, nevertheleſs.
কি কিবা কিম্বা or.
অতএব therefore.
তভু তমু notwithſtanding.
যাবত while. তাবত ſo long.

যাবত কণ্ঠেতে আমার রহে প্রান।
তাবত পূজিব আমি দেব ভগবান॥

"*While* life remains in my body,
"*So long* will I worſhip the Deity Bhogowaan."

CHAPTER. VI.

Of Numbers.

THE learned ſeem no longer to doubt, that the uſe of numerical figures was firſt derived from India: and indeed the antiquity of their application in that country far exceeds the powers of inveſtigation.

The denominations of the cardinal numbers are ſo irregular in

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in Bengaleſe, that I find it will be neceſſary to exhibit them as far as one hundred. And it muſt be obſerved as a particularity, that the ninth numeral of every ſeries of ten, is not ſpecified by the term of nine in the common order of progreſſion, but takes its appellation from the ſeries immediately above; as for inſtance the number *twenty nine* is not expreſſed by *nobeeſh*, which ſhould ſeem the proper denomination, but is called *oonteeſh*, or one leſs than thirty. So *thirty nine* is *oonchaaleeſh* or one leſs than forty.

All the numerals in Shanſcrit have different forms for the different genders, as in Arabic; but are invariable in Bengaleſe.

	Bengaleſe.	Shanſcrit.	
১	এক	একঃ	one.
২	দুই	দ্বৌ	two.
৩	তিন	ত্রয়ঃ	three.
৪	চারি	চত্বারঃ	four.
৫	পাঁচ	পঞ্চ	five.
৬	ছয়	ষট	ſix.
৭	সাত	সপ্ত	ſeven.
৮	আট	অষ্ট	eight.
৯	নয়	নবাঃ	nine.

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১০	দশ	দশ	ten.
১১	এগার	একাদশ	eleven.
১২	বার	দ্বাদশ	twelve.
১৩	তের	ত্রয়োদশ	thirteen.
১৪	চৌদ্দ	চতুর্দশ	fourteen.
১৫	পোনের	পঞ্চদশ	fifteen.
১৬	ষোল	ষোড়শ	fixteen.
১৭	সতের	সপ্তদশ	feventeen.
১৮	আঠার	অষ্টাদশ	eighteen.
১৯	ঊনিশ	ঊনবিংশতিঃ	nineteen.
২০	বিশ	বিংশতি	twenty.
২১	একশ	একবিংশতিঃ	twenty one.
২২	বাইশ	দ্বিবিংশতিঃ	twenty two.
২৩	তেইশ	ত্রয়োবিংশতিঃ	twenty three.
২৪	চব্বিশ	চতুর্ব্বিংশতিঃ	twenty four.
২৫	পঁচিশ	পঞ্চবিংশতিঃ	twenty five.
২৬	ছাব্বিশ	ষড়্বিংশতিঃ	twenty fix.
২৭	সাতাইশ	সপ্তবিংশতিঃ	twenty feven.
২৮	আটাইশ	অষ্টাবিংশতিঃ	twenty eight.
২৯	ঊনত্রিশ	ঊনত্রিংশৎ	twenty nine.
৩০	ত্রিশ	ত্রিংশৎ	thirty.

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৩১	একত্রিশ	একত্রিংশৎ	thirty one.
৩২	বত্তিশ	দ্বাত্রিংশৎ	thirty two.
৩৩	তেত্তিশ	ত্রয়স্ত্রিংশৎ	thirty three.
৩৪	চৌত্তিশ	চত্তস্ত্রিংশৎ	thirty four.
৩৫	পঁইত্তিশ	পঞ্চত্রিংশৎ	thirty five.
৩৬	ছত্তিশ	ষটত্রিংশৎ	thirty fix.
৩৭	সাঁইত্তিশ	সপ্তত্রিংশৎ	thirty ſeven.
৩৮	আটত্তিশ	অষ্টত্রিংশৎ	thirty eight.
৩৯	ঊনচল্লিশ	নবত্রিংশৎ	thirty nine.
৪০	চল্লিশ	চত্বারিংশৎ	forty.
৪১	একচল্লিশ	একচত্বারিংশৎ	forty one.
৪২	ব্যাল্লিশ	দ্বিচত্বারিংশৎ	forty two.
৪৩	তেতাল্লিশ	ত্রিচত্বারিংশৎ	forty three.
৪৪	চৌয়াল্লিশ	চত্তশ্চত্বারিংশৎ	forty four.
৪৫	পঁয়তাল্লিশ	পঞ্চচত্বারিংশৎ	forty five.
৪৬	ছেচল্লিশ	ষটচত্বারিংশৎ	forty fix.
৪৭	সাতচল্লিশ	সপ্তচত্বারিংশৎ	forty ſeven.
৪৮	আটচল্লিশ	অষ্টচত্বারিংশৎ	forty eight.
৪৯	ঊনপঞ্চাশ	একোনপঞ্চাশৎ	forty nine.
৫০	পঞ্চাশ	পঞ্চাশৎ	fifty.
৫১	একান্ন	একপঞ্চাশৎ	fifty one.
৫২	বায়ান্ন	দ্বিপঞ্চাশৎ	fifty two.

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৫৩	তিপ্পান্ন	ত্রিপঞ্চাশৎ	fifty three.
৫৪	চৌয়ান্ন	চতুঃপঞ্চাশৎ	fifty four.
৫৫	পঞ্চান্ন	পঞ্চপঞ্চাশৎ	fifty five.
৫৬	ছাপ্পান্ন	ষটপঞ্চাশৎ	fifty fix.
৫৭	সাতান্ন	সপ্তপঞ্চাশৎ	fifty feven.
৫৮	আটান্ন	অষ্টপঞ্চাশৎ	fifty eight.
৫৯	ঊনষাটি	একোনষষ্টিঃ	fifty nine.
৬০	ষাটি	ষষ্টি	fixty.
৬১	একষষ্টি	একষষ্টিঃ	fixty one.
৬২	বাষষ্টি	দ্বিষষ্টিঃ	fixty two.
৬৩	তেষষ্টি	ত্রিষষ্টিঃ	fixty three.
৬৪	চৌষষ্টি	চতুঃষষ্টিঃ	fixty four.
৬৫	পঁয়ষষ্টি	পঞ্চষষ্টিঃ	fixty five.
৬৬	ছষষ্টি	ষটষষ্টিঃ	fixty fix.
৬৭	সাতষষ্টি	সপ্তষষ্টিঃ	fixty feven.
৬৮	আটষষ্টি	অষ্টষষ্টিঃ	fixty eight.
৬৯	ঊনষত্তোর	একোনসপ্ততিঃ	fixty nine.
৭০	সত্তোর	সপ্ততিঃ	feventy.
৭১	একাত্তোর	একসপ্ততিঃ	feventy one.
৭২	বাহাত্তোর	দ্বিসপ্ততিঃ	feventy two.
৭৩	তেহাত্তোর	ত্রিসপ্ততিঃ	feventy three.
৭৪	চৌহাত্তোর	চতুঃসপ্ততিঃ	feventy four.

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৭৫	পঁচাত্তোর	পঞ্চসপ্ততিঃ	ſeventy five.
৭৬	ছেয়াত্তোর	ষটষপ্ততিঃ	ſeventy ſix.
৭৭	সাতাত্তোর	সপ্তসপ্ততিঃ	ſeventy ſeven.
৭৮	আটাত্তোর	অষ্টসপ্ততিঃ	ſeventy eight.
৭৯	ঊনআশি	নবসপ্ততিঃ	ſeventy nine.
৮০	আশি	অশীতিঃ	eighty.
৮১	একাশি	একাশীতিঃ	eighty one.
৮২	বিরাশি	দ্ব্যশীতিঃ	eighty two.
৮৩	তিরাশি	ত্র্যশীতিঃ	eighty three.
৮৪	চৌরাশি	চতুরশীতিঃ	eighty four.
৮৫	পঁচাশি	পঞ্চাশীতিঃ	eighty five.
৮৬	ছেয়াশি	ষড়শীতিঃ	eighty ſix.
৮৭	সাতাশি	সপ্তাশীতিঃ	eighty ſeven.
৮৮	আটাশি	অষ্টাশীতিঃ	eighty eight.
৮৯	ঊননয়ি	একোননবতিঃ	eighty nine.
৯০	নয়ি	নবতিঃ	ninety.
৯১	একানয়ি	একনবতিঃ	ninety one.
৯২	বিরানয়ি	দ্বিনবতিঃ	ninety two.
৯৩	তিরানয়ি	ত্রিনবতিঃ	ninety three.
৯৪	চৌরানয়ি	চতুর্নবতিঃ	ninety four.
৯৫	পঁচানয়ি	পঞ্চনবতিঃ	ninety five.
৯৬	ছেয়ানয়ি	ষন্নবতিঃ	ninety ſix.

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৯৭	সাতানয়ি	সপ্তনবতিঃ	ninety ſeven.
৯৮	আটানয়ি	অষ্টনবতিঃ	ninety eight.
৯৯	নিরানয়ি	নবনবতিঃ	ninety nine.
১০০	শতঃ	শ	one hundred.

Ordinal Numbers.

Bengaleſe.	Shanſcrit.	
একক্তি · পয়লা	পুথম	firſt.
দোয়জা · দোষরা	দ্বিতীয়	ſecond.
তেয়জা · তেষরা	ত্রিতীয়	third.
চৌটা	চতুর্থ	fourth.
পাঁচক্তি	পঞ্চম	fifth.
ছয়ক্তি	ষষ্ঠ	ſixth.
সাতক্তি	সপ্তম	ſeventh.
আটক্তি	অষ্টম	eighth.
নয়ক্তি	নবম	ninth.
দশক্তি	দশম	tenth.
এগারক্তি	একাদশ	eleventh.
বারক্তি	দ্বাদশ	twelfth.
তেরক্তি	ত্রয়োদশ	thirteenth.
চৌদ্দক্তি	চতুর্দশ	fourteenth.
পোনেরক্তি	পঞ্চদশ	fifteenth.

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ষোলক্রি	ষোড়শ	ſixteenth.
সতেরক্রি	সপ্তদশ	ſeventeenth.
আঠারক্রি	অষ্টাদশ	eighteenth.
ঊনিশা	ঊনবিংশতি	nineteenth.
বিশা · বিশক্রি	বিংশ	twentieth.

From hence the Ordinals are all formed by adding আ to the cardinals.

Of the Bengal Arithmetic.

As the numerical figures of India are certainly the prototype of thoſe now uſed in Europe, it is probable that the ſimpler rules at leaſt of Arithmetic are derived from the ſame ſource: for other nations of the Eaſt have invented different proceſſes for arriving at the ſame concluſions. Thus the Chineſe perform all their computations by means of a ſett of Beads; and the Perſians uſe a ſpecies of figures which are in fact Arabic words; and add up the moſt conſiderable ſums, without being in the leaſt aſſiſted by the poſition of units under units, tens under tens &c. Perhaps there may yet exiſt other modes of arithmetic of which we have no notion; ſo that the ſtrict conformity in the arrangement and application of figures, as well as in

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in their forms, which we find between Hindoſtan and Europe, ſhould not raſhly be imputed to chance.

The Bengaleſe in all their accompts make particular uſe of the number *four*. Their Bankers always count the largeſt ſums of money by diviſions of *fours*, and the computations of numbers of all other things are always made in the ſame manner: and upon all occaſions *four* is their grand multiple and diviſor. This is probably a veſtige of the moſt original and antient airthmetic, when invention had proceeded no farther than to number the fingers, and then repeat the ſame proceſs.

Even to this day the Bengaleſe reckon by the joints of their fingers, beginning with the lower joint of the little finger and proceeding to the thumb, the ball of which is alſo included as a joint; and thus the whole hand contains *fifteen*.

From this method of performing numeration on the joints, ariſes that well-known cuſtom among the Indian merchants, of ſettling all matters of purchaſe and ſale by joining their hands beneath a cloth, and then touching the different joints as they would increaſe or diminiſh their demands.

As a proof how far ſome branches of Science have been cultivated in India, I ſhall here give a ſpecimen of the prodigious extent of the Shanſcrit numeration by diſtinct terms.

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এক°	১	One.
দশ°	০	Ten.
শত°	০	a Hundred.
সহস্র°	০	a Thousand.
অযুত°	০	X. Thousands.
লক্ষ°	০	C. Thousands.
নিযুত°	০	a Million.
কোটিঃ	০	X. Millions.
অর্বুদ	০	C. Millions.
মহা অর্বুদ	০	a Thousand Millions.
পদ্ম	০	X. Thousand Millions.
মহা পদ্ম	০	C. Thousand Millions.
খর্ব্ব	০	a Billion.
মহা খর্ব্ব	০	X. Billions.
শঙ্খ	০	C. Billions.
মহাশঙ্খ	০	a Thousand Billions.
হাহা	০	X. Thousand Billions.
মহা হাহা	০	C. Thousand Billions.
ধুন	০	a Trillion.
মহা ধুন	০	X. Trillions.
অক্ষৌহিনী	০	C. Trillions.
মহা অক্ষৌহিনী	০	a Thousand Trillions.

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The conſtituent parts of accounts, and ſome arithmetical Tables.

চৌটি	a quarter of any thing indiſcriminately.
সিকি	a quarter of money.
পোয়া	a quarter of weights and meaſures.
আধা	a half of any thing.
আধিনি	a half of money.
অর্দ্ধেক	a half of meaſures.
তিনপোয়া	three quarters of any thing.
সওয়া	one and a quarter.
ডেড়	one and a half.
পৌনে দুই	one and three quarters.
সওয়াদুই	two and a quarter.
আড়াই	two and a half.
পৌনেতিন	two and three quarters.
সওয়াতিন	three and a quarter.
সাড়েতিন	three and a half.
পৌনেচারি	three and three quarters.

The fractions are denominated in the ſame manner, joined to all larger ſums or quantities.

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The reader is not to be told that the ſhells called *Cowries* are current in Bengal, as the loweſt ſpecies of money: They are upon on average in the proportion of five thouſand to the rupee.

Bengal accounts are divided into পাকা and কাঁচা which litterally ſignify *ripe*, and *unripe*. An unripe, or kaachaa account is when the higheſt denomination in the line of addition is the কাহন kaahon, or ſome what more than a quarter of a rupee: viz. ſuch accounts as are uſed by the petty retailers in the Bazar, wherein no ſingle article amounts to one rupee.

The paakaa, or ripe account is when the rupee is the higheſt denomination, or ſtandard unit in the line of addition; and each of the ſubordinate fractional figures is increaſed in value proportionably to the increaſe of the ſtandard unit from the kaahon to the rupee; which proportion is regulated by the price of cowries in the Bazar. But in the paakaa and in the kaachaa accounts, the ſame figures, both for the units and fractions, hold the ſame arithmetical places. To ſhew therefore that an account is kaachaa, the word কড়ি is written at top, as we write *L. S. D.* to denote the paakaa account the word রুপেয়া or উক্কা is ſuperſcribed in the ſame manner.

Groſs commodities of all kinds are ſold by the সের ſar, a weight nearly anſwering to two pounds avoirdupoiſe, and of which 40 make মন a maund. The

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The Sar is divided into পোয়া or quarters, and thoſe again are ſubdivided into ছটাক of which four make a পোয়া

Precious metals and jewels are weighed by the তোলা the মাসা and the রতি. তোলা *tolaa* is derived from the word তুলন *to weigh*, and therefore ſignifies a ſtandard, or preciſe weight by which all others may be regulated. It is alſo the mean weight between precious and groſs articles, as it is the higheſt denomination of the former, and the loweſt of the latter. The ſicca rupee, properly called টাকা taakaa in Bengaleſe, originally weighed a তোলা and ſtill continues at that ſtandard in Chittagong, where it is on that account called the দশ মাসা doſh maaſaa rupee, or a rupee weighing ten maaſaas. In other parts of Bengal the ſtandard weight of a Sicca rupee is conſiderably increaſed.

The তোলা (which is generally denominated the *Sicca weight*) is the ſtandard unit for the Sar, which varies in almoſt every province of India. Thus at Calcutta the Bazar mon is of 80 tolaas i.e. each Sar is to weigh 80 tolaas. The factory mon conſiſts only of 74 ſicca weight or tolaas

The fractional parts of the rupee are আনা the aanaa, পাই the paaee or pye, গণ্ডা the gondaa, and কড়ি *cowry*.

The fractions of the কাহন the kaahon, in kaachaa accounts, are

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are পন the pon, গণ্ডা the gondaa, and কড়ি the koree.

5 gondaas of a kaachaa account are in the Bazar called one বুড়ি booree, 5 gondaas of a paakaa account conſtitute one পাই paaee. Obſerve that the word booree is never uſed in accounts, but only in the markets.

20 gondaas make one পোন kaachaa, or one আনা paakaa. The gondaas as far as 19 are marked by the common numerals; after which the fractional mark ⁄. is applied for the pons or aanaas. For 2 and 3 pons the numerals 2 and 3 are joined to this fractional figure thus ২⁄. ৩⁄ and for 4 pons, the loweſt fractional, or that which ſingly denotes the koree, is put before a dot thus ।. For 8 pons, or aanaas, this fraction is doubled, thus ।।. and for 12 pons 2 fractional figures connected at the top and bottom by a third placed obliquely, thus ।৷. as may be better obſerved in the following table.

।	1 koree.
।।	2 korees.
।৷	3 korees. 4 korees make
১	1 gondaa.
৫	5 gondaas one booree kaachaa, (or one paaee paakaa.)
১০	10 gondaas kaachaa. (called আধানা aadhaanaa paakaa, half an aanaa.)

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১৫ 15 gondaas kaachaa. (or 3 paaee paakaa) 20 gondaas make

৵ 1 pon kaachaa, (or one aanaa paakaa.)

৴৹ 2 pons.

৶ 3 pons. 4 pons kaachaa make one চৌক chok. (4 pons paakaa make one সিকি *ſeekee*.)

।৹ 1 chok or *ſeekee*, generally denominated 4 pons.

।৵৹ 5 pons kaachaa. (or 5 aanaas paakaa)

।৴৹ 6 pons.

।৶ 7 pons.

।।৹ 8 pons, or 2 chok (or *ſeekees*.)

।।৵৹ 9 pons.

।।৴৹ 10 pons.

।।৶ 11 pons.

।৷৹ 12 pons, or 3 choks (or *ſeekees*.)

।৷৵৹ 13 pons.

।৷৴৹ 14 pons.

।৷৶ 15 pons. 16 pons kaachaa make 4 *ſeekees* or 1 kaahon. 16 aanaas paakaa make

১ টাকা 1 taakaa or rupee.

Tables.

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Tables of Weights and Meaſures.

রতি Rotee.

।১	।২	।৩	।৪	।৫	।৬	।৭
1.	2.	3.	4.	5.	6.	7.

8 Rotees make one মাসা maaſaa, which is marked by tranſpoſing the fractional ſtroke thus,

মাসা Maſaa.

১।	২।	৩।	৪।	৫।	৬।	৭।	৮।	৯।
1.	2.	3.	4.	5.	6.	7.	8.	9.

10 Maaſaas make one তোলা tolaa, which is marked by the common numerals thus,

তোলা Tolaa.

১	২	৩	৪
1.	2.	3.	4.

Here begins the table for common weights and meaſures.

As the Tolaa is properly the conſtituent unit of the Sar, and as whatever be the weight of the Sar, that of the Tolaa is always invariable, for the ſake of regularity we will take the Sar of 80 tolaa, of which 5 will make one chotaak.

ছটাক	৵	৶	৩/	
Chotaak.	1.	2.	3.	4 Chotaak make one
পোয়া	।৹	।।৹	।।।৹	
Poaa.	1.	2.	3.	4 Poaa make one Sar, thus

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marked, সের

১ ২ ৩ &c. 40 Sar make ১ মন one Mon.

A Table of Long-meaſure.

3 জব barley corns make one আঙ্গুলি or fingers breadth.
4 আঙ্গুলি make one মুষ্ট or hand.
4 মুষ্ট make one হাত or cubit.
4 হাত make one ধনুক bow's length or fathom
2000 ধনুক make one ক্রোস kros, or near two miles and a quarter.

I ſhall now give a few inſtances of kaachaa and paakaa accounts, which will clearly explain both their arithmetical poſition, and their mode of numeration.

Account kaachaa.

	কড়ি
1.	১।৮৭।
2.	২।৮।।
3.	৩।১০

The numeration of the above ſums is as follows:

for the firſt line,

এক কাহন ছয় পন সওয়া সাত গণ্ডা 1 kaahon, [6 pons, 7 gondaas and a quarter.

for the ſecond line,

দুইকাহন নয় পন দুই কড়া 2 kaahons, 9 pons, 2 koraas.

for

for the third line,

তিন কাহন সাড়ে চারি পন 3 kaahons, four pons and a half, or 10 gondaas.

Account paakaa তঙ্কা

1. . . . . ২।২/১০
2. . . . . ৫ ৸/১০
3. . . . . ৬৸ ৫
4. . . . . ৯ ২/১৫
5. . . . . ১৸ ·।

for the firſt line,

দুই টাকা সাড়ে সাত আনা 2 rupees, 7 aanaas, 10 gondaas.

for the ſecond line,

পাঁচ টাকা আড়াই আনা 5 rupees, 2 aanaas 10 gondaas.

for the third line,

ছয় টাকা সওয়া তের আনা 6 rupees, 13 aanaas, 15 gondaas.

for the fourth line,

নয় টাকা পৌনে চারি আনা 9 rupees, 4 aanaas, 15 gondaas.

for the fifth line,

এক টাকা পাঁচ আনা এক কড়া 1 rupee, 5 aanaas, 1 koree.

It muſt be remembered that the Bengaleſe reckon one paaee as

as containing 5 gondaas and 4 paaees to the aanaa. But the Engliſh who generally uſe the paaee as the loweſt denomination in their accounts, divide the Bengal paaee into three, and reckon 12 paaees to the aanaa, conſequently the Engliſh paaee contains 1 gondaa and two thirds, or ſomewhat more than 6 cowries.

CHAPTER. VII.

OF THE SYNTAX.

TO thoſe who are acquainted with the general rules of grammatical arrangement, the conſtruction of the Bengal idiom will preſent but few difficulties. While the conſtituent parts of all languages are the ſame, the modes of combination cannot be widely different: ſo that to compoſe a new ſyntax, ſome anomalous tongue ſhould be ſought, in which the mutual relation of the noun, the verb and the particle is neither expreſſed by inflexion, nor poſition.

But as ignorance, idleneſs and affectation are continually producing a variety of corruptions in every living language, and

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more particularly in Bengal, where there are no native grammarians to check the progreſs of vitious expreſſions, or the prevalence of provincial and foreign dialects, it may be thought in ſome degree uſeful to have inveſtigated and aſcertained the idiom by ſome preciſe and authoritative ſtandard.

A comparative view of the more antient authors, with an occaſional recourſe to the pure Shanſcrit, has furniſhed a clue for this undertaking; and I am clearly convinced that a due attention to the examples inſerted in the foregoing pages, will abundantly prove that the Bengal language poſſeſſes a fund of words adequate to almoſt every branch of compoſition; that it has undergone many material and ſucceſſive improvements; and and that its ſtyle is capable of regularity, of conciſeneſs, and of preciſion.

Little indeed can be urged in favour of the bulk of the modern Bengaleſe. Their forms of letters, their modes of ſpelling, and their choice of words are all equally erroneous and abſurd. They can neither decline a word, nor conſtruct a ſentence: and their writings are filled with Perſian, Arabic and Hindoſtanic terms, promiſcuouſly thrown together without order or meaning: often unintelligible, and always embarraſſing and obſcure.

They generally omit the diacritical terminations, or add them where

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where not wanted; drop the perſonal ſigns of verbs, or ſubſtitute one perſon for another; lengthen vowels that ſhould be ſhort, and curtail thoſe that are properly long. They ſeldom ſeparate the ſeveral words of a ſentence from each other, or conclude the period with a ſtop. Yet the language with all theſe corruptions and impediments circulates thro' an extenſive kingdom, and ſuffices for the mutual intercourſe of ſeveral millions of people. But the want of a better ſyſtem enforces its practice, and habit gradually reconciles us to its defects.

The Shanſcrit language, among other advantages, has a great variety in the mode of arrangement: and the words are ſo knit and compacted together, that every ſentence appears like one compleat word. When two or more words come together *in regimine*, the laſt of them only has the termination of a caſe; the others are known by their poſition; and the whole ſentence ſo connected forms but one compound word, which is called a পদ or *foot*.

So in the better Bengaleſe compoſitions the diacritical terminations are very frequently omitted, and particularly that of the genitive; as

কিবা সুনলিত কেশের ভাতি।
মনিন হইন ননিন পাত॥

"How

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" How beautiful was the jet of her treſſes !

" *The huſband of the lotus* (the beetle) pined away (with envy.)

And when two or more ſubſtantives are put in oppoſition, the diacritical termination of caſe is applied only to the laſt ; as

যুধিষ্ঠির নৃপতিরে ধরিব নিশ্চয়

" I will undoubtedly ſeize the *commander* Joodheeſhteer. "

When two ſubſtantives come together, the genitive is always prior in poſition, unleſs by poetic licence ; as in the following line.

ঝরঝরি জলের বায়ুর খরখরি

" There is *the daſhing of the water*, and the ruſtling of the breeze.

By the ſame liberty the genitive is ſometimes placed at a diſtance from the noun on which it depends ; as

নক্ষ নক্ষ বীরের কাটিয়া পাড়ে মাতা ।
কাহার কাটয়ে ধনু কার মাথে ছাতা ॥

" Having cut off the heads of thouſands *of heroes*, he throws [them down ;

" Of ſome he cuts the bows, and of ſome the umbrellas on their [heads."

There is no other form for the poſſeſſive pronoun, but the genitives of the perſonals ; as আমার *mine*, তোর *thine*, তোমার *your*, তার *his*, আমার দিগের *our* &c.

Example.

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Example.

তোমার হাথে রহিল জত আমার ধন

"All my wealth (i.e. the wealth of me) remained in your hands.
"(i.e. the hands of you)

Upon the ſame principle the genitive caſe of a ſubſtantive may become an adjective; as মধুর *ſweet* from মধু *honey*.

Example.

আস্বাষ করিয়া বলে মধুর বচন

"Having inſpired him with confidence, he gave him ſweet
"counſel. (i.e. *honey'd words*, or *words of honey*)

সিওঁতিতে পদ যাতা রাখিতেং ।
সিওঁতি হইল সোনা দেখিতেং ॥
সোনার সিওঁতি দেখি পাটনীর ভয় ।
এত মেয়া মানুষ নয় দেবতা নিশ্চয় ॥

"The mother (of nature) on ſuddenly placing her foot in the
[bucket,
"The bucket immediately became gold to behold."
"Fear ſeized the pilot, on beholding the *golden* bucket; (and
[he ſaid)
"This woman is not of human race, ſhe is certainly an angel."

শব্দযোগ or prepoſitions, for the moſt part govern the genitive caſe of ſubſtantives; but frequently the accuſative of pronouns; as

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তোমা হইতে নিচ কেবা আছয়ে মানুষে

"Who among men is of leſs account *than yourſelf*?

হে এ রে and আরে are general interjections that mark the vocative caſe; but গো and আন are applied only to women; as

শুন শুন গো সই হিত উপদেশ কই রামায়নে
কর অবগতি

"Hear, hear, O woman, I give you good advice; put faith
"in the Raamaayon."

আন পাপিনী আন শঙ্খিনী কেন নামরিনি হইয়া

"O criminal girl! O ſorcereſs! wherefore didſt thou not
"periſh at thy birth!"

Theſe laſt words are alſo uſed unconnectively, to denote that a woman is addreſſed by the ſpeaker; as

আন তোর বদন হেরি।
সিন্ধু সুতে নিন্দা করি॥

"O nymph! when I behold thy cheek,
"I deſpiſe the daughter of the ocean"

সীতা গো পরম সতী তার শুন দুর্গতি

"O woman! Seetaa was very conſtant: hear her unfortunate
"ſtory!"

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রে is alſo uſually ſubjoined to the imperative of the verb, particularly in converſation; as শুনরে *hear* O (thou) for শুন বলরে *ſpeak thou*, for বল thus

যাওরে রজনি তুমি মরিয়া

"Go thou O night, having periſhed."

The relative is very rarely uſed in compoſition, but its place is conſtantly ſupplied by the perſonal pronoun; as

আছিল রাজার পুত্র কহিল তাহায়।
পড়িবা সকল পুথি জত লেখা যায়॥

"There was a Raajaa's ſon, *to him* he ſaid (i.e. to whom he ſaid)
"You ſhall read all the books whatever that are written."

Nouns in the plural number always require a verb in the ſingular; as

সখী গন বলে মহাসয় তুমি কবিবর।
আমার কি সাধ্য দিতে তোমারে উত্তর॥

"The damſels *ſay*, you, ſir, are a poet.
"What power have we to anſwer you?

But where reſpect is implied, the plural of the verb is uſed even to a ſingular noun; as

এই রূপে সান্ত নাকরেন নারায়ন

"In

" In this manner Naaraayon pacifies him. "

And in a reſpectful addreſs to ſuperiors, the third perſon is generally applied inſtead of the ſecond; particularly among the moderns.

The indefinite preſent tenſe of the verb is almoſt univerſally applied inſtead of the preterite; and is even put in appoſition with it. Example.

ক্রোধে পার্থ অগ্নিবান পূরিন সন্ধান।
অগ্নিতে পোড়ায় সৈন্য দ্রোন বিদ্যমান॥

" Paart,ho in a rage aimed a weapon of fire,
" And with fire *deſtroyed* the troops in Dron's preſence. "

The preſent tenſe of the ſubſtantive verb is always more elegantly underſtood, than inſerted; as

বিদ্যার আকার ধ্যান বিদ্যানাম জপ।
বিদ্যা নাত বিদ্যা নাত বিদ্যা নাম তপ॥

" The beauty of Beedyaa *is* my ſtudy, Beedyaa's name *is* my [bead-roll;
" Beedyaa *is* my deſire, Bdeeyaa *is* my deſire; Beedyaa's name *is* my prayer. "

If a ſentence be expreſſed conditionally, the expreſſion is repeated in all the words which can admit the conditional form, and the returning member of the period exactly anſwers it; as

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যখন যেমত রাখিবা তখন তেমত পূজিব

"As you ſhall at any time place me, *ſo* will I *then* worſhip."

The uſe of the conditional conjunction is not confined to the ſubjunctive mood; but is applied to all the tenſes indifferently as in Engliſh. Thus:

to the paſt,

সোমদত্ত বলে যদি হইনা কৃপাবান

"Somdott ſaid, if you *were* really favourable ——"

to the future,

যদি মোরে বর দিবা দেব পসুপতি

"If you *will* grant me a favour, O Lord of life——"

to the preſent,

ব্রহ্মা যদি আপনে আসিয়া করে রন।
তোমারে ধরিতে সে নারিবে কাদাচন॥

"If Brohmaa himſelf having deſcended *makes* war,
"He ſhall by no means avail to take you priſoner."

The infinitive mood is uſually expreſſed by the gerund in তে as

সভা মধ্যে সোমদত্ত পাইয়া অপমান।
তপস্যা করিতে বনে করিল পয়ান॥

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"Somdøtt having received this diſgrace in the midſt of the [aſſembly,
"Retired into the deſert *to pray.*"

But the verbal infinitive is very frequently uſed in a paſſive ſenſe with the verb য়াওন Example.

মহা ঘোর যুদ্ধ হয় নাযায় লিখনে

"The battle raged with ſo great a noiſe as cannot be written."
(litterally, as cannot go in writing.)

Tranſitive verbs are called সকর্ম্মক in Shanſcrit, intranſitives অকর্ম্মক and thoſe are denominated দ্বিকর্ম্মক which govern two ſubjective caſes; as

বহুত বচনে কহিন অর্জ্জুনে

"He addreſſed much counſel to Orjoon."

The proper mode of arrangement in Bengaleſe is, firſt to name the agent, then the ſubject, and laſtly the verb: But the whole order of a ſentence ſeems generally to be the reverſe of the Engliſh method; as

5 4 3 2 1
জনেতে পূর্ন হইন সংগ্রামের স্থন
1 2 3 4 5
"The field of battle was full of water."

The laſt member of a period is almoſt always expreſſed by the preterite participle, inſtead of the tenſe of a verb; as

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যত দুঃখ দিল তোমায় পাপী দুর্য্যোধন ।
আমারে ক্ষেমহ মাতা না রাখিয়া মন ॥

"Whatever moleſtation the wicked Doorjjodhon hath cauſed you,
"Forgive me, O mother, not having kept it in mind." (i.e. and *do* not *keep* it in mind)

সে দেষে এ সব ভোগ জানহ বিশেষ ।
এ বার করহ ভোগ থাকিয়া এ দেষ ।

"Know, that in this country all this food is plenty,
"Therefore come now and eat, *having remained* in this country."

মল্লিকা ফুলে মানা অগুরু মাখিয়া ।
নিদাঘে বাতাস দিব কাম জাগাইয়া ॥

"Having anointed with Ogoo·oo (a perfume) my necklace of [the flower moleekaa,
"I will excite a breeze in the ſtifling calm, *having awakened* [deſire."

This participle is alſo indeclinable, and agrees with a noun in any caſe; or may rather be called a nominative abſolute; as

ভাট মুখে শুনিয়া বিদ্যার সমাচার ।
উথলিল সুন্দরের সুখ পারাপার ॥

"*Having heard* an account of Beedyaa from the mouth of Bhaat,
"The inclinations of Soondor boiled vehemently."

where

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where শুনিয়া agrees with সুন্দরের a genitive.

The participle paſſive is very frequently uſed with the tenſes of করন to form a ſimple tranſitive verb; as ক্ষেমা করন to forgive, from ক্ষেমন to forgive; as

এখন ইহার ফল করিবার পারি।
ধর্ম্ম অনুরোধে তোমা আজি ক্ষেমা করি॥

"Now I am able to puniſh you for this,
"But for the ſake of religion I this day *forgive* you."

In all the Indian languages the connection of two ſentences is preſerved, by beginning the ſecond period with the participle preterite of the concluding verb of the firſt. Example.

আর ধনু ধরি বীর পূরিল সন্ধান।
সন্ধান পূরিয়া এড়ে দিব্য অস্ত্র গন॥

"The hero taking another bow, compleated his aim:
"*Having compleated his aim,* he caſt dreadful weapons."

This is ſomething like the expreſſion in Ovid:

"Congeriem ſecuit, *ſectamque* in membra redegit."

The participles দিয়া গিয়া and ſome others are frequently redundant.

Exam-

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Example.

দুখের ঘরেতে বন্দি করিয়া অনঙ্গ আনন
ভেজাইয়া দিয়া কোন অভিনাসে বিরহ
বাতাসে জানাইনা জুবতী

"Having enſlaved me in the houſe of affliction, and *having ſet*
"*to it* the ſpark of deſire,
"How eagerly did you inflame a young girl with the breath
"of perfidy!"

This participle preterite muſt ſometimes be rendered with the ſign of the infinitive in Engliſh; as

গুন সাগর নাগর রায় নগর দেখিয়া যায়

"The learned Naagor goes *to view* the city."

Thus we may obſerve that the uſe of the participles is very frequent, and not inelegant, as it throws a degree of variety into the conſtruction, and at the ſame time renders the ſentence more round and compact.

Through all the foregoing ſheets I have earneſtly laboured to give both a reaſon and a proof for every rule which I laid down, and for every particularity which came in review: This I hope will exculpate me for the number of inſipid inſtances which I have been obliged to inſert. It will not be ſuppoſed that

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that in the continual hurry of a life of buſineſs I could have much leiſure to turn over voluminous compoſitions for the meer purpoſe of ſelecting poetical expreſſions: I generally took thoſe which firſt occurred, and for the moſt part confined my reading to the Mohaabhaarot, which is reckoned one of the moſt claſſical writings.

CHAPTER VIII.

Of Orthoepy and Verſification.

IN the preceding chapters I have laid down no other rules for the utterance or omiſſion of the inherent vowel, than ſuch as properly depend upon the Shanſcrit, and are applicable to the right pronunciation of verſe, wherein every ſingle conſonant forms a ſeparate ſyllable. But the popular mode of applying it in ordinary converſation ſtill remains to be conſidered.

The following canons will I hope be found ſufficient for the purpoſe.

And firſt of words concluding with a conſonant whoſe inherent vowel is not uttered.

All

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All ſubſtantives that contain only two ſeparate conſonants are monoſyllabic in Bengaleſe, tho' of two ſyllables in Shanſcrit; as মন *the heart*, তপ *prayer*, বীর *a hero*, জন *a perſon*: pronounce mon, top, beer, jon, &c.

The ſame method obtains, if the latter conſonant be a pholaa, or double; as দন্ত *a tooth*, পুত্র *a ſon*, শব্দ *a word*: read dont, pootr, ſhobd.

স্থান the prepoſition, and ſuch others of the attributive claſs, as are properly ſubſtantives, come under this rule. So alſo ফের *back*,, দূর *far off*, and আর *moreover* are monoſyllables.

র the ſign of the genitive caſe is always mute; as তার *of him*, তোর *of thee*, মোর *of me*, ঘরের *of a houſe* &c. pronounce taar, tor, mor, ghorar. So গন and দল the ſigns of the plural number, are always of one ſyllable.

কোন kon the interrogative *who?* or *what?* is monoſyllabic.

Names of numbers which have only two conſonants are of one ſyllable; as এক ak *one*, তিন teen *three*, পাঁচ paach *five*, ছয় choy *fix*, &c.

Whenever in a word containing more than two ſeparate conſonants,

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ſonants, the laſt letter be a conſonant, the included vowel is omitted; as আকাশ *Æther*, নন্দন *a ſon*, বাতাস *wind*: pronounce aakaaſh, nondon, baataas.

Words containing four ſeparate conſonants (which ſhould conſequently have three ſyllables) are frequently contracted into diſſyllables, by dropping the inherent vowel of the third conſonant; as দরশন doroſhon, *appearance* is pronounced dorſhon.

Of words terminating with an open conſonant.

All adjectives containing only two ſingle conſonants, or one ſingle and one double, are diſſyllables; as বড় *large*, ছোট *ſmall*, মন্দ *bad*, ভাল *good* &c. pronounce boro, choto, mondo, bhaalo.

Indeclinable particles of two conſonants claſſed under the head of pronouns which terminate in ন generally have their final conſonant open; as হেন *that*, তেন *ſuch*, কেন *why* &c. read hano, tano, kano.

The enclytics ক ko, হ ho and ত to always preſerve their inherent vowel; as নাহিক naaheeko for নাহি *not*, এত ato *this* for এ or এই করহ koroho for কর *do thou* &c.

So alſo the particles of two conſonants ending with ত are diſſyllabic; as কত koto *how many*, তত toto *ſo many*, জত joto

jete howmany feever &c,

The following parts of the verb never drop the inherent vowel of their final conſonant:

The 2d. perſon plural of the preſent tenſe; as করু koro *ye do.*
The 3d perſon ſingular of the preterite করিল koreelo *he did.*
The 1ſt perſon ſingular of the future করিব koreebo *I will do.*
The 3d perſon ſingular of the aoriſt করিত koreeto *he would do.*
The 2d perſon ſingular and plural of the imperative কর koro *do thou* or *ye.*

In all other tenſes and perſons of the verb, the concluding conſonant is invariably mute; as করিস koree*s thou doſt*, not koreeſo; করেন koran *they do*, not korano; করিলাম koreelaam *I did*, not koreelaamo; করুক korcok *let him do*, not korooko; করন koron *to do*, not korono; করিবার koreebaar *in doing*, never koreebaaro; ſo করিলেক and করিবেক *he hath done, he will do*; are always pronounced koreelak and koreebak.

The final conſonants of the numerals, from eleven to eighteen incluſive, always preſerve their inherent vowel; as এগার agaaro not agaar, আঠার aat,haaro not aat,haar &c.

The other vowels require no rule; they are always uttered as they are written.

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When the ſame word is repeated twice together, the latter is denoted by the figure ২ as the firſt line which is inſerted in the fiftieth page would be conſtantly written by the Bengaleſe in this manner.

টন২ করে জন মন্ন২ বায়

Many words of popular and general uſe are uſually contracted in Bengal writings, to avoid delay in the hurry of buſineſs.

The contraction is formed by the firſt letter or ſyllable of the word to be contracted, followed by the figure ০ *onoolwor* the conſtant attendant upon theſe occaſions.

I have here inſerted the moſt common of them.

A.	কি°	for	কিসমত	a village or diviſion.
P.		—	কিস্তি	a boat.
B & H.		—	কিস্তিবন্দি	a rent-roll, an agreement to pay by inſtallments.
B & H.	চা°	—	চানান	an invoice.
B & H.		—	চাকর	a ſervant.
A.	জা°	—	জামিন	a ſurety or ſecurity.
B & H.	জো°	—	জোড়া	a pair (or ſuit) of any thing.
P.	জি°	—	জিম্মে	in truſt, or, in the charge of.
A.		—	জিনিস	goods.

A.

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A. ন° for নগাদ ready money.

A. তা° — তালুক a taalook or ſmall zemindarry. (literally, ſomething dependent)

A. — তারিখ the date or day of the month.

P. ত° — তরফ a ſide, or towards.

B & H. দ° — দর price, or value.

H. প° — পরগানে a pergunneh, or large portion [of land.

B. পা° — পাইক a pike, or watchman.

P. পে° — পেয়াদা a peaada (a footman, or meſ- [ſenger.

P. বা° — বাবত on account of, or belonging to.

B. ম° — মণ্ডল a mundul, or chief perſon in [a village.

P. মা° — মাহে the moon.

A. — মারফত with, or by the hands of.

A. — মাহামদ maahaamod.

মে° for the Engliſh Mr.

A. মো° — মোকাম a place, prefixed to the name of [any place.

A. না° — নাগাইদ ending with (applied to dates [of time.

A.

A. সা° — সাকিম an inhabitant.
B. হা° — হাওয়ালাত to the care of.
B. ই° — ইমুক beginning with (applied to dates [of time.)

NB. A ſtands in this liſt for Arabic, P for Perſian, H for Hindoſtanic, B for Bengaleſe.

Of Verſification.

The verſes of the Bengaleſe are regulated by accent, and by the number of ſyllables in a line; no regard whatever being paid to quantity, but as it co-incides with accent.

Their poems, like thoſe of the Arabians and Perſians, are in Rhyme, which appears to ſuit the genius of moſt of the Aſiatic languages, and to have been in uſe from the earlieſt antiquity.

The Bengal Poets have many rules for contracting ſuch words as are too long, and for extending thoſe that are too ſhort for their metre.

The moſt common of theſe licences are as follow.

Subſtantives are contracted by the omiſſion of the diacritical terminations; of which I have given frequent inſtances.

The preterite participle is reduced from three ſyllables to two, by changing the penultimate vowel into its correſponding conſonant; as করা for করিয়া বনা for বনিয়া thus

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সাধ করিয়া শিখিলাম কাব্য রস যত ।
কানার কপালে পড়া সব হইল হত ॥

"Having eagerly ſought, I learnt every ſpecies of pleaſure;
"But having fallen to the lot of a deaf man it is all vaniſhed."

The preterites of ſome verbs are contracted, by throwing away their penultimate conſonant; as কৈনাম for করিনাম *I did*, বৈনাম *I ſpoke* for বলিনাম Example.

বন মধ্যে বলাৎকার কৈল নারী গন

"In the deſerts he committed violence on the women."

So the firſt ſyllable of the word পারন *to be able*, is frequently thrown away, when preceded by the negative না as নারি *I am not able*, নাপারি নারিনাম for নাপারি নাম &c.

So in the third ſingular of the preſent tenſe নহে *is not*, is contracted to নয় by dropping the হ as

এতেক শুনিয়া সবে বলে হায় হায় ।
যে কথা কহিয়াছ ভাই কিছু মিথ্যা নয় ॥

"Having heard this, they all cried alas, alas!
"The tale which thou haſt told, O brother, certainly *is not* [falſe."

Words

Words are lengthened by adding to them ſome one of the following enclytics ক ko ত to হ ho and চ cho.

The uſage of ক ko with an open vowel ſeems confined to the word নাহি when it ſtands for *non eſt*; as

তোমা সম যোদ্ধা পতি নাহিক আমার

"We have no warrior like yourſelf."

ত to is applied indifferently wherever a ſyllable is wanted, but particularly after words ending in ই or এ as

এই হেতু তোমারেত কহি এ রাজন

"On this account I ſpeak to you, O king."

This enclytic is commonly added after the numerals in common converſation; as তিনত teento for তিন teen *three*, দশত doſhto for দশ doſh *ten* &c.

হ ho is added to ſome of the pronouns in এ as কেহ kaho তেহ taho &c. thus

রঘুনাথের বানে তেহ হইল অস্থির

"Even he was put to flight by the arrows of Roghoonaant,h."

and to the ſecond perſons of the preſent tenſe and imperative;

যদি না করহ মোর বাক্যের পালন

"If

" If you do not ſurely obey my words,——"

ঙ after the Shanſcrit accuſative; as নিবেদনঙ্ক for নিবেদন° কার্য্যঙ্ক for কার্য্য° &c.

The vowel এ is very frequently added enclytically to the caſes of ſubſtantives.

It is likewiſe uſed to lengthen out the firſt perſon ſingular of the preſent tenſe, by inſerting after the final ই its correſponding conſonant য় as কহিয়ে *I ſpeak*, for কহি জানিয়ে *I know*, for জানি Example.

আমি যে কহিয়ে তাহা শুন ক্ষেত্রি গন

" Hear, O ye Kyhatrees, that which I ſpeak."

And alſo to the third perſon of the ſame tenſe which ends in এ by changing that vowel into য় as আছয়ে for আছে for করে for করয়ে &c. Example.

তোমা হইতে নীচ কেবা আছয়ে মানুষে।
মোর অগোচর নহে জানিয়ে বিশেষে ॥

" Who among men is of leſs account than yourſelf!

" Neither is this hidden from me, I know it well."

আ is ſometimes inſerted before এ which is then changed into য় as মাঝায় for মাঝে the locative caſe of মাঝ

the

the middle or *waiſt*; as

কে বলে অনঙ্গ অঙ্গ দেখা না যায়।
দেখুক যে আঁখি ধরি বিদ্যার আকার॥

"Who ſays that the figure of Love is not to be ſeen?
"Opening his eyes let him look on the ſhape of Beedyaa."

Of the formation of Verſes.

The Bengal meaſures are altogether borrowed from the Shanſcrit, and may be divided into three ſpecies: Heroic, Lyric, and the গীত or Elegiac.

Every line of every ſpecies of verſe is called a ছন্দ with a different additional appellation according to the number of ſyllables it may contain; as

অনুষ্টুপ ছন্দ — a verſe of 8 ſyllables.
পংক্তী ছন্দ — — of 10 .
ত্রিষ্টুপ ছন্দ — — of 11 .
জাতী ছন্দ — — of 12 .
শর্করী ছন্দ — — of 14 .

and if the verſe have a double rhyme, which gives it any add number of ſyllables above 11, the word অতি is prefixed to that which denotes the even number immediately below it;

as

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as অতিজগতী a verſe of 13 ſyllables.
অতিশর্করী — of 15 — &c.

The metre moſt uſually applied in Shanſcrit poems is a ſtanza compoſed of four lines, of the অনুষ্টুপ্ ছন্দ each of which anſwers to a dimetre Iambic, and is called শ্লোক which is a general term for any ſtanza. The 2d and 4th lines only rhyme together; and conſequently make a long diſtich.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8
বসুনা বসুধা লোকে বন্দতে মন্দজাতিকং ।
1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8
করভোরু রতিপ্রঙ্গে দ্বিতীয়ে পঞ্চমে প্যহং ॥

boſoonaa boſoodhaa loka bondota mondo jaateekung
korobhoroo roteeprongga dweeteeya ponchoma pyohung.

The common heroic meaſure of the Bengaleſe is a diſtich conſiſting generally of 14 ſyllables, and hath a trochaic accent; as

দুর্গা দুর্গা পরা ত্বমি দুর্গাতি নাশিনী ।
গোপন রাখিনা জয়া যশোদা নন্দিনী ॥

doorggaa doorggaa poraa toomee doorggotee naaſheenee
gokoolo raakheelaa joyaa joſhodaa nondeenee.

"O Doorgaa, Doorgaa! thou art the greateſt of deities and the [diſpeller of care.

"Thou didſt victoriouſly guard Gokool, thou art the daughter [of Joſhodaa."

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This ſpecies is called পয়ার Another ſort of diſtich is called তোটকচ্ছন্দ and conſiſts of 12 ſyllables with an anapæſtic meaſure.

নৃপনন্দন কাম রসে বসিয়া।
পরি ধান ধুতি পড়িছে খসিয়া॥

nreepo nondono kaamo roſa boſeeyaa
poree dhaano dhootee poreech,ha khoſeeyaa.

Sometimes the তোটক has but 11 ſyllables, and then is dactylic with a trochee at the end; as

কি ব্যাধি জন্মিল হিয়ার মাঝে।
চাঁদের কর শর হেন বাজে॥

kee byaadhee jonmeelo heeyaaro maajha
chaadaro koro ſoro hano baaja.

"What diſorder is ariſen within my body!
"The rays of the moon pierce me like darts.

All the lyric meaſures of the Bengaleſe (at leaſt ſuch as enter into their larger compoſitions) are alſo diſtichs; but are ſubdivided by pauſes, and internal rhymes, from whence they receive their appellation.

Thus a line of 14 ſyllables, compoſed of two verſes of 7 ſyllables each, is called এক পদী or *of one pauſe*; as

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নিজ কর্ম্মের দোষ তোমারে করি রোষ

" Should I blame you for the criminality of my own actions ? "

A diſtich having two pauſes in each line of 14 ſyllables is called দ্বিপদী as

পদ্ম সঙ্গে গাথে রঙ্গে স্থল পদ্ম তান।
মাঝে মাঝে গন্ধরাজে আর করে আন॥

" With joy he ſtrings along with the lotus the beautiful ſtolo-
[podm ; (a large flower)
" The lilly inſerted between them receives additional luſtre. "

We have lyric meaſures in Engliſh which anſwer to all theſe verſes of the Bengaleſe: Thus in Milton.

" As when the dove, laments her love, all on the naked ſpray ;
" When he returns, no more ſhe mourns, but loves the live-long
(day. "

But if the diſtich have two internal pauſes, and conſiſt of more than 14 ſyllables in a line, it is called ত্রিপদী or *of three pauſes*; as in this of 20 ſyllables.

পার্থ মহা বীর হইল অস্থির পুত্রের মরন শুনি।
হাহা পুত্র মোর এক ধনুর্দ্ধর বীর গন চূড়া মনি॥

" Part,ho

" Paart, ho the great hero became diſtracted on hearing the
(death of his ſon,
" Alas! my ſon, the greateſt of all bowmen, the diadem of
all heroes."

Other tr*ee*podees have 7 ſyllables in each of the internal pauſes, and others 8; with 10 in the concluding one; but are all formed upon the ſame principal.

If there are 3 internal pauſes, rhyming together, beſides the concluding part, the diſtich is then denominated চৌপদী as

আ গোমরা যাই নইয়া বানাই সলে দিয়াছাই
ভজি ইহারে।
যোগিনী হইয়া ওহারে নইয়া যাইপনাইয়া
সাগর পারে॥

" O woman! I could take upon myſelf his misfortunes, and
" die; and having conſigned my family to the duſt, would o-
" bey him alone: I would become a pilgrim, and having taken
" him with me, would fly acroſs the ocean."

The Bengaleſe fill the pages of their books with verſe as if it were proſe. The firſt line of a diſtich is diſtinguiſhed by a ſingle upright ſtroke, thus । and the ſecond line by two ſtrokes ॥

Muſic

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Muſic is conſtantly applied by the Hindoos in all their public worſhip; but the inſtruments on which it is performed are very imperfect, and ſeem hardly to have received any alterations, or improvements from the firſt period of their invention. The Bengaleſe always uſe the minor key, and their gamut proceeds by the very ſmalleſt intervals of the chromatic ſcale. They have no idea of counterpoint, and always play and ſing in uniſon or octaves.

Their ſyſtem is divided into ſix modes called রাগ each of which is ſuppoſed to be adapted to particular ſeaſons and circumſtances according as its peculiar character is grave or gay, loud or ſoft &c. Every রাগ is ſubdivided into ſix ſubordiante modes denominated রাগিনী and it is to be obſerved that as রাগ is of the maſculine gender, and রাগিনী of the feminine, the Hindoos ſuppoſe রাগ to be the huſband, and রাগিনী his wives. I have been told that there are treatiſes in Bengaleſe and Shanſcrit upon the ſcience of muſic, but I could never procure a ſight of them. The book called রাগমালা (or *the necklace of muſic*) is nothing more than a collection of pictures, exhibiting the traditional hiſtory of the primary and ſubordinate modes, and the ſubjects appropriated to each.

Almoſt

Almoſt all the Bengal compoſitions are intended to be ſung to the accompaniment of inſtruments, and every change of metre or of ſtrain is regularly marked as it occurs; that no part may be introduced out of ſeaſon, and that a রাগ proper for the morning may not unfortunately be performed in the evening.

In moſt of the poetical writings upon religious or moral ſubjects, which are ſuppoſed to be recited or ſung by a Bramin to a ſurrounding audience, a ſort of hemiſtich or diſtich is occaſionally inſerted to be ſung in chorus by the whole aſſembly at particular intervals. It is not always a verſe belonging to the reſt of the meaſure, but has a ſeparate and diſtinct metre of its own: it is called ধুয়া. When it is to be attended with clapping of hands, as in the ceremonies of public worſhip, ধুয়া তান

In all the larger works, various kinds of metre are applied to enliven the ſtyle, or to expreſs particular change of ſentiments and paſſions: ſo in the Dron porb of the Mohaabhaarot where the lamentation of Orjjoon for the death of his ſon is introduced, the narrative of the accident is in the পয়ার or common heroic; but when Orjjoon himſelf begins to ſpeak, the meaſure ſuddenly breaks

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breaks off into the ত্রিপদী beginning পার্থ মহা বীর হইন অস্থির &c.

The গীত or elegiac ſtyle of writing, is ſo very looſe and arbitrary, that I cannot lay down any rules for its conſtruction; but I have generally obſerved, that the ſame rhyme is carried on thro' the whole ode.

The ſtrain of theſe pieces ſeems in general to be much more poetical than that of their more extenſive compoſitions.

APPENDIX.

Hitherto we have ſeen the formation and conſtruction of the Bengal language in all its genuine ſimplicity; when it could borrow Shanſcrit terms for every circumſtance without the danger of becoming un-intelligible, and when tyranny had not yet attempted to impoſe its fetters even on the freedom of compoſition.

As a contraſt to this, I ſhall take for the ſubject of this appendix a ſhort petition which I have ſelected from a number of others as being remarkably replete with foreign expreſſions; and which ſerves to ſhew how far the modern Bengaleſe have been forced

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forced to debaſe the purity of their native dialect, by the neceſſity of addreſſing themſelves to their Mahommedan Rulers. Indeed the Muſſulman officers, who ſuperintended the adminiſtration of juſtice and the collection of the revenues, would ſeldom or never condeſcend to receive petitions and letters in the Bengal language, with which they were almoſt wholly unacquainted: but obliged the natives to procure a Perſian tranſlation to all the papers which they might have occaſion to preſent. This practice familiariſed to their ears ſuch of the Perſian terms as more immediately concerned their ſeveral affairs; and by long habit, they learnt to aſſimilate them to their own language, by applying the Bengal inflexions and terminations.

I ſhall firſt inſert the petition as it ſtands in the original, copied exactly on a copper plate, and repreſented in the proper character on the correſponding page. This will ſhew the learner moſt of the vitiated forms of letters uſed in expeditious writing; and introduce him to the irregular hands, which are conſtantly found in matters of buſineſs.

I ſhall next give a plain, but not literal tranſlation of the petition, meerly to ſhew its meaning, and laſtly ſhall analyze the conſtruction of each word, and point out its derivation.

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Errata discovered since the Bengal Grammar came to England.

Page.	Line.			
29.	16	for. *hrosookaar*	read	*hroswookaar.*
37.	2.	— *Mohaab-aarotar*	—	*Mohaabhaarotar.*
39.	1.	— নাজাহো	—	নাজাহ.
—	14.	— চাহো	—	চাহ.
18.	15.	— *baahgonee*	—	*baaghonee.*
76.	14.	— *fign*	—	*sign.*
77.	12.	— *Composions*	—	*Compositions.*
—	last.	— *third*	—	*second.*
85.	5.	— চানায়	—	চানাহ.
89.	18.	— *was*	—	*is.*
101.	3.	after *and*	supply	*the.*
102.	7.	for. *porosmai*	read.	*porosmi.*
109.	4.	— জাবে	—	জাবি.
112.	6&7.	— *a river of the water of life*	—	*an immortal stream.*
115	last.	— *by adding*	—	*having.*
123.	19.	— দেইমাস	—	দেইনাব.
133.	10.	— পরাশ্রয়	—	পরায়.
146.	20.	— *Maculine*	—	*Masculine.*
166.	2.	— *seventh*	—	*seventeenth.*
—	4.	— ঽনবিংশতি	—	ঽনবিংশ
167.	9.	— *Airthmetic*	—	*Arithmetic.*
184.	17.	— *Bead-roll*	—	*Rosary.*
197.	12.	after *I am not able*	supply	*for.*
199.	11.	for *Kyhatrees*	read	*Khyatrees.*
—	12.	*The first & third words of this line must change places.*		
204.	7.	for *principal*	read	*principle.*
205.	12.	— *Subordiante*	—	*Subordinate.*

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C.W. Sculpt.

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৭স্বীরাম

গরিবনেওাজ সেনামত

আমার জমিদারি পরগনে কাকজোল
তাহার দুই গ্রাম দরিয়াশীকিস্তী হইয়াছে
সেই দুই গ্রাম পয়স্তী হইয়াছে চাকলে একবরপুরের
শ্রী হরেকৃষ্ণ চৌধুরি আজ রায় জবরদস্তী দখল করিয়া
ভোগ করিতেছে আমি মালগুজারির শরবরাহতে
মারাপড়িতেছি ওমেদওয়ার যে শরকার হইতে আমিন
ও এক চোপদার শরজমিনতে পহুচিয়া তোরফেনকে
তলব দিয়া লইয়া আদালত করিয়া হকদারের হক দেনায়া
দেন ইতি শন ১১৮৫ শাল তারিখ ১১ শ্রাবন

ফিদবি
জগতবির রায়

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Tranſlation.

Shree Raam!

Cheriſher of the poor, Proſperity!

My Zemindarry is the Pergunnah of Kaakjol; of which two villages have been overflowed by an inundation: theſe two villages were afterwards embanked. Now one Shree Hora Kreeſhno Choudhooree, of the Chuklaa of Akborpoor, having by force and violence taken poſſeſſion, applies them to his own uſe. I therefore am reduced to great difficulties in compleating the ſum of the revenues. I am hopeful that an Aameen and one Chobdar on the part of government may be ſent to the premiſes to ſummon both parties: and having juſtly decided upon the affair, may cauſe the right of property to be given to the true proprietor. This is my petition.

In the year 1185, 25 th day of the month Shraawon.

(ſigned)

The devoted ſuppliant

Jogot Dheer Raay.

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Analyſis.

৭ শ্রীরাম The crook of Gonaſh, with the uſual invocation to Raam.

গরিবনেওয়াজ শনামত This is a Perſian formulary of addreſs, without any addition or change of inflexion to naturalize it into the Bengaleſe: But it is very unuſual to find it ſo applied in the writings of the Hindoos.

আমার জমিদারি পরগনে কাকজোল 'My Zemindarry is the Pergunnah of Kaakjol.' আমার is the regular poſſeſſive caſe of আমি *I.* জমিদারি is corrupted from zemindaree a Perſian word ſignifying an eſtate, or poſſeſſion of lands পরগনে is alſo a Perſian word, and is applied to a large diviſion or parcel of a diſtrict. কাকজোল is a proper name, and properly of Bengal original.

তাহার দ্বই গ্রাম দরিয়াশীকিস্তী হইয়াছে 'Of which there has been an inundation of two villages.' তাহার is the regular poſſeſſive caſe of the demonſtrative pronoun সে দ্বই improperly written for দুই *two.* গ্রাম is a Shanſcrit word for a Town or Village. দরিয়াশীকিস্তী is a Perſian compound term and ſignifies *a breaking out of a river.* হইয়াছে is the third perſon ſingular of the definite paſt tenſe of হওন *to be*; ſo that দরিয়াশীকিস্তী হইয়াছে muſt mean *there has*

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has been an inundation of two villages, and দুই গ্রাম is the genitive case without the diacritical sign.

সেই দুই গ্রাম পয়স্তী হইয়াছে 'An embankment of these two villages has taken place.' সে properly সে is the demonstrative pronoun, and agrees with গ্রাম which, as in the former sentence, is the genitive without its termination. পয়স্তী is a Persian word and implies *embankment*; but the spelling is very erroneous in the Bengalese, হইয়াছে as in the former sentence.

চাকনেএকবরপুরের শ্রীহরে কৃষ্ণ চৌধুরি আজ রায় জবরদস্তী দখল করিয়া ভোগ করিতেছে 'Shree Horakreeshno Choudhooree, of the district of Akborpoor, having taken possession by the way of violence, applies (them) to his own use.' চাকনে is a Persian term for a district, একবরপুরের the genitive case of একবরপুর improperly written for একবরপুর the name of a place, compounded of একবর an Arabic title, and পুর a Shanscrit term for a town or settlement. শ্রীহরে কৃষ্ণ is the name of a Bengalese, and চৌধুরি is a Bengal term for a certain office or post in the collection of the revenues. আজরায় জবরদস্তী is a Persian formulary applied on all occasions where

where force and violence have been exerted. দখল করিয়া is a compound preterite participle formed from the Bengal verb করন *to do*, and দখল an Arabic verbal implying *poſſeſſion*, or *entrance*; ভোগ করিতেছে is the definite preſent tenſe of a compound verb ſignifying *to eat*; for in all oriental languages *to eat* is applied to appropriation and enjoyment of every kind of property.

আমি মালগুজারির শরবরাহতে মারাপড়িতেছি 'I meet much difficulty in the completion of the revenues.' আমি is the pronoun *I*, মালগুজারির is a Perſian term, with the Bengal ſign of the genitive caſe added to it, and means *the revenues which are to be paid to government*. শরবরাহতে is the ſign of the ſeventh caſe applied alſo to a foreign term, and implies *completion*. মারা পড়িতেছি literally ſignifies *am beaten*, but here denotes any hardſhip or ſuffering.

উমেদওয়ার জে শরকার হইতে আমিন ও এক চোপদার শরজমিনতে পহুচিয়া তোরফেনকে তলব দিয়া নইয়া আদালত করিয়া হকদারের হক দেনায়া দেন

"I am hopeful, that from the government an Aameen and one "Chopdaar having arrived on the premiſes, and having ſum-

"moned

" moned and brought together both parties, and having de-
" cided juſtly, may cauſe the property to be given to the right-
" ful proprietor."

This is a long ſentence compoſed of ſeveral members, all of which are connected together by the uſage of the preterite participle. উমেদওয়ার is a Perſian adjective and ſignifies *hopeful*: the verb ſubſtantive *I am* is underſtood. সরকার হইতে from the government. সরকার is a Perſian word and means *the head of affairs.* হইতে is a Bengal prepoſition *from.* যে is a Bengal particle meaning *that.* আমিন is an Arabic participle and denotes *one who is truſted* and is the term uſually applied to an officer diſpatched into the country for the immediate inveſtigation of occaſional diſputes. ও means *and.* এক is *one* in Bengaleſe. চোপদার improperly written for চুবদার is a Perſian term and ſignifies *bearing a ſtick.* It is applied to the attendants of men in high ſtation and Judges, who are diſtinguiſhed by ſilver ſticks. শরজমিনতে the ſign of the oblique Bengal caſe, is here applied to a Perſian compound word, meaning *the ſpot* or *premiſes.* পহুচিয়া is a Hindoſtanic verb adopted and declined like thoſe of the Bengaleſe: it means *to arrive.* তোরফেনকে the mark of the accuſative

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ſative caſe, is here added to an Arabic noun in the dual number, implying *the two parties.* তলব দিয়া is a compound participle formed from the Arabic word *talab* a ſummons, and দেওন the Bengal verb *to give.* লইয়া is the regular participle from the verb লওন *to bring.* আদালত করিয়া is compounded of an Arabic noun for *juſtice,* and করন *to do.* হকদারের a genitive termination is here added to হকদার a Perſian compound word meaning *a perſon poſſeſſing a right,* or *who hath right on his ſide.* হক is an Arabic word ſignifying *right.* দেনায়া দেন *may cauſe to give.* the firſt word is a cauſal participle irregularly formed from দেওন *to give;* the ſecond is the third perſon plural preſent tenſe of the ſame verb. The plural is expreſſive of reſpect to the character of the Aameen.

ইতি শন ১১৮৫ শান তারিখ ১১ শ্রাবন

ইতি an adverb meaning *thus far*: and implies that the petition is concluded. শন is an Arabic word for *year,* and always applied to dates or epoch. শান alſo means *year* in Perſian and the writer has here ignorantly uſed two words of the ſame ſignification

fication to expreſs one thing. তারিখ means the date or day of the month, in Arabic and Perſian. শাবন is the name of a Bengal month, anſwering to half July and Auguſt. ফিদবি is an Arabic participle derived from the verb to ſacrifice, and is always applied in Perſian to betoken humility and dependance. জগত খির রায় is a Bengal proper name.

THE END.

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Devanagari sur les alphabets ou sur les écritures indoues du
Sanskrit : Prototype Dévanâgari, (de la ville de Dé
Dans le nord forme carrée et anguleuse, dont plus ancienne
du Bengale, d'Agra, Nepal, Kashmire, Tirhout,
Gouzerate, bengali ou cursive de la langue indou
du Bengale, du Mahratte
Dans le midi écritures arrondies ou ovales, le Telenga l'ouvrage
le grantha, le Tamale entamoul, le Karatte ou Kanara
le singhala-dwipa, ou l'écriture singhalaise qui est
celle des côtes de Ceylan.
Mem. lu en 1813 à la 3e Classe

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